THURSDAY
October 15, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
28 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 149 • No. 245
Regd. TN/ARD/110/2024-2026
RNI No. 1001/1957

To subscribe, give a missed call at 9828331787 or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna

THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA. INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND THE NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE" AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 (**"RHP"**).

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD	
	ANCHOR INVESTOR BIDDING DATE: MONDAY, OCTOBER 19, 2026
	BID/ISSUE OPENS ON: WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026
	BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON[(1)]: FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

(1) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided below in the advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

J CH-CHE

...continued from previous page.

2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

(1) *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

(2) *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

(3) *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ millions)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken pre-IPO placement from the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoter or the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of equity shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the DRHP till date.
3. The aggregate pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and the top 10 Shareholders is set out below:

S. No.	Name of the shareholder	Pre-Issue: No. of Equity Shares of face value ₹10 each	Pre-Issue Shareholding (in %)*	Post-Issue as at allotment at lower end ₹1,065: No. of Equity Shares^	Post-Issue Shareholding (in %)^*	Post-Issue as at allotment at upper end ₹1,119: Number of Equity Shares^	Post-Issue Shareholding (in %)^*
Promoter							
1	Reliance Industries Limited	5,937,841,645	66.35%	5,937,841,645	64.41%	5,937,841,645	64.41%
	Additional top 10 Shareholders						
1	Jaadhu Holdings, LLC (an affiliate of Meta Platforms, Inc. (formerly known as Facebook, Inc.))	892,275,913	9.97%	892,275,913	9.68%	892,275,913	9.68%
2	Google International LLC	690,854,775	7.72%	690,854,775	7.49%	690,854,775	7.49%
3	The Public Investment Fund (a sovereign wealth fund of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia)	206,931,899	2.31%	206,931,899	2.24%	206,931,899	2.24%
4	Omicron Asia Holdings II Pte. Ltd. (an affiliate of funds, vehicles and/or entities managed and/or advised by Kohlberg Kravis Roberts & Co. L.P., an indirect subsidiary of KKR & Co. Inc.)	206,931,899	2.31%	206,931,899	2.24%	206,931,899	2.24%
5	VEPF VII AIV I Ltd. (an affiliate of funds, vehicles and/or entities managed and/or advised by Vista Equity Partners Management, LLC)	206,931,899	2.31%	206,931,899	2.24%	206,931,899	2.24%
6	SLP Redwood Holdings Pte. Ltd. (an affiliate of Silver Lake)	168,489,206	1.88%	168,489,206	1.83%	168,489,206	1.83%
7	MIC Redwood 1 RSC Limited (an indirectly wholly owned subsidiary of Mubadala Investment Company PJSC)	165,545,519	1.85%	165,545,519	1.80%	165,545,519	1.80%
8	General Atlantic Singapore JP Pte. Ltd.	120,120,900	1.34%	120,120,900	1.30%	120,120,900	1.30%
9	Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust (acting through its trustee, Platinum Owl C 2018 RSC Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Abu Dhabi Investment Authority)	103,465,950	1.16%	103,465,950	1.12%	103,465,950	1.12%
10	India Markets Pte. Ltd. (an entity managed/advised by TPG Capital (S) Pte. Ltd.)	82,772,760	0.92%	82,772,760	0.90%	82,772,760	0.90%
11	Other public shareholders	167,148,465	1.87%	437,148,465	4.74%	437,148,465	4.74%
	TOTAL	**8,949,310,830**	**100.00%**	**9,219,310,830**	**100.00%**	**9,219,310,830**	**100.00%**

Note: The Promoter Group do not hold any Equity Shares in the Company

^Assuming full subscription in the Issue. The post-Issue shareholding details as at Allotment will be based on the actual subscription and will be updated in the Prospectus, subject to finalization of the Basis of Allotment. Also, this table assumes there is no transfer of Equity Shares by these shareholders between the date of the advertisement and Allotment (if any such transfers occur prior to the date of Prospectus, it will be updated in the shareholding pattern in the Prospectus).

** Assuming exercise of all vested options*

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band in this advertisement. Please refer to the website of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

The Issue Price will be determined by the Company in consultation with the BRLMs, on the basis of assessment of market demand for the Equity Shares offered through the Book Building Process and on the basis of quantitative and qualitative factors as described below. The face value of the Equity Shares is ₹ 10 each and the Issue Price is 106.50 times the face value of the Equity Shares at the lower end of the Price Band and 111.90 times the face value of the Equity Shares at the higher end of the Price Band. Investors should refer to *"Risk Factors"*, *"Our Business"*, *"Restated Consolidated Financial Information"* and *"Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations"* on pages 30, 196, 320 and 436, of the RHP respectively, to have an informed view before making an investment decision.

Qualitative Factors

Some of the qualitative factors and our strengths which form the basis of computing the Issue Price are on page 126 of the RHP

Quantitative Factors

Some of the quantitative factors which may form the basis for computing the Issue Price are as follows:

A. Basic and Diluted Earnings Per Equity Share ("EPS"):

Year/Period ended	Basic EPS (in ₹)	Diluted EPS (in ₹)	Weight
March 31, 2026	33.63	33.59	3
March 31, 2025	29.21	29.17	2
March 31, 2024	23.96	23.93	1
Weighted Average	**30.55**	**30.51**	
Three months ended June 30, 2026*	8.69	8.68	-
Three months ended June 30, 2025*	7.96	7.95	-

**Not annualised*

Notes:

(1) Basic earnings per share is calculated by dividing the Profit for the year / period as per Restated Consolidated Statement of Profit and Loss attributable to equity shareholders by the weighted average number of Equity Shares.

(2) Diluted earnings per share is calculated by dividing the Profit for the year / period as per Restated Consolidated Statement of Profit and Loss attributable to equity shareholders by the weighted average number of Equity Shares outstanding plus the weighted average number of potential equity shares on account of employee stock option plan.

B. Price/Earning ("P/E") ratio in relation to the Price Band of ₹ 1,065 to ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share:

Particulars	P/E at the Floor Price (no. of times)	P/E at the Cap Price (no. of times)
Based on basic EPS for Fiscal 2026	31.67	33.27
Based on diluted EPS for Fiscal 2026	31.71	33.31

C. Industry Peer P/E ratio

Particulars	P/E ratio^
Highest	40.71
Lowest[1&2]	3.99
Average	22.35

^ P/E ratio of peer companies has been considered above for determining the highest, lowest and average Industry P/E. The P/E ratio of the peer companies has been computed based on the closing market price of the equity shares of respective peer companies on NSE as on October 13, 2026, divided by diluted EPS for fiscal ended March 31, 2026.

Note 1: Refers to the P/E ratio of Vodafone Idea Limited. The profit after tax of Vodafone Idea Limited for the year ended March 31, 2026, of ₹ 345,520 million includes exceptional items aggregating to ₹ 586,070 million. The profit after tax and the exceptional items for the year ended March 31, 2026, were ₹ 34,552 crore and ₹ 58,607 crore respectively (these have been multiplied by 10 to reflect the same in ₹ million)

Note 2: If we exclude such exceptional item then the P/E ratio for Vodafone Idea Limited would not be comparable and the average P/E ratio for the industry would be the same as the Highest P/E ratio.

D. Return on Average Net Worth ("RoNW"):

Financial Year/Period Ended	RoNW (%)	Weight
March 31, 2026	9.42	3
March 31, 2025	8.97	2
March 31, 2024	8.02	1
Weighted Average	**9.04**	
Three months ended June 30, 2026*	2.30	-
Three months ended June 30, 2025*	2.31	-

**Not annualised*

Notes:

(1) Return on Average Net Worth is calculated as Net Profit for the year / period attributable to the owners of the Company based on the Restated Consolidated Financial Information divided by the average Net Worth for the year / period.

(2) Net Worth refers to the aggregate value of the paid-up share capital and all reserves created out of the profits and securities premium account and debit or credit balance of profit and loss account, after deducting the aggregate value of the accumulated losses, deferred expenditure and miscellaneous expenditure not written off, as per the audited balance sheet, but does not include reserves created out of revaluation of assets, write-back of depreciation and amalgamation. Net Worth has been calculated as the aggregate of equity share capital and other equity excluding other comprehensive income.

(3) Average Net Worth is computed as average of Net Worth as at the beginning and end of the year/period.

(4) For further details, see "Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations – Non-GAAP Measures – Return on Average Net Worth and Net Asset Value Per Equity Share" on page 451 of the RHP.

E. Net Asset Value ("NAV") per Equity Share:

NAV per Equity Share	(in ₹)
As on March 31, 2026	373.66
As on June 30, 2026	382.34
After the Issue	
- At the Floor Price	402.33
- At the Cap Price	403.91
Issue Price*	[●]

** To be determined on conclusion of the Book Building Process*

Notes:

(1) Net Worth has been calculated as the aggregate of equity share capital and other equity excluding other comprehensive income.Net Worth refers to the aggregate value of the paid-up share capital and all reserves created out of the profits and securities premium account and debit or credit balance of profit and loss account, after deducting the aggregate value of the accumulated losses, deferred expenditure and miscellaneous expenditure not written off, as per the audited balance sheet, but does not include reserves created out of revaluation of assets, write-back of depreciation and amalgamation.

(2) Net Asset Value per Equity Share is calculated by dividing Net Worth as of the end of year/period by the number of Equity Shares outstanding at the end of the year/period.

(3) For further details, see "Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations – Non-GAAP Measures – Return on Average Net Worth and Net Asset Value Per Equity Share" on page 451 of the RHP.

F. Comparison with accounting ratios:

We are a technology platform company offering digital connectivity and digital services to our customers. Digital connectivity is the key enabler for providing our digital services solutions. We have considered only scaled digital connectivity providers listed in India namely Bharti Airtel Limited and Vodafone Idea Limited as the peer set and have not considered other listed digital connectivity service providers for the purpose of comparing financials and operating data. Following is the comparison of our key accounting ratios with such listed companies:

Particulars	Face value (₹)	Revenue from operations for Fiscal 2026 (in ₹ million)	EPS (Basic) (₹)	EPS (Diluted) (₹)	P/E	Return on Average Net Worth (%) (₹)	NAV per Equity Share (₹)
The Company*	10	1,468,853	33.63	33.59	[●]#	9.42%^	373.66^
Peer Companies							
Bharti Airtel Limited	5	2,109,728[1]	45.96[3]	44.37[3]	40.71 [4]	20.32%[5]	244.60[6]
Vodafone Idea Limited	10	448,730[2]	3.21[3]	3.21[3]	3.99 [4]	NM$	(3.30)[7]

Source: All the financial information for listed peer companies mentioned above is on a consolidated basis and is sourced from the annual report or audited financial statements or audited financial results or quarterly IR pack or quarterly reports of the respective company for the financial year ended March 31, 2026, submitted to the Stock Exchanges.

** Financial information of the Company has been derived from the Restated Consolidated Financial Information.*

 # To be included in the Prospectus based on the Issue Price.

$ Since the Average net-worth of Vodafone Idea Limited is negative, return on average net-worth is not meaningful (NM).

^For further details, see "Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations – Non-GAAP Measures – Return on Average Net Worth and Net Asset Value Per Equity Share" on page 451 of the RHP.

Notes for peer Companies

[1] Revenue from operations for Bharti Airtel Limited is on consolidated basis (including the Africa Business) as reported in the consolidated audited results for the year ended March 31, 2026. Revenue from operations for India (excluding passive infrastructure) for Fiscal 2026 was ₹ 1,403,734 million as reported in the quarterly IR pack for the quarter and the year ended March 31, 2026.

[2] The revenue from operations of Vodafone Idea Limited for the year ended March 31, 2026, as per the audited consolidated financial results was ₹ 44,873 crore which has been multiplied by 10 to reflect the same in ₹ million.

[3] Basic and diluted EPS refers to the basic and diluted EPS sourced from the audited consolidated financial results of the peer companies respectively for the Fiscal ended March 31, 2026.

[4] P/E ratio of peer companies has been computed based on the closing market price of the equity shares of respective peer companies on NSE as on October 13, 2026, divided by diluted EPS for fiscal ended March 31, 2026.

[5] Return on average net worth (%) for Bharti Airtel Limited is computed as net income (after exceptional items) attributable to the owners for the year ended March 31, 2026, divided by average of consolidated total equity attributable to the owners as on March 31, 2026, and March 31, 2025.

[6] Net asset value per equity share for Bharti Airtel Limited is the book value per equity share as disclosed in the quarterly IR pack for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026.

[7] Net asset value per equity share for Vodafone Idea Limited has been computed as total equity as of March 31, 2026, as per the audited consolidated financial results divided by the number of equity shares outstanding as of March 31, 2026.

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

G. Weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA"), floor price and cap price

(a) Price per share of the Company (as adjusted for corporate actions, including split, bonus issuances) based on primary issuances of Equity Shares or convertible securities (excluding issuance of Equity Shares pursuant to a bonus issue or employee stock option scheme, if any) during the 18 months preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, where such issuance is equal to or more than 5% of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of the Company (calculated based on the pre-Issue capital before such transaction(s) and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested) in a single transaction or multiple transactions combined together over a span of rolling 30 days ("Primary Issuances")

Not applicable

(b) Price per share of the Company (as adjusted for corporate actions, including bonus issuances) based on secondary sale or acquisition of equity shares or convertible securities (excluding gifts) involving the Promoter, members of the Promoter Group, and/ or any Shareholders with rights to nominate directors during the 18 months preceding the date of filing of the Red Herring Prospectus, where the acquisition or sale is equal to or more than 5% of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of the Company (calculated based on the pre-Issue capital before such transaction(s) and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested), in a single transaction or multiple transactions combined together over a span of rolling 30 days ("Secondary Transactions")

Not applicable

(c) Since there are no such transactions to report under (a) and (b), therefore the following are the details of the price per share of the Company basis the last five primary or secondary transactions (secondary transactions where the Promoter, Promoter Group, and/ or Shareholders with the rights to nominate directors on the Board, are a party to the transaction), not older than three years prior to the date of filing of the Red Herring Prospectus irrespective of the size of transactions:

Not applicable

(d) Weighted average cost of acquisition, floor price and cap price

Past transactions	Weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (₹)	Floor Price ₹ 1,065 (in times)	Cap Price ₹ 1,119 (in times)
Weighted average cost of acquisition of Primary Issuances	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
Weighted average cost of acquisition of Secondary Transactions	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
Since there were no Primary Issuance or Secondary Transactions of equity shares of the Company as mentioned above, the information of price per share of the Company based on the last five secondary transactions where the Promoter, Promoter Group, and/ or Shareholders with the rights to nominate directors on the Board, are a party to the transaction, during the last three years preceding to the date of filing of the Red Herring Prospectus irrespective of the size of the transaction:			
- Based on primary issuances	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
- Based on secondary transactions	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

H. Justification for Basis for Issue Price

Detailed explanation for Issue Price / Cap Price along with our Company's KPIs and financial ratios for the Fiscals and periods presented in the Restated Consolidated Financial Information and in view of the external factors which may have influenced the pricing of the Issue, if any:

- **Technology company with inherent engineering and full-stack proprietary capabilities:** We are the only digital connectivity provider globally with an end-to-end 5G SA technology stack deployed at nationwide scale - including a 4G+5G combination core, 5G devices and OSS and BSS operating systems, helping India become only the fifth country globally to possess such indigenous 5G capability, as per the Analysys Mason Report. We are the only Indian company to be among the top 20 companies globally in the WIPO PCT rankings in 2025
- **Transforming digital connectivity and digital services in India:** We were the first to roll out 4G VoLTE connectivity at scale in India and the first company to achieve 100 million 4G customers in less than 180 days from commercial launch of our services, as per the Analysys Mason Report. We are the first operator in India to launch a standalone 5G network, as per the Analysys Mason Report and have also enabled large scale, rapid 5G adoption in India. As of June 30, 2026, RJIL had 533.3 million customers, including 284.9 million 5G customers. As of June 30, 2026, 28.6 million customers subscribe to our JioFiber or JioAirFiber services, making us the largest fixed broadband service provider in India, as per the Analysys Mason Report
- **We have a culture of innovation which drives our execution engine excellence:** We have introduced several innovations such as JioGridX, which records 82 parameters at a given location across speed, coverage and user traffic and enables automated and real-time improvement actions for seamless work orders, created a Digital twin which helps in planning network rollouts and remotely guide field engineers for first time right installations and Jio Brain AI enabling autonomous decision making and real-time network optimisation.
- **The nation scale, digital gateway to India:** Consumers use the MyJio App to discover and access a large library of digital services. MyJio App had 227.6 million and 215.9 million average Monthly Active Users in the three months ended June 30, 2026, and Fiscal 2026 respectively. - As of June 30, 2026, over 1,000 digital TV channels and 15 OTT services are being offered with our JioFiber and JioAirFiber packages. -We also use physical touchpoints, such as 1,059 Jio Centres and 6,322 Jio Points as of June 30, 2026, supported by the feet-on-street network which includes a mix of employees and contractors to distribute our digital services.
- **Future ready network infrastructure:** As of June 30, 2026, we have access to a pan-India network of 360,537 Network Towers, majority of which are fiberized. We hold 26,800.8 MHz spectrum, with average remaining life of approximately15.8 years as of June 30, 2026. We have access to over 1.0 million route kilometres (or 30.0+ million fiber pair kilometres of which more than 60% is intracity) of fibre network as per the Analysys Mason Report. We are the only operator in India to have spectrum in low-band, mid-band and millimetre wave (700 MHz, 3300 MHz and 26GHz) spectrum for 5G, as per the Analysys Mason Report
- **Proven track record of scale, growth and profitability with a strong balance sheet:** In the three months ended June 30, 2026 and Fiscal 2026, we generated total revenue from operations of ₹ 391,729 million and ₹ 1,468,853 million, EBITDA of ₹ 208,645 million and ₹ 762,554 million, and EBITDA margin of 53.26% and 51.91% respectively. We have achieved this scale in just 10 years since the launch of digital connectivity services by RJIL in 2016. We have a strong balance sheet which is reflected in our improving leverage position – our Net Leverage reduced from 0.88x in Fiscal 2024 to 0.36x in Fiscal 2026

ASBA* Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

* Applications Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account.

Mandatory in public issues.
No cheque will be accepted.

UPI UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI - Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

*ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Eligible Employees in the Employee Reservation Portion (iii) Eligible Shareholders in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion; (iv) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 0.50 million in the Non-Institutional Portion. For more details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section **"Issue Procedure"** on page 534 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India (**"AIBI"**) and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (**"SEBI"**) at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi= yes&intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited, Axis Bank Limited and State Bank of India have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Issue, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Issue related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*^	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 5,00,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opens on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1.0 million provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "*History and Certain Corporate Matters*" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled "*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*" on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus shall be delivered to the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: jpl_ipo@morganstanley.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investors_india@morganstanley.com
Website: https://www.morganstanley.com/india
Contact Person: Keyur Thakar/ Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011203

BofA Securities India Limited
Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6632 8000
E-mail: dg.jpl_ipo@bofa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com
Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia
Contact Person: Sahil H. Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011625

Axis Capital Limited
1st Floor, Axis House
P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4325 2183
E-mail: jio.ipo@axiscap.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaints@axiscap.in
Website: www.axiscapital.co.in
Contact Person: Sanaea Sumondy/ Simran Gadh
SEBI Registration No: INM000012029

BNP Paribas
1, North Avenue Maker Maxity
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3370 4000
E-mail: LIST.CIB.JioIPO@asia.bnpparibas.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com
Website: www.bnpparibas.co.in
Contact Person: Ankur Thacker
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011534

Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited
1202, 12th Floor, First International Financial Center, G Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 098
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6175 9999
E-mail: jio.ipo@citi.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors.cgmib@citi.com
Website: www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking
Contact Person: Naman Kulshreshtha
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010718

CLSA India Private Limited
8/F Dalamal House
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6650 5050
E-mail: jio.ipo@clsa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.helpdesk@clsa.com
Website: www.india.clsa.com
Contact Person: Prachi Chandgothia
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010619

DAM Capital Advisors Limited
Altimus 2202, Level 22
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4202 2500
E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
Website: www.damcapital.in
Contact Person: Aanchal Wagle/ Jay Shah
SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli
Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6616 9000
E-mail: jioipo@gs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Contact Person: Saurav S
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011054

HDFC Bank Limited
Investment Banking Group
Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7th Floor, Tower 2 and 3
One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3395 8233
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@hdfc.bank.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com
Website: www.hdfc.bank.in
Contact Person: Bharti Ranga/ Souradeep Ghosh
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: jplipo@hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353

ICICI Securities Limited
Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6807 7100
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@icicisecurities.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com
Website: www.icicisecurities.com
Contact Person: Ramesh Vaswana / Soumavo Sarkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179

IIFL Capital Services Limited
(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)
24th Floor, One Lodha Place
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4646 4728
E-mail: jio.ipo@iiflcap.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com
Website: www.iiflcapital.com
Contact Person: Gaurav Mittal/ Pawan Kumar Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940

Jefferies India Private Limited
Level 16, Express Towers
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4356 6000
E-mail: Jio.Platforms.IPO@jefferies.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: jipl.grievance@jefferies.com
Website: www.jefferies.com
Contact Person: Akshat Shah/ Meghna Biju
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011443

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: jpl.ipo@jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361

J.P. Morgan India Private Limited
J.P. Morgan Towers
Off C.S.T Road, Kalina, Santacruz (East),
Mumbai - 400 098 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6157 3000
E-mail: JIO_IPO@jpmorgan.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investorsmb.jpmipl@jpmorgan.com
Website: www.jpmipl.com
Contact Person: Shivam Goel/ Rishank Chheda
SEBI Registration No.: INM000002970

SBI Capital Markets Limited
1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, G Block,
Parinee Crescenzo, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4006 9807
E-mail: jio.ipo@sbicaps.com
Website: www.sbicaps.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investor.relations@sbicaps.com
Contact Person: Krithika Shetty/ Prashant Patankar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531

UBS Securities India Private Limited
Unit 2901, Level 29, Altimus,
Dr. GM Gokhale Marg /
Pandurang Budhkar Road,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6155 6000
E-mail: OL-jioipo@ubs.com
Website: www.ubs.com/indiaoffers
Investor Grievance E-mail: igbmindia@ubs.com
Contact Person: Vidhit Patni
SEBI Registration No.: INM000013101

360 ONE WAM Limited
360 ONE Centre, Kamala City
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West),
Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4031 7000
Email: jioplatforms.ipo@360.one
Investor Grievance E-mail:
mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one
Website: www.360.one
Contact Person: Devesh Patkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801

REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE

KFin Technologies Limited
Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Gachibowli,
Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally
Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India
Tel: + 91 40 6716 2222/ 1800 309 4001
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
einward.ris@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R
SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

Company Secretary
Ms. Savithri Parekh

Compliance Officer
Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park,
Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli,
Navi Mumbai 400 701Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 7967 0000
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP shall be available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Offer, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, **Tel**: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000**; Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000**; BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000**; Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183**; BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000**; Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999**; CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050**; DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500**; Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000**; HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233**; HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289**; ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100**; IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728**; Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000**; JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030**; J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000**; SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807**; UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000**; and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000**; Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400**, Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** ***(Formerly known as Batlivala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)*** Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number (operational from October 16, 2026 (excluding all public holidays) between 9 am and 6 pm) to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue from October 16, 2026, by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 14, 2026

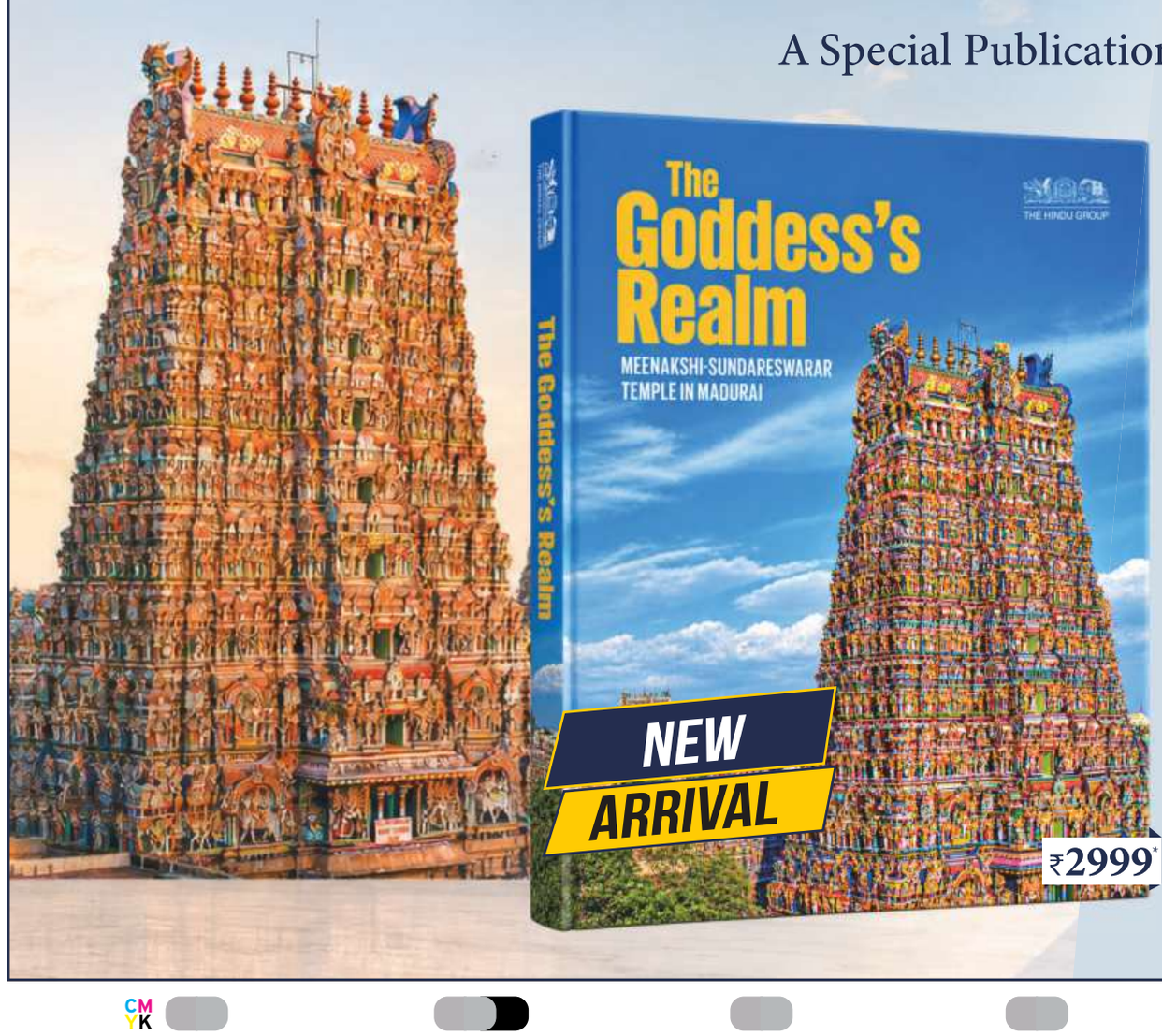
All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them In the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP shall be available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled "**Risk Factors**" on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Issue have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (**"U.S. Securities Act"**) or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) in the United States solely to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from, or not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act, or (ii) outside the United States in "offshore transactions," as defined in, and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of Equity Shares in the United States.

A Special Publication from The Hindu Group

THE HINDU GROUP



The Goddess's Realm is a visual tribute to the magnificent Meenakshi-Sundareswarar Temple in Madurai. Explore its timeless architecture, intricate artistry, stories, and rich cultural heritage.
A celebration of Madurai's divine legacy, beautifully brought to life.

A magnificent tribute to one of India's most revered temples

Richly researched and rigorously documented.

Stunning Visuals that bring the divine legacy to life.

SCAN QR CODE OR VISIT
newsth.live/THBookStore
For bulk booking and enquiries, contact us at bookstore@thehindu.co.in

THG BOOKS

* Shipping charges applicable | Terms and Conditions apply

A Special Publication from The Hindu Group

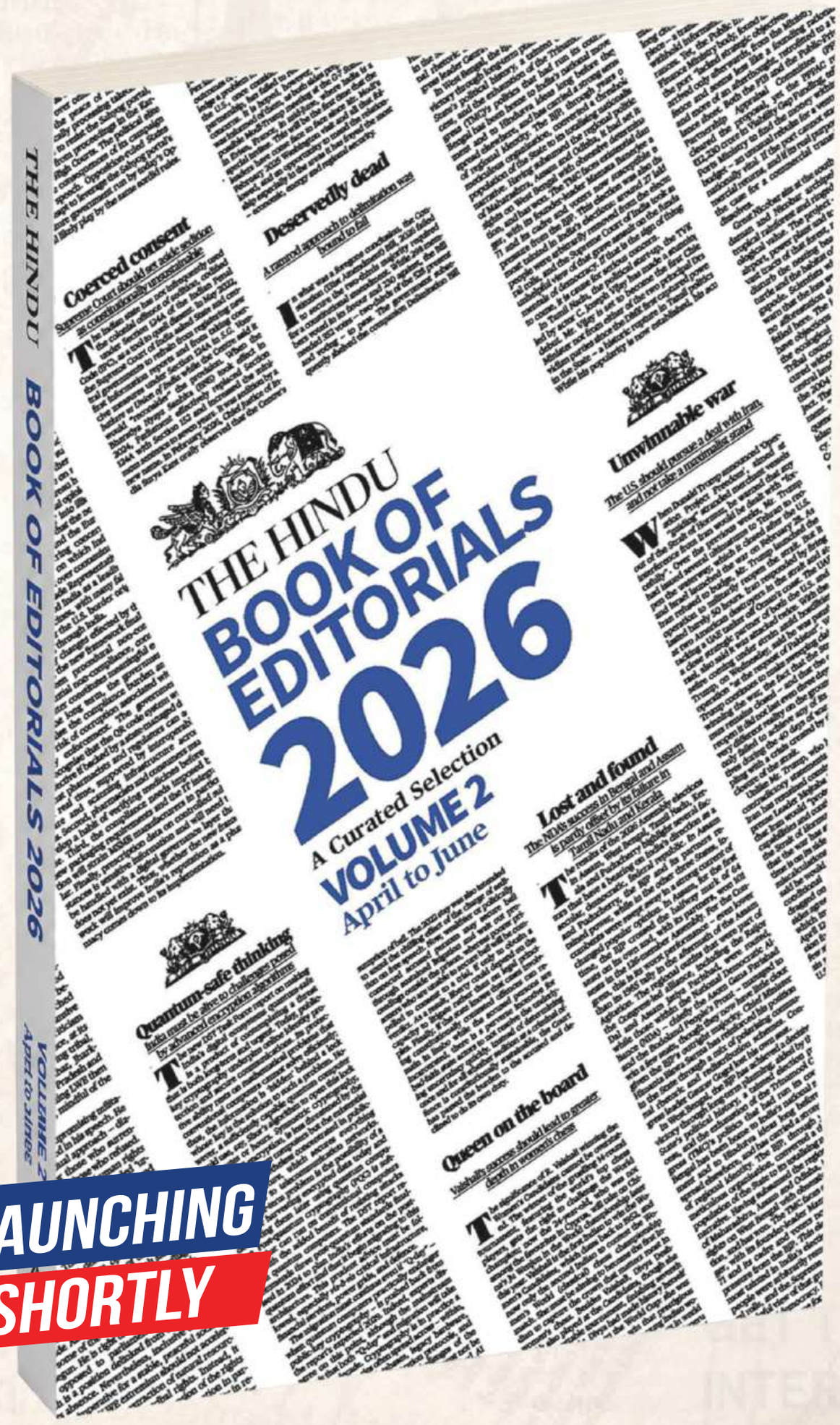
THE HINDU GROUP

The Definitive Guide to the Stories
Behind India's Most Impactful Editorials

The Hindu Book of Editorials 2026 – Volume 2 (April to June) is a carefully curated collection of thought-provoking editorials from The Hindu.
Covering key national and international developments, this volume offers balanced perspectives, deep analysis, and valuable insights into the issues shaping our world.

THE HINDU
BOOK OF EDITORIALS 2026
A Curated Selection
VOLUME 2
April to June

- Curated from The Hindu editorials (April–June 2026)
- In-depth analysis of major national and global events
- Valuable resource for UPSC, State PSC, and competitive exam aspirants
- Ideal for professionals, students, researchers, and avid readers
- Credible journalism with balanced viewpoints and expert perspectives



LAUNCHING SHORTLY

Pre-Launch Offer * ~~₹149~~ * ₹120

* Shipping charges applicable | Terms and Conditions apply

PRE-BOOK YOUR COPY TODAY!

TO AVAIL THIS LIMITED PERIOD OFFER, SCAN QR CODE OR VISIT

newsth.live/THBookStore

For bulk booking and enquiries, contact us at bookstore@thehindu.co.in

THG BOOKS

THURSDAY
October 15, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
28 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 149 • No. 245
Regd. TN/ARD/110/2024-2026
RNI No. 1001/1957

To subscribe, give a missed call at 9828331787 or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna

OIL TARGETS

Houthis vow more hits on Saudi Arabian infra

WORLD » PAGE 14

ENDANGERED HABITAT

Mining project threatens rare geckos

NEWS » PAGE 12

'STRATEGIC RESTRUCTURING'

Cabinet approves IDBI Bank sale to Fairfax

BUSINESS » PAGE 13

CONTROVERSIAL RULING

A split verdict, faltering remedies

EC appointments case underscores limits of judicial intervention

EDITORIAL » PAGE 8

FIGHTING BACK

Hope and Paul shine as Windies pull level

SPORT » PAGE 15

NEARBY

Vijay launches ₹3,108-cr. project for water supply

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday laid the foundation stone for a project to interlink various water sources in Chennai at a cost of ₹3,108.55 crore, aiming at ensuring an equitable supply of drinking water. » PAGE 2

State Board Class 12 exams from March 3 to 29

CHENNAI
The State Board public examinations for Class 12 students will be conducted from March 3 to March 29 in 2027, the School Education Department has said. » PAGE 6

METROPLUS » 4 PAGES

Many youth held as SIR protests rock capital for fifth straight day

Youth and student groups march through Delhi amid a large contingent of security forces demanding scrapping of SIR, resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, and reinstatement of Jantar Mantar as protest site; protesters allege being beaten up

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Protesters climbed over barricades, slogans pierced through the din of police announcements, and detention buses filled up on Wednesday as hundreds of people took to the streets of central Delhi against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The fifth consecutive day of demonstrations saw separate marches by members of the Youth Congress and those of the Students' Federation of India and the Democratic Youth Federation of India.

The Left groups protested on Firoz Shah Road before a large contingent of police personnel and security forces moved in to control the crowd.

Pushing forward: Members of Left outfits protest in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

"*Vote chor, gaddi chhod* (vote thief, vacate your seat)," the protesters shouted while placards carried messages such as "We are Indians, not terrorists" and "Protest, not silence, is the lifeblood of democracy". The protesters targeted Mr. Kumar and opposed the removal of Jantar Mantar's status as a designated protest site.

The situation escalated as police personnel began detaining protesters who sat on the road, with several being bundled into detention vehicles. Some protesters alleged being beaten up. The number of people detained was not made available at the time of going to press.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10
EDITORIAL
» PAGE 8
MORE REPORTS ON
» PAGE 11

CJP leaders sent to jail for going to Jantar Mantar

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were remanded to five days in judicial custody on Wednesday for allegedly entering Jantar Mantar area, which has been denotified as a designated protest site. The police have registered two FIRs over allegations of trespass and other charges.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 11

SC agrees to 'take care' of Delhi voters whose names were removed

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to intervene for Delhi's voters whose names were deleted from the electoral roll pursuant to the special intensive revision (SIR), and are now effectively being asked by the Election Commission of India (ECI) to misrepresent themselves as fresh applicants.

A Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant was informed by advocates Prashant Bhushan and Neha Rathi, appearing for petitioners Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri, that voters seeking to restore their names in the roll are being compelled by the ECI to file a declaration that they had never voted before or face imprisonment. "We are thinking of passing an order which will take care of this issue," the CJI remarked.

> The EC should either allow them [voters seeking re-inclusion] to file Form 8 or create a new form for voters deleted in the SIR
>
> **PRASHANT BHUSHAN**
> Advocate for petitioners

"The ECI should either allow them to file Form 8 [for shifted voters] or create a new form for voters deleted in the SIR," Mr. Bhushan submitted. He said the Delhi SIR case was listed on October 30, but that would be too late as the last date for filing claims and objections was the same day. The Chief Justice advanced the date of hearing to October 28.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

India's exports to China grow 40%, deficit crosses $100 bn

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

India's exports to China grew 40% in the first three quarters of 2026 to around $20 billion, although the trade deficit with the neighbouring country has continued to widen, already crossing $100 billion this year, according to data released on Wednesday by China's General Administration of Customs.

India's two-way trade with China between January and September this year was up 25.4% to $144.45 billion, while India's imports from China continued to rise, up 23.3% to $125.19 billion.

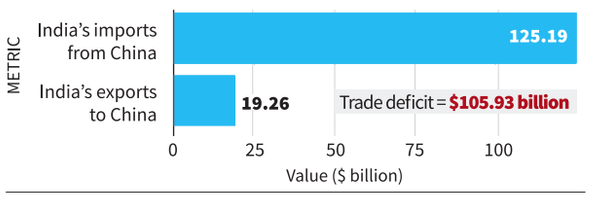
Indian exports to China registered a robust 40.7% growth, albeit from a much smaller base, to $19.26 billion after the first three quarters, already reaching last year's total. The trade deficit stood at $105.93 billion and is on track to surpass last year's record figure of $116.12 billion.

Indian officials say that while there is no expectation for trade to be perfectly balanced, the broader concern is the heavily lopsided trade relationship, a lack of market access for Indian firms, and the nature of India's imports.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Widening gap

India's two-way trade with China rose **25.4% year-on-year to $144.45 billion in Jan.-Sept. 2026.** While India's exports grew 40.7% to $19.26 billion, **imports rose 23.3% to $125.19 billion**, pushing the trade deficit to $105.93 billion



Wholesale inflation rises to 49-month high of 11.4%

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Wholesale price inflation rose to 11.4% in September, a record-breaking high during the two-and-a-half years for which there is data for the new series of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI), and a 49-month-high as per the much longer old series.

Inflation in the food articles component of the WPI came in at 8.1% in September, up sharply from 5.7% in the previous month. The non-food primary articles segment also saw elevated inflation levels of 10.3%.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 13

Northeast monsoon to set in over T.N. today, bring widespread rain till October 20: RMC

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

After a prolonged spell of warm weather, several parts of Tamil Nadu are in for a respite, as the Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC) has forecast the onset of the Northeast monsoon over the southern peninsula on Thursday.

Chennai experienced intermittent showers and a cloudy sky on Wednesday. Moderate rainfall is expected to continue on Thursday, with the temperature likely to remain close to the normal range of 33-34 degrees Celsius.

Nagapattinam and Karaikal received rainfall of 9 cm and 8 cm each till 6 p.m., while various other places such as Dharmapuri, Virudhunagar, and Ramanathapuram received light to moderate rainfall.

Wet spell: Chennai experienced intermittent showers and a cloudy sky on Wednesday. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

The Northeast monsoon is likely to bring fairly widespread rainfall over the State till October 20, putting an end to the extended spell of soaring temperatures in interior districts. On Wednesday, Erode recorded the highest maximum temperature of 37.8 degrees Celsius in the State.

Monsoon indicator

RMC officials said the reversal of the wind pattern to Easterlies had begun, indicating the arrival of monsoon. Fairly widespread rain has already begun in south coastal Tamil Nadu and is expected to spread to the north coastal region and other areas as well.

Southwest monsoon is expected to retreat entirely from the country on Thursday.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 6

INBRIEF

Ministers to monitor monsoon preparedness in GCC zones

Ministers and senior IAS officers have been appointed to monitor monsoon preparedness and disaster response across all 15 zones of the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC). A total of 219 flood-prone areas have been identified and emergency resources deployed ahead of the Northeast monsoon. At a review meeting chaired by Minister for Public Works and Sports Development Aadhav Arjuna at the Ripon Buildings on Wednesday, officials were instructed to ensure that relief measures were implemented in coordination with various departments. Of the 219 waterlogging locations identified, new storm-water drains have been constructed at 93 locations, work is under way at 19, water collection and pumping sumps have been established at 21, and motor pumps have been kept ready at 62. Preventive measures have been taken at the remaining 24 locations. Desilting work has been completed on 1,583.62 km of the 1,669-km storm-water drain network.

Vijay launches ₹3,108-cr. ring main pipeline project for equitable drinking water supply

The project will interlink all nine water treatment facilities to ensure uninterrupted supply to residents of the GCC area. It involves laying 91.2 km of interconnected pipelines and installing instruments to measure water pressure, flow, and quality at treatment plants and distribution stations

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday laid the foundation stone for a ring main pipeline system, a project to interlink various water sources in Chennai at a cost of ₹3,108.55 crore.

The project aims at providing an equitable and uninterrupted supply of drinking water to residents of the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) area.

It is being implemented by the Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board (CMWSSB).

Mr. Vijay launched the closed circular loop project at the Chennai Metrowater pumping station in Sholinganallur.

According to an official release, the city's major water sources include Puzhal, Cholavaram, Veeranam, Chembarambakkam, Thervoy Kandigai-Kannankottai and Poondi reservoirs, and Krishna river. Water from these sources is being treated at the treatment plants in Puzhal, Surapet, Kilpauk, Chembarambakkam and Veeranam.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay laying the foundation for the closed circular loop project at the Chennai Metrowater pumping station in Sholinganallur on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The supply infrastructure also includes a desalination plant at Minjur and two desalination plants at Nemmeli.

From these sources, the CMWSSB currently supplies 1,260 million litres per day (MLD) of treated and safe drinking water through 143 distribution stations to meet the needs of approximately 91 lakh people in the GCC area.

At present, the infrastructure is designed to supply water from individual treatment plants to designated areas of the city through primary pipelines. However, there is no adequate alternative arrangement to supply water if a disruption occurs at any of the water sources or treatment facilities.

To address this issue, the project will interconnect all nine treatment facilities in the city – five water treatment plants, three desalination plants, and the 400 MLD desalination plant being constructed at Perur.

Financial aid

The project, being implemented with financial assistance from the Asian Development Bank, involves the laying of 91.2 km of interconnected pipelines, 64.2 km of water transmission pipelines, and 2.65 km of pumping mains.

Instruments to measure water pressure, flow, and quality at treatment plants and distribution stations, along with Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition systems, will also be installed as part of the project to enable continuous monitoring from the control room at the Chennai Metrowater headquarters.

Ministers N. Anand, Aadhav Arjuna, P. Venkataramanan, Rajmohan, N. Marie Wilson and R. Kumar; Additional Chief Secretary to the Municipal Administration and Water Supply Department Gagandeep Singh Bedi, senior officials, and MLAs were present at the launch.

Flood mitigation

Later, the Chief Minister also inspected the ongoing flood mitigation measures at Okiyam Maduvu in Karapakkam.

According to an official release, Mr. Vijay instructed officials to expedite the ongoing works.

Elderly man regains movement after spine surgery

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 65-year-old man who had sustained an acute spinal injury after a fall, and then suffered quadriparesis (weakness in all four limbs), was treated at Dr. Mehta's Hospitals, Velappanchavadi.

At a press conference on Wednesday, Ganesh Kumar, consultant spine surgeon, said the patient previously had chronic neck pain, but did not get it treated. After the fall, he was unable to move and was brought to Chennai by train. He was found to have cervical ossification of the posterior longitudinal ligament, a rare progressive condition in which the flexible ligament that runs along the back of the spine becomes calcified. This gradually narrowed the spinal canal, placing pressure on the spinal cord.

Dr. Kumar and his team performed a cervical spine procedure using intraoperative neuromonitoring, involving posterior decompression to relieve pressure on the spinal cord. The patient is now able to walk independently and has regained fine motor skills, Dr. Kumar said. S. Ramesh Babu, medical director, said the case highlighted multidisciplinary team work. Leena Chandrasekaran, head, nursing operations, was present.

Ganesh Kumar, consultant spine surgeon at Dr. Metha's Hospitals, speaking to presspersons on the spine surgery at the hospital in Chetpet on Wednesday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

TANKER Foundation invites nominees for annual award

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The TANKER Foundation has invited nominations for its annual awards for service and research.

The eligibility criteria for The Renny Abraham TANKER Foundation Love For Service Award 2027 include being a medical doctor and a resident of India engaged in community service for at least five years.

Additionally, TANKER foundation and the K.V. George Foundation have invited applications for the K.V. George Kottukulam Memorial TANKER Foundation Young Investigator Award 2027 for young researchers in nephrology.

The eligibility criteria include being below 45 years of age; the primary researcher must have been a major contributor; and having conducted the research in India.

The last date for submission is December 15, 2026.

For details, contact 044-28341635/43090998 or e-mail at info@tankerfoundation.org. The awards will be presented in January 2027.

झारखण्ड सरकार
स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के सह–प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों (बैक्लॉग) पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु विज्ञापन।

स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, झारखण्ड के नियंत्रणाधीन शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, धनबाद, एम०जी०एम० चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, जमशेदपुर, फुलो झानो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, दुमका, मेदिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, पलामू तथा शेख भिखारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, हजारीबाग के विभिन्न विभागों में विभागवार सह–प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर (बैक्लॉग) Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।

विभागवार सह–प्राध्यापक पद की रिक्ति की विवरणी निम्नांकित है जो अधिक /कम हो सकती है–

क्र०सं०	विभाग का नाम	कुल रिक्ति	ST.	SC	BC-I	BC-II
1	माइक्रोबायोलॉजी	1	0	0	1	0
2	फार्माकोलॉजी	1	0	0	1	0
3	पी०एस०एम०	2	1	1	0	0
4	नेत्र	1	0	1	0	0
5	निश्चेतना	3	0	1	1	1
6	मनोरोग	2	1	0	1	0
7	दन्त	2	1	1	0	0
Total		12	12	3	4	4

2. अर्हता– सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु एम०सी०आई / एन०एम०सी० के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव लागू होगा।

3. चयन का आधार– Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु गठित चयन समिति द्वारा विहित प्रक्रिया के अन्तर्गत तत्संबंधी अभिलेखों की जाँच की जायेगी। तदनुसार विभागवार रिक्ति के विरूद्ध चयनित अभ्यर्थियों के नाम की अनुशंसा की जायेगी।

4. नियुक्ति की शर्ते–

a) सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने के लिए एम०सी०आई / एन०एम०सी० के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव संबंधी प्रावधान लागू होंगे।

b) चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर पदधारकों को समय–समय पर वित्त विभाग द्वारा दिये गये परामर्श के अनुरूप मासिक मानदेय देय होगा। इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता/सुविधा देय नहीं होगा।

c) चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा आधारित सेवाएँ अधिकतम 02 वर्ष अथवा नियमित नियुक्ति / प्रोन्नति, जो पहले हो, तक अथवा 70 वर्ष की आयु तक होगी।

d) 02 वर्ष की संविदा अवधि की समाप्ति के उपरांत उनके च्मतवितउंदबम का मूल्यांकन संतोषजनक पाये जाने पर आगामी वर्षों हेतु एक बार में एक वर्ष के लिए सेवा विस्तार वित्त विभाग की सहमति से किया जायेगा।

e) संविदा आधारित यह नियुक्ति पूर्णतः औपबंधिक होगी एवं संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु चयनित अभ्यर्थियों द्वारा भविष्य में नियमित नियुक्ति एवं अन्य सुविधाओं का दावा नहीं किया जायेगा।

f) अवकाश रू– संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षकों को कैलेण्डर वर्ष के लिए राज्य कर्मियों के अनुरूप आकस्मिक अवकाश देय होगा, परन्तु अन्य किसी अवकाश के हकदार नहीं होंगे।

g) किसी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय में संविदा पर नियुक्त सह–प्राध्यापक का स्थानांतरण किसी अन्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल में नहीं किया जायेगा।

h) सभी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों में सह–प्राध्यापक के उतने ही पद इस व्यवस्था से भरें जायेंगे जितना नितान्त आवश्यक होगा। इन पदों पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आरक्षण प्रतिशत का अनुपालन किया जायेगा।

i) वित्त विभाग से प्राप्त परामर्श के आधार पर मंत्रिपरिषद् द्वारा लिए गए निर्णय के अनुसार संविदा राशि निर्धारण के संबंध में विभागीय संकल्प–407 (9) दिनांक 02.09.2021 एवं विभागीय अधिसूचना 357 (9) दिनांक 30.07.2024 के आलोक में सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर नियुक्त पद धारक को मानदेय – सह–प्राध्यापक 2,00,000/– (दो लाख रूपये) देय होगा इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता या सुविधा देय नहीं होगा।

5. अधिकतम उम्र सीमा– संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षकों के लिए अधिकतम उम्र सीमा सभी वर्गों के लिए 70 वर्ष होगी।

6. साक्षात्कार विवरणी – रिक्त पदों पर वाक–इन–इन्टरव्यू रिम्स (RIMS), राँची के प्रशासनिक भवन में निम्नांकित तिथियों में सम्पन्न होगा–

क्र० सं०	पदनाम	दिनांक	समय
01	सह–प्राध्यापक	23.10.2026	10:30am

7. सभी इच्छुक उम्मीदवार वेबसाईट : www-jharkhand-gov-in@health के अन्तर्गत Recruitment पर दिये गये आवेदन पत्र में अंकित सभी वांछित सूचनाएँ पूर्णरूपेण भर कर, सभी मूल प्रमाण पत्रों की स्वअभिप्रमाणित छायाप्रति एवं मूल प्रमाण पत्रों के साथ वाक–इन–इन्टरव्यू आयोजन की तिथि पर ससमय भाग लेंगे।

8. इस विज्ञापन को स्थगित करने, किसी आवेदन को बिना कोई कारण बताए स्वीकृत / अस्वीकृत करने एवं रिक्ति के अवशेष रहने की अवस्था में पुनः विज्ञापन प्रकाशित करने का सर्वाधिकार स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग को सुरक्षित रहेगा।

निदेशक, चिकित्सा शिक्षा,
झारखंड, राँची

PR 391802 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare (26-27)_D

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No. TRD-KGP-W-2026-27-05RT1, Dated 09.10.2026. For and on behalf of President of India, the Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD/Kharagpur-721301 invites e-tender for the following works before 15:00 hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15:30 hrs. **Description of works**: Replacement of Rusted Cantilever assembly under Kharagpur Division; **Tender Value:** ₹ 8,16,81,626.50; **EMD:** ₹ 16,33,600.00; **Cost of tender document** : Nil. **Date of Opening:** 02.11.2026; **Completion Period:** 18 months; **Date of Submission:** Upto 15:00 hrs. of 02.11.2026. Interested Tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details, description and specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this work will be accepted. **Note:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all tenders. **(PR-891)**

SLOPE PROTECTION & OTHER ANCILLARY WORKS

Tender Notice No.: CON/2026/SEP/03, **Dated:** 08-10-2026. E - Tender are invited by the undersigned for the following work. **Tender No.:** CE-CON-DK-PW-2026-08; **Name of Work:** Slope protection work and other ancillary work etc. at Piphema yard in between Ch 59.400 km to Ch 60.700 km in connection with Dimapur (Dhansiri)-Kohima (Zubza) New BG Railway Line Project. **Tender Value :** ₹318,26,12,003.07/-; Date & time of **closing** of tender at **14:30** hrs. on **11-11-2026** and **opening** at **15:30** hrs. on **11-11-2026**. For complete information and tender document of e-Tender will be available in website **www.ireps.gov.in**

Chief Engineer/Con/
Nagaland Project/Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Construction Organization
Serving Customers With A Smile

CLASSIFIEDS MART

TO ADVERTISE VISIT
www.thehinduads.com
CALL: 044-28576300 ▪ TOLL FREE: 1800 102 4161
or Contact your nearest Authorised space sellers

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, SENDHIL M, S/O Mr. MANI, aged about 45 years, residing at No. 299, Gajendiran Salai, Co–operative Nagar, Thiruverkadu, Chennai –600077.Henceforth to be known as Senthil Mani. Vide affidavit dated 10/09/2026

I, BADRINATHAN ASARI B S/o. Balasubramanian, was born on 06 th july 2002, (Birth Place - Belapur, Maharastra) residing at No.53, 3rd Main Road, Annamalai Nagar, Avadi, Tiruvallur - 600054, Tiruvallur District, Tamil Nadu State, shall henceforth be known as, BADRINATHAN B, BADRINATHAN ASARI B, THOOTHUKUDI.

I, RAVIN V R, S/o. Ranjith Kumar, Residing No.10, 6th Street, Nagammai Nagar, Railway Carshed Complex, Tiruvallur, Tamilnadu – 600109, Hereby Solemnly Affirm and Sincerely State as Follows. I State that Correct Name is RAVIN V R in Aadhar Card, Pan Card & Bank Account. But Wrongly Mentioned in Educational Certificate as RAVIN R. I state that RAVIN V R and RAVIN R Denotes Me Only.

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Umashankar S, Son of Thiru Selvakumar born on 1st sep 1991, residing at No 46/9 Ram Nagar 3rd main road peravallur chennai 600082 shall henceforth be known as "S UMA SHANKAR"

OLD AGE HOME

SV HOME for Aged Along with Free Hospital Facility. 50/88,Panchaliamman Kovil Str Arumbakkam. 99406 83788

FURNITURE

ALL SOFAS, All Recliners,Recondition,Reupholstery KNS Rajan 7667133233

HEALTH

HAPPY FOOT Reflexology. @ Shenoy Ngr. 60min– 999/– 9042 18 28 28

BODY MASSAGES Avl at Alwarpet @ PIVOT SPA. Ct: 97909 67299

PEST CONTROL

NETLON SAINTGOBAIN SS Doortype SV Trading Authorised Dealer:9940386715

UJVN LTD.
H.O.: 'UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. : U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website : www.ujvnl.com

Letter No 947 **Date Extension Notice-07** Dated 14.10.2026

Due to unavoidable circumstances, due dates in respect of online Bid Identification No. T-01/EE(Solar)/2026-27 are revised as follows:
Last Date /Time of Receipt of bid on the portal :28-10-2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.
Last Date /Time of submission of bid in Office : 30-10-2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
Date of opening of the bid on website : 30-10-2026 from 13:00 Hrs.
All other details and terms & conditions shall remain same. Detail of subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancelation etc. may be obtained from the website.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal http://uktenders.go.in.

Executive Engineer (Solar)
"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

Govt. of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board
Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010
Website : https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in • e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com

Advt. No. :–JCECEB/46/26 -99 ,Ranchi/Dated: 14/10/2026

Indicative information regarding Stray vacancy Round of Online Counselling for admission in All India Seats in M.B.B.S. & B.D.S. courses

PRESS COMMUNIQUE

In compliance of direction issued by Medical Counselling Committee, New Delhi on 14.09.2026 regarding the NEET-UG Schedule-2026 State Counselling, the Board will organise Stray Vacancy Round of Online Counselling for vacant All India seats in M.B.B.S. & B.D.S. Courses in Laxmi Chandravansi Medical College & Hospital, Palamu; Netaji Subhas Medical College and Hospital, Seraikela-Kharsawan; Sido Kanhu Medical College & Hospital, Dumka; Birsa Institute of Medical Sciences & Research Khunti (for M.B.B.S.) and Vananchal Dental College and Hospital, Garhwa under Babu Dinesh Singh University, Garhwa & Awadh Dental College & Hospital, Jamshedpur (for B.D.S.) of Jharkhand State as per the Updated Schedule Notification which can be seen on the MCC Website.

Detailed information in this regard has been uploaded under "Important Notice" column at **Board's website http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in.**

Sd/-
(Controller of Examination)

PR 391778 (Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board) 26-27 (D)

CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras
Today: 6.00 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall - The Music Academy Madras – HCL Concerts – Sai Sisters – Kiran and Nivi (Vocal), Dr. Keerthana Sankar (Violin), Kaushik Sridhar (Mridangam).

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
East Mada Street, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004
Saroja Parasaran Memorial Endowment "Navaratri Festival" - Oct 11-20, 2026
Today: 15th Oct: 5.00 pm: **Dr.Lalitha Mohan** (Vocal), 6.30 pm: **Smt.Nisha Rajagopal** (Vocal).
Tomorrow: **16th Oct**: 5.00 pm: **Smt.Chaitraa Sairam** (Vocal), 6.30 pm: **Smt. J.B.Keerthana** (Vocal). Prasadham at 8.30pm. **All are welcome.**
In Association with : Nalli

Mahalakshmi Temple & Kalyanamandapam Association No. 11, Park View Street, R.A.puram, Chennai-600028.
Ph: 9941130700
Today 5pm Sri Sai Bhajan by Students of Sri Sathya Sai Institute of Educare, Chromepet. All are Welcome.

Naada Inbam, 24992672
Javinam Endowment concert. "Stree Shakti" by Dr N Bhairavi Vaitheeswaran, Karaikkal S Venkatasubramanian, Kumbakonam K Swaminathan. Today 6.15pm at Ragasudha Hall.

Ramakrishna Mission Students' Home, Mylapore
NAVARATRI UTSAV-2026
at Vivekananda Auditorium from Oct 11 TO 20, 2026
TODAY 15-10-2026, 7.30 a.m.: Discourse on "Sundara Kandam" by Sriman Akkarakani U.Ve. Srinidhi Swamigal. 6.30 p.m.- 7.30 p.m. - Mandolin Samhitha Shivram and Mandolin Shreyes Shivram & Party 7.30 p.m. 8.30 p.m. - Ms. R. Nithya Shree & Party Vocal. All are Welcome!
Best Wishes : Nalli

Sringeri Bharathi Vidyashram, T. Nagar.
Ph: 24348964.
Navarathri Music Concerts, Today 5 p.m, Smt. Valli Anand, Smt. Lakshmi & Smt. Pushkala - Vocal, Chittoor A. Giridar, Satyavageeswaran, 6.30 p.m, Shruthi Shankar Kumar - Vocal, Chidambaram Badrinath, Palani Balaji. All are Welcome.

Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam
15.10.2026 – 7.00 pm – "Sundara Kandam" Upanyasam by Pravachana Tilakam Dhamal S. Ramakrishnan

Sri Thyaga Brahma Gana Sabha (Regd) Vanimahal. Ph 28152166
Today 6.30 pm at Vani Mahal NAVARATHRI FESTIVAL -2026 Vocal Concert by Ms.Archana & Ms.Samanvi, Ms.Sreelakshmi S Bhat(Violin), Sri Hariharan Sundarraman(Mrud.). All are welcome.

MISCELLANEOUS

Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam
15.10.2026 – 9.00 am - Sri Medha Dakshinamurthy, Dhaaranaa Saraswathi, Hayagreeva Mantra Homams; Chandi Parayanam, Veda Parayanam, Sahasranama Archanai, Suvasini & Kanya Pooja; 12.30 p.m –Annadhanam; 6.30 pm – Kamadhenu Vahana Alankaram

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
☎ 044-28576300
☎ Toll Free
1800 102 4161

INBRIEF

Silent demonstration staged against police action in Delhi

A group of young women wearing masks of Prime Minister Narendra Modi staged a silent flash protest at Uptown Kathipara in Chennai on Tuesday night, walking through the busy food court holding placards criticising the Union government. They condemned the police action on protesters in Delhi, who were demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The silent protest sought to draw parallels between the Emergency declared in 1975 and what the protesters described as the present situation in the country, alleging that young people were being detained, assaulted, and booked for questioning the government. They contended that the exercise of State power against peaceful protesters amounted to an "undeclared emergency". Radhika Ganesh, cultural and political activist, said, "The protest was directed at the Union government and Prime Minister Narendra Modi. We were questioning the use of state brutality against peaceful protesters, which we believe is unwarranted."

Timings
CHENNAI

THURSDAY, OCT. 15		
RISE	06:00	SET 17:51
RISE	09:50	SET 21:17
FRIDAY, OCT. 16		
RISE	06:00	SET 17:50
RISE	10:42	SET 22:08
SATURDAY, OCT. 17		
RISE	06:00	SET 17:50
RISE	11:32	SET 23:00

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	24
Chennai Airport	36	27
Chennai City	35	28

Chennai Airport Today
34°C The weather will be warm. Night will also be comfortable. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershowers will occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
32°C The weather will be a little warm. Night will also be comfortable. A few spells of light to moderate rain and thundershowers will occur.

© Copyright Skymet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

Madras High Court adjourns Pallikaranai interim Zone of Influence case to November 11

The judges say they will go through the report filed by Tamil Nadu State Wetlands Authority for declaring 36 survey numbers as an interim ZoI, and then pass orders on the next date of hearing

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

Senior counsel told the court that the interim ZoI proposed by the TNSWA was completely acceptable to all the writ petitioners.

The Madras High Court on Wednesday adjourned to November 11, 2026, a batch of cases filed against a construction ban imposed by the National Green Tribunal (NGT) on a one-kilometre radius around the boundaries of the Pallikaranai marshland, a Ramsar site, in Chennai.

First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan said, in the meantime, they would go through a report filed by Tamil Nadu State Wetlands Authority for declaring 36 survey numbers covering 128.19 hectares as an interim Zone of Influence (ZoI).

The judges said that they will seek clarifications, if any, regarding the declaration of an interim ZoI on the next date of hearing and then pass orders with respect to the declaration which could be enforced until the determination of a final ZoI after elaborate studies required to do so.

The case was adjourned after hearing the arguments of Additional Advocates General P.V. Balasubramaniam and T. Gowthaman for TNSWA and Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority respectivley and senior counsel P.S. Raman, V. Prakash and Srinath Sridevan for CREDAI-Chennai and other writ petitioners.

Mr. Raman told the court that the interim ZoI proposed by the TNSWA was completely acceptable to all the writ petitioners before the court. He said, the TNSWA had left a sufficient buffer zone around the existing boundaries of the marshland and then identified the survey numbers which could be declared as interim ZoI.

Existing boundaries

Mr. Balasubramaniam said, the existing boundaries of the marshland itself by itself was not final and that the actual area of the marshland may shrink after final determination. So, the existing buffer zone and interim ZoI would ensure that sufficient extent of the land around the marsh gets protected, he said.

In its latest report filed before the High Court and served on the writ petitioners, the TNSWA had stated the interim ZoI could cover survey numbers 283 and 284(P) in Enjambakkam village, 175(P), 177 and 189 in Karappakkam village and 407(P) in Okkiyam Thoraipakkam village of Sholinganallur Taluk.

Listing out the other parcels of land which could be made part of the interim ZoI, the authority said, survey numbers 57/1 in Perungudi village in Sholinganallur Taluk; survey numbers 439(P), 507/1, 527, 602/7 and 602/8 in Sholinganallur village of Sholinganallur Taluk and survey numbers 537(P), 542 (P) in Perumpakkam village in Tambaram Taluk could be mentioned in the order of the court.

The TNSWA went on to add that even within the interim ZoI, construction activities need not be banned throughout the entire zone and that it could be regulated based on site specific scientific and hydrological characteristics. It said, there could be a prohibition on blocking, diversion or obstruction of estbalished inlet and outlet channels, natural drains or hydrological pathways in the proposed interim ZoI.

"In case of construction, necessary no objection certificate shall be obtained from the district level wetlands management committee in accordance with the proposed regulatory mechanism. The proposed regulatory framework is intended to ensure that developmental activities do not obstruct the natural flow of water into or out of the Pallikaranai Ramsar site or adversely affect its ecological character together with balancing the development needs of the society and the government," the report read.

TNSWA also told the court that the final ZoI shall be determined only after completion of scientific and cadastral exercises and ground truthing in accordance with the Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017 and the guidelines framed under them.

Dignitaries at the launch of JADHU, an AI-powered daily lifeskills platform in Chennai on Wednesday. M. SRINATH

AI platform launched to support children with disabilities in city

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

In a bid to help children with disabilities, Rewin Health, a Chennai-based digital therapeutics company, launched JADHU, an AI-powered daily lifeskills platform in Chennai on Wednesday.

The platform aims to help disabled children, teens and adults build the everyday skills needed to participate independently in daily life.

According to a release, JADHU combines AI-personalised daily programming, virtual reality based real-world practice environments and real-time physiological monitoring to build everyday skills required to participate independently in daily life.

"JADHU exists because too many families in Tamil Nadu are told to wait - for a diagnosis, for a therapy slot, for a professional to have the time to see their child," said Vijay Karunakaran, Founder and Chief Executive Officer, Rewin Health. Referencing a study conducted by them, he said that 83% of parents say what their child learns in therapy does not carry into daily life, and that 72% of families are not in structured therapy at all. "JADHU puts 60 minutes of guided, personalised practice into the home every day, in situations where independence is actually needed, and gives the therapist objective data on what happened in between," he said.

It is designed for children with Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD), ADHD, Oppositional Defiant Disorder (ODD), and other learning differences.

The platform provides a personalised daily programme where after an initial assessment, JADHU generates a new session every morning, two 30-minute blocks a day. It also provides the person with everyday scenarios such as grocery shopping, travelling on a bus to rehearse.

Further, daily practice runs can be done on a smartphone or tablet with interactive scenarios or in a JADHU Viewer for a 360-degree environment, and fully immersive sessions on a Meta Quest headset. Welfare of the Differently-Abled Department Secretary S. Madumathi also took part in the event.

झारखण्ड सरकार
स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के सह–प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु प्रकाशित विज्ञापन सं० – PR 389807 Health Med Edu Family Welfare (26–27) D के अंतर्गत दिनांक – 21.09.2026 को रिम्स के प्रशासनिक भवन में आयोजित Walk In Interview को अपरिहार्य कारणों से रद्द किया जाता है

निदेशक, चिकित्सा शिक्षा
झारखंड
राँची

PR 391734 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare (26-27) D"

PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED,
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033814 www.pstcl.org
O/o: Dy.CE/TS (Design), Telefax: 0175-2207774, E-mail: se-trd@pstcl.org

Notice Inviting E-Tender

Enquiry No.	STQ-5188
Description	Design, Manufacture, testing, supply & delivery of 220V 300Ah & 220V 200Ah Battery Charger
Qty.	220V 300Ah Battery Charger-71 220V 200Ah Battery Charger-14
Last Date & Time for receipt of tender	18-11-2026 up to 11.00AM
Date & Time for Opening of tender	20-11-2026 at 11.00 AM

Detailed NIT/specification may be downloaded from PSTCL e-tendering website **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in.** Corrigendum, if any, will not be published in newspapers. As such the website may be visited regularly for updates.

-sd-
1078/12/2026-27/16152 **Dy. CE/TS (Design), PSTCL, Patiala**

झारखण्ड सरकार, स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के सह–प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों (बैक्लॉग) पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु विज्ञापन।

स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, झारखण्ड के नियंत्रणाधीन शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, धनबाद, एम०जी०एम० चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, जमशेदपुर, फूलो झानो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, दुमका, मेदिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, पलामू तथा शेख भिखारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, हजारीबाग के विभिन्न विभागों में विभागवार सह–प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर (बैक्लॉग) Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।

विभागवार सह–प्राध्यापक पद की रिक्ति की विवरणी निम्नांकित है जो अधिक /कम हो सकती है–

क्र०सं०	विभाग का नाम	कुल रिक्ति	UR	ST	SC	BC-I	EWS
1	एनाटोमी	**4**	2	0	1	1	0
2	फिजियोलॉजी	**2**	1	0	1	0	0
3	बायोकेमेस्ट्री	**1**	1	0	0	0	0
4	पैथोलॉजी	**3**	2	1	0	0	0
5	औषधि	**9**	8	1	0	0	0
6	शिशु रोग	**1**	1	0	0	0	0
7	सर्जरी	**3**	2	1	0	0	0
8	अस्थि	**2**	2	0	0	0	0
9	ई०एन०टी०	**2**	1	0	1	0	0
10	नेत्र	**4**	2	1	0	1	0
11	स्त्री एवं प्रसव	**1**	1	0	0	0	0
12	निश्चेतना	**4**	1	2	0	0	1
13	चर्म एवं रति रोग	**3**	3	0	0	0	0
14	रेडियोलॉजी	**6**	3	1	1	1	0
15	रेडियोथेरेपी	**5**	3	1	0	1	0
16	टी०बी० एण्ड चेस्ट	**1**	1	0	0	0	0
17	फिजिकल मेडिसिन एंड रिहैबिलिटेशन	**2**	1	1	0	0	0
Total		**53**	**35**	**9**	**4**	**4**	**1**

2. अर्हता– सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु एम०सी०आई / एन०एम०सी० के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव लागू होगा।
3. चयन का आधार– Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु गठित चयन समिति द्वारा विहित प्रक्रिया के अन्तर्गत तत्संबंधी अभिलेखों की जाँच की जायेगी। तदनुसार विभागवार रिक्ति के विरूद्ध चयनित अभ्यर्थियों के नाम की अनुशंसा की जायेगी।
4. नियुक्ति की शर्तें–
a) सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने के लिए एम०सी०आई / एन०एम०सी० के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव संबंधी प्रावधान लागू होंगे।
b) चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर पदधारकों को समय–समय पर वित्त विभाग द्वारा दिये गये परामर्श के अनुरूप मासिक मानदेय देय होगा। इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता/सुविधा देय नहीं होगा।
c) चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा आधारित सेवाएँ अधिकतम 02 वर्ष अथवा नियमित नियुक्ति / प्रोन्नति, जो पहले हो, तक अथवा 70 वर्ष की आयु तक होगी।
d) 02 वर्ष की संविदा अवधि की समाप्ति के उपरांत उनके च्मतवितउंदबम का मूल्यांकन संतोषजनक पाये जाने पर आगामी वर्षों हेतु एक बार में एक वर्ष के लिए सेवा विस्तार वित्त विभाग की सहमति से किया जायेगा।
e) संविदा आधारित यह नियुक्ति पूर्णतः औपबंधिक होगी एवं संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु चयनित अभ्यर्थियों द्वारा भविष्य में नियमित नियुक्ति एवं अन्य सुविधाओं का दावा नहीं किया जायेगा।
f) अवकाश रू– संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षकों को कैलेण्डर वर्ष के लिए राज्य कर्मियों के अनुरूप आकस्मिक अवकाश देय होगा, परन्तु अन्य किसी अवकाश के हकदार नहीं होंगे।
g) किसी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय में संविदा पर नियुक्त सह–प्राध्यापक का स्थानांतरण किसी अन्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल में नहीं किया जायेगा।
h) सभी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों में सह–प्राध्यापक के उतने ही पद इस व्यवस्था से भरें जायेंगे जितना नितान्त आवश्यक होगा। इन पदों पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आरक्षण प्रतिशत का अनुपालन किया जायेगा।
i) वित्त विभाग से प्राप्त परामर्श के आधार पर मंत्रिपरिषद् द्वारा लिए गए निर्णय के अनुसार संविदा राशि निर्धारण के संबंध में विभागीय संकल्प–407 (9) दिनांक 02.09.2021 एवं विभागीय अधिसूचना 357 (9) दिनांक 30.07.2024 के आलोक में सह–प्राध्यापक के पद पर नियुक्त पद धारक को मानदेय – सह–प्राध्यापक 2,00,000/– (दो लाख रूपये) देय होगा इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता या सुविधा देय नहीं होगा।
5. अधिकतम उम्र सीमा– संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षकों के लिए अधिकतम उम्र सीमा सभी वर्गों के लिए 70 वर्ष होगी।
6. साक्षात्कार विवरणी – रिक्त पदों पर वाक–इन–इन्टरव्यू रिम्स (RIMS), राँची के प्रशासनिक भवन में निम्नांकित तिथियों में सम्पन्न होगा–

क्र० सं०	पदनाम	दिनांक	समय
01	सह–प्राध्यापक	23.10.2026	10:30am

7. सभी इच्छुक उम्मीदवार वेबसाईट : www-jharkhand-gov-in@health के अन्तर्गत Recruitment पर दिये गये आवेदन पत्र में अंकित सभी वांछित सूचनाएँ पूर्णरूपेण भर कर, सभी मूल प्रमाण पत्रों की स्वअभिप्रमाणित छायाप्रति एवं मूल प्रमाण पत्रों के साथ वाक–इन–इन्टरव्यू आयोजन की तिथि पर ससमय भाग लेंगे।
8. इस विज्ञापन को स्थगित करने, किसी आवेदन को बिना कोई कारण बताए स्वीकृत / अस्वीकृत करने एवं रिक्ति के अवशेष रहने की अवस्था में पुनः विज्ञापन प्रकाशित करने का सर्वाधिकार स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग को सुरक्षित रहेगा।

निदेशक, चिकित्सा शिक्षा,
झारखंड, राँची

PR 391800 (Health Med Edu and Family Welfare) 26-27 (D)

Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin 603209. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

Open platform screen doors, poor signage among issues at Vadapalani Phase II station

Commuters walk long distances to switch between two metro lines as the work on entry/exit of Phase II station is under way; lack of real-time information on trains, safety issues among concerns

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

From delays in the opening of entry/exit, long walks via the skywalk, to poor signage, commuters have been facing a few issues at Vadapalani Metro Rail's Phase II station.

Initial hiccups: Commuters said that signage directing passengers towards the skywalk does not indicate that it leads to the Phase II station.

A commuter asked how the platform doors could be kept open as commuters peep from the edge of the platforms to see whether the train is arriving, risking their safety

Arduous task

Despite the stretch opening ten months past the deadline, work on the entry/exit of Phase II station, part of the newly opened 14.6 km Poonamallee to Vadapalani stretch of the Phase II network, has still not been completed. As a result, all commuters are forced to use the entry/exit of Vadapalani Phase I station located on 100 Feet Road, take a long walk through the skywalk which links the Phase I and Phase II stations, go up two floors to reach the platform and then board the connecting train.

Commuters said that the length of the skywalk could have been shorter, and the signage needs to be improved.

Selva, a resident of Porur, who was returning to the city with his family, took a train from Chennai Central Metro Rail station and arrived at Vadapalani Metro Rail Phase I station. "It is pretty tiring to walk through the skywalk and reach the Phase II station's platform with the baggage. They could have planned a short transit here to connect both the stations. Those who have to pull the baggage, and walk will find it difficult," he said.

Safety concern

The Chennai Metro Rail has introduced half-height platform screen doors at Phase II stations. These doors are meant to serve as protective barriers blocking access to the tracks. They should open only when the train arrives. However, they remain always open at Vadapalani Phase II station. Balaji, another frequent commuter, said that, to make things worse, the platform information display system (PIDS), which should indicate real-time train arrival, too isn't functioning.

"As a result, passengers are clueless about when the train will arrive, and some of them get dangerously close to the platform edge and peep to see whether the train is arriving. The staff have to constantly ask them to move away from the edge of the platform. This doesn't work well during peak hours. How can they keep the platform doors open compromising passenger safety," he asked.

The signage, too, is far from satisfactory. For instance, when passengers enter from the Phase I station, there is signage directing passengers to the skywalk, but it doesn't indicate that it leads to the Phase II station.

First-time passengers may not know that the skywalk takes them to the phase II station, commuters said.

Work on entry/exit

According to Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) officials, work on the entry/exit of the phase II station will be finished in a couple of months. "The signage too will be improved wherever necessary," an official said.

Over 10 lakh psychotropic tablets seized this year: DGP

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu police have seized more than 10 lakh psychotropic tablets this year as part of intensified enforcement, Director General of Police (DGP) Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal said on Wednesday. This marked a significant increase from less than one lakh tablets seized last year, he said.

Mr. Aggarwal was speaking to reporters after flagging off a 14-day National Motorcycle Rally Against Drug Abuse at Marina Beach to mark the birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel. The rally will cover 1,810 km across six States before reaching Ekta Nagar in Gujarat.

Mr. Aggarwal said the police had also seized 23,000 kg of ganja so far this year. "Ganja is coming to Tamil Nadu from Odisha. A special team, led by a Deputy Superintendent of Police, is stationed there permanently. In coordination with Odisha police and Narcotics Control Bureau, we are making efforts to arrest drug traffickers in Odisha. We have also arrested some key accused," he said.

Dismissing allegations that narcotics continue to be sold in the State as baseless, Mr. Aggarwal said the police were focused on dismantling entire networks. He appealed to the public to cooperate with the police in making Tamil Nadu drug-free.

K. Shankar, Additional Director General of Police, Enforcement Bureau, CID, said the State had formed 67 Anti-Narcotic Task Forces and deployed 2,500 personnel at ₹265 crore.

StartupTN
TAMIL NADU STARTUP AND INNOVATION MISSION
(A Section 8, Company under the MSME Department, Government of Tamil Nadu)

Call for Applications – Startup Incentives for Technology Acquisition

StartupTN - Technology Transfer Center invites applications from startups for financial support under the Incentives for Technology Acquisition. The Government of Tamil Nadu has allocated Rs. 50 Lakhs for this initiative.

Eligibility:
- DPIIT-recognised Startups
- Registered in Tamil Nadu
- Formal Technology Licensing agreement with a recognised academic or research institution
- Validated Proof of Concept (or) prototype with a deployment plan

Financial Support Available:
- 50% of the technology acquisition/license cost (or) Rs. 5.00 lakh, whichever is lower

Apply Now: https://form.startuptn.in/TNTTC

For queries, write to: **openinnovation@startuptn.in**

Last date to apply: November 15, 2026

DIPR/892/Display/2026

Sd/-
MD & CEO (FAC), StartupTN

TAMILNADU POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD
PUBLIC NOTICE

Whereas as per Ministry of Environment and Forests, Government of India, New Delhi, Environmental Impact Assessment Notification Number S.O.1533 dated 14.09.2006, Public Hearing at the site or in its close Proximity - District wise is to be carried out in the manner prescribed in Appendix IV of the said Notification for ascertaining concerns of local affected persons, for the projects covered in the schedule of the said Notification.

Whereas the Public Hearing at or in close proximity to the site has to be conducted by the State Pollution Control Board concerned in the specified manner as per paragraph 7(III) sub para (iii) & Appendix-IV of the said Notification.

Whereas, as required, Public Hearing is proposed to be conducted by Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board for the following project on the date, time and venue as mentioned below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Project and Location	Date & Time of Public Hearing	Place of Public Hearing
1	**Proposed Rough stone & Gravel Quarry** **Project 1 Thiru.B.Gopalakrishnan, Rough stone and Gravel Quarry** S.F.No. 50/4, 50/5A, 51/1, 51/2, 51/3, 51/4, 51/5, 51/6, 51/7 and 51/8 over an extent of 2.37.0 Ha in Vadipatti North Village, Palani Taluk, Dindigul District. **Project 2. Thiru.P.Manikandan, Rough stone and Gravel Quarry** S.F.No. 157/2, over an extent of 1.48.00 Ha in Thathanaickenpatti North Village, Palani Taluk, Dindigul District.	**19.11.2026 at 11.00AM**	**Community Complex, R.Vadipatti Village, Palani Taluk. Dindigul District.**

In this connection, it is informed that the Draft Environmental Impact Assessment Report and Executive summary of Environmental Impact Assessment Report in English and Tamil are made available for Public reference at the following places.

1. O/o. District Collector, Dindigul District, Dindigul.
2. District Industries Centre, Dindigul District, Dindigul.
3. Block Development Officer, Palani Panchayat Union, Palani Taluk, Dindigul District.
4. O/o. District Environmental Engineer, Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board, Collector Office Campus, Dindigul.
5. Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board, 76, Mount Salai, Guindy, Chennai – 32.
6. Regional Office, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Nungambakkam, Chennai - 600 034.

Suggestions, Views, Comments and Objection of the Public are invited within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice, by Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board.

All persons including Bonafide Residents, Environmental Groups and others, who are likely to be affected by the project can participate in the Public Hearing and they can also make Oral/Written suggestions to District Environmental Engineer, Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board, Dindigul on the project.

Member Secretary,
Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board,
Chennai – 600 032.

DIPR/896/DISPLAY/2026

IMD to install new radars, strengthen existing network

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) is looking to strengthen its existing radar network alongside installing new radars to improve weather observations and track monsoons.

With the onset of Northeast monsoon on Thursday, the IMD's Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC), Chennai, is maintaining the nearly 24-year-old S-band doppler weather radar in working condition. It is likely to be replaced with a new S-band radar by 2027.

RMC officials said orders have been placed to replace various radars, including in Chennai, Karaikal, Kolkata, and Machilipatnam about six months ago. The supplier is awaiting a component from abroad before assembling the new equipment.

Four new S-Band and X-band radars would be installed at Kanniyakumari, Tiruchi, Yercaud, and Ramanathapuram under the Mission Mausam. X-band radars, which have a weather surveillance range of up to 180 km, would provide accurate observations of extreme weather events, said Sivananda Damodara Pai, Head, RMC.

Mrutyunjay Mohapatra, Director General, IMD, said the country has a network of 52 radars, and would be increased to 132 by 2028. A total of 16 radars would be added in various States by March 2027.

The aim is to ensure a denser radar network along the coast while improving coverage of hilly and urban areas, he said.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY

SMT. K. CHELLAM
(W/o. Late Sri. Alengar Kandaswami Pillai)
DoB 25.5.1939 DoD 14.10.2026
Rituals on
Friday 16.10.2026, 9 am at E-101, 3rd Main Road, Besant Nagar.
9500081262

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

First Anniversary

CA ABRAHAM ZACHARIAH (Lalu)
Chairman, St. Thomas Educational Trust Board Member, Model Education Society
In life, we loved you dearly, In death, we love you still In our hearts you hold a place, no one else will ever fill
Deeply missed by
Shirley, Thushara, Shruthi, Riju, Amara & Zuri

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

13th ANNIVERSARY
15th OCTOBER 2026

Er.M.CHIDAMBARAM
Divisional Engineer, Highways (Rtd), Thangam Colony, Anna Nagar, Chennai
"The seeds of wisdom you planted continue to grow in our hearts"
FONDLY REMEMBERED BY FAMILY MEMBERS

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

12th ANNIVERSARY

29.04.1935 - 15.10.2014
Sri.K.R. NARAYANAN
Rtd. CWS/S.Rly
Missing you so much Tata
By Ramya & Prasanna
9940657984, 9790933226

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

ANNIVERSARY

JANANAM 02.03.1946
MUKTHI 15.10.2000
Sri. R.RAGHURAMAN
In Fond Memory of our Former Joint Managing Director
Sri Lakshmi Saraswathi Textiles (Arni) Ltd.,

B.R. S.L.K.P.T. ESTD 1932

26th ANNIVERSARY
IN TREASURED MEMORY OF

SRI. R. RAGHURAMAN
(former Proprietor)
S.L.K.P.Transports,
Gudiyattam
Fondly remembered by
Staff & Family Members

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
To dedicate a space in this section,
Please contact: **044-28576300** from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161 from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.
For Placing Advertisements Online log on to www.thehinduads.com
DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE FOR ENGINEERING WORK

Sr. No. (1) E-Tender No.: DRM-ENGG-BSP-T-178-26-27, Date: 01.10.2026.
Work: Construction of RUB/LHS in lieu of LC No. 351 at Km.688/25-27 between NIA-AKT under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Central, Bilaspur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 12,30,67,157.90. **Earnest Money Deposit:** ₹ 24,61,400.00. **Completion Period:** 18 Months.

Start Date of Submission of Tender: From **11.00 hours on 13.10.2026. Last Date of Submission of Tender:** Upto **11.00 hours on 27.10.2026.**

The complete information of above e-Tender Notice is available over websites: **https://www.ireps.gov.in** Bids other than e-bids shall not be accepted against above Tender.

Divisional Railway Manager(Engg) CPR/10/PH/443 ***Bilaspur.***

South East Central Railway @secrail

ELECTRICAL TRD WORK AT KATIHAR DIVISION

E-Tender Notice No.: EL_TRD_16_26-27; Dated: 07-10-2026. (BID No.: EL_TRD_16_26-27). E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following work: **Name of work:** Electrical TRD Work in connection with "Comprehensive annual maintenance contract of Control & Relay Panel incorporating Numerical Relays for 25KV AC for TSS & Shunt Capacitor Bank of Traction substation Katihar, Samsi, Dalkhola, Gunjaria, Rangapani, Araria Jn., Bangalbaree, Buniadpur & Kaliaganj under jurisdiction of Katihar Division for a period of 03 (Three) years." (Ashida Make Control & Relay Panel at location Katihar, Samsi, Gunjaria, Rangapani, Araria Jn., Bangalbaree & Buniadpur). **Tender Value:** ₹1,89,00,000/-; **Earnest Money:** ₹2,44,500/-. **E-tender will be closed at** 15:00 hrs.on 29-10-2026 and **Opened at** 15:30 hrs. on 29-10-2026. The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available upto 15:00 hrs. of 29-10-2026 in website http://www.ireps.gov.in

Sr. DEE/TRD/Katihar
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
"Serving Customers with a smile"

Government of Jharkhand
Department of Health, Medical Education and Family Welfare

Press Release

Advertisement for obtaining services on a contractual basis for the vacant posts (Backlog) of Associate Professor of academic cadre in various departments of Government Medical Colleges of the State.

Applications are invited for obtaining services on a contractual basis through a **Walk-In-Interview** for the vacant posts (backlog) of department-wise posts of Associate Professor in various departments of Shahid Nirmal Mahto Medical College and Hospital, Dhanbad; M.G.M. Medical College and Hospital, Jamshedpur; Phulo Jhano Medical College and Hospital, Dumka; Medinirai Medical College and Hospital, Palamu; and Sheikh Bhikhari Medical College and Hospital, Hazaribagh, under the control of the Health, Medical Education and Family Welfare Department, Jharkhand.

The department-wise details of vacancies for the post of Associate Professor are as follows, which may increase or decrease:

S.No.	Name of the Department	Total Vacancies	ST	SC	BC I	BC II
1	Microbiology	1	0	0	1	0
2	Pharmacology	1	0	0	1	0
3	P.S.M.	2	1	1	0	0
4	Ophthalmology (Eye)	1	0	1	0	0
5	Anaesthesia	3	0	1	1	1
6	Psychiatry (Mental Illness)	2	1	0	1	0
7	Dental	2	1	1	0	0
	Total	**12**	**3**	**4**	**4**	**1**

2. Eligibility: The qualifications and desired experience prescribed by the MCI / NMC will be applicable for obtaining services on a contractual basis for the post of Associate Professor.
3. Basis of Selection: Document verification will be conducted under the prescribed process by the selection committee constituted for hiring services on a contractual basis through a Walk-In-Interview. Accordingly, recommendations of the names of selected candidates against the department-wise vacancies will be made.
4. Terms of Appointment:
a) For obtaining services on a contractual basis for the post of Associate Professor, the provisions regarding qualifications and desired experience prescribed by the MCI / NMC will applicable.
b) Post holders appointed on a contractual basis to the post of Associate Professor in various departments of the Medical College will be paid a monthly honorarium in accordance with the advice given by the Finance Department from time to time. Apart from this, no other allowance/facility will be payable.
c) Contractual services for the post of Associate Professor in various departments of the Medical College will be for a maximum period of 02 years or until regular appointment/promotion, whichever is earlier, or up to the age of 70 years.
d) After the expiry of the contract period of 02 years, if the evaluation of their performance is found satisfactory, the service extension will be done for one year at a time for the upcoming years with the concurrence of the Finance Department.
e) This contract-based appointment will be purely provisional, and the candidates selected for obtaining services on a contractual basis will not claim regular appointment and other benefits in the future.
f) Leave: Contractual medical teachers will be entitled to casual leave for the calendar year similar to state employees, but they will not be entitled to any other leave.
g) An Associate Professor appointed on contract in a medical college will not be transferred to any other medical college and hospital.
h) Only as many posts of Associate Professor as are absolutely necessary will be filled through this arrangement in all medical colleges. The reservation percentage will be followed for obtaining services on these posts.
i) Based on the advice received from the Finance Department, according to the decision taken by the Council of Ministers regarding the determination of the contract amount, in light of Departmental Resolution-407 (9) dated 02.09.2021 and Departmental Notification 357 (9) dated 30.07.2024, the post holder appointed to the post of Associate Professor will be paid an honorarium of ₹2,00,000/- (Two Lakh Rupees). Apart from this, no other allowance or facility will be payable.
5. Maximum Age Limit: The maximum age limit for contract-based medical teachers will be 70 years for all categories.
6. Walk-in-interview for the vacant posts will be held in the Administrative Building of RIMS, Ranchi on the following dates:

Sl No	Post	Date	Time
01	Associate Professor	23.10.2026	10:30 AM

7. All interested candidates will fill in all the required information completely in the application form provided under 'Recruitment' on the website: **www.jharkhand.gov.in/health**, and participate on time on the date of the **walk-in-interview** along with self-attested photocopies of all original certificates and the original certificates.
8. The Department of Health, Medical Education and Family Welfare reserves all rights to postpone this advertisement, to accept/reject any application without assigning any reason, and to re-publish the advertisement in case vacancies remain unfilled.

Director, Medical Education, Jharkhand, Ranchi

PR.NO.391803 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare(26-27):D

सत्यमेव जयते

PLI
POSTAL LIFE INSURANCE
SINCE 1884

இந்திய அஞ்சல் துறை
भारतीय डाक विभाग
DEPARTMENT OF POSTS, INDIA

भारतीय डाक
डाक सेवा-जन सेवा
India Post
Dak Sewa-Jan Sewa

POSTAL LIFE INSURANCE

PROTECTION TRUST PROSPERITY

A Special Scheme for
Central and State Government
Employees, Public Sector
Bank Employees and All Degree,
Diploma and ITI Holders.

Doctors | Professionals | Degree Holders | Lawyers | ITI Trained Workers

Your future, your protection

Low Premium, High Bonus
Online Premium Payment (NACH / UPI)
NO GST
Loan Facility

A plan for every family
Guaranteed and reliable protection
Higher bonus Benefits
Protection for your family
Simple and quick service

Since 1884

www.indiapost.gov.in

India Post
Dak Sewa-Jan Sewa

THE HINDU GROUP

SHOW YOUR KOLU AT OUR CITY'S BIGGEST KONDATTAM.

GOPURAM
TURMERIC POWDER ★ KUMKUM
Presents
Made Of Chennai
KOLU KONDATTAM
THE HINDU DOWNTOWN
Powered by
DHEEPAM LAMP OIL | MANGALDEEP PREMIUM QUALITY INCENSE | PRINCE JEWELLERY
In Association with
POORVIKA APPLIANCES

This Navarathri, Chennai comes alive with the magic of your Kolu.
Upload a picture of your Kolu and win exciting prizes.

Don't miss our city's grandest showcase of creativity and culture.

Upload a picture of your kolu arrangement featuring packs of **ITC Mangaldeep and Dheepam** products to earn extra points.

Scan or visit
fline.news/MOCKL2026PA
to upload your Kolu pictures.

Last day to participate:
Today

For queries please contact:
90030 77030, 81487 48183

Associate Partners: Narpavi | Rmkv Unique Silks | Sundari Silks India | Tasty Tasty
Banking Partner: pnb
Food Partner: Cafe Coffee House
Venue Partner: VELS Thiruvanmiyur Campus
Water Partner: repute packaged drinking water

Gift Partners: Cotton House Thiruvanmiyur | OMR - Karapakkam | Difa | Hanbao Fans | Appliances | Houseware | hilaptop.com | Maestro Multi Cooker | Medimix Trusted Since 1969 | naga | RAS Chekku Oil | Vivekanandha Sarees

T&C apply*

From Page One

Northeast monsoon to set in over T.N. today

The prevailing weather systems, including those over the Comorin area, would influence rainfall over the State.

The Regional Meteorological Centre has forecast heavy to very heavy rainfall over isolated places in various coastal and Western Ghats districts on Thursday. Similar rainfall trends are likely in several interior districts till October 20. The wet spell would bring temperatures closer to normal from Friday, said officials.

INBRIEF

Dhinakaran questions CM's 'silence' on Cauvery issue

AMMK founder T.T.V. Dhinakaran on Wednesday questioned Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's "silence" on the Cauvery water dispute with Karnataka, despite having held talks with his Andhra Pradesh counterpart regarding the sharing of Krishna river water. "Why is Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Mr. Joseph Vijay, who held talks with the Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister for Krishna river water, maintaining silence over the Cauvery issue? Is the alliance [between the TVK and the Congress] more important than the State's rights and the livelihood of the farmers?" Mr. Dhinakaran said in a social media post. "Has Mr. Vijay decided to sacrifice the livelihood of the people in the Cauvery Delta region in exchange for the support of the Congress, which is holding up the minority TVK government," he asked.

State Board Class 12 examinations to be held from Mar. 3 to 29

Class 10 exams to be held from March 17 to April 12. Class 11 arrear exams will begin on March 5 and end on April 1, says School Education Dept.

School Education Minister Rajmohan releasing the examination schedule for students of State Board schools in Chennai on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The tentative exam result dates are May 7 for Classes 12 and 11, and May 20 for Class 10

The State Board public examinations for Class 12 students will be conducted from March 3 to March 29 next year, the School Education Department announced in Chennai on Wednesday.

Releasing the examination schedule for students of State Board schools, School Education Minister Rajmohan said the examinations for Class 10 students will begin on March 17 and end on April 12.

The Class 11 arrear examinations will begin on March 5 and end on April 1. The tentative result dates are May 7 for Classes 12 and 11, and May 20 for Class 10. For all three classes, the first paper will be the language paper.

Each examination will last three hours, and will begin at 10 a.m. The students will get 15 minutes to read the question paper before beginning to write the exam at 10.15 a.m. The exam will conclude at 1.15 p.m.

Mr. Rajmohan wished the students, teachers, and parents a "peaceful and wonderful examination" season.

"Some training in the lessons and in writing skills, along with an understanding of the lessons, will be provided to students. Learning should be fun, and not a burden," he added.

Responding to a question on paper leaks, the Minister stressed that all possible efforts were being made to ensure that even the smallest gaps were monitored and rectified.

Why can't T.N. police grant nod for route marches, asks HC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

Judge wonders why RSS can't conduct route marches in Tamil Nadu when it can do so even in 'terrorist-infested areas such as Jammu and Kashmir'

The Madras High Court on Wednesday wondered why the Tamil Nadu police do not grant permission for route marches, bike rallies, and other such events by the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), Dravidar Kazhagam (DK), or even political parties, irrespective of the party in power.

Justice V. Lakshminarayanan raised the question during the hearing of a writ petition (criminal) filed by RSS North Tamil Nadu secretary V.G. Jagadeesan, through his counsel V. Chandrasekaran and K. Srinivasa Murthy, seeking permission for route marches in various places across the State on October 18 and 25, and on November 1.

The petitioner sought permission for RSS members to participate in the marches wearing dark olive brown trousers, white shirts, caps, belts, and black shoes. He said the participants would be led by a musical band in each place where permission had been sought, and the event would be followed by public meetings.

Senior counsel N.L. Rajah told the court that the RSS had been taking out such annual marches across the country since its inception in 1925, and that its sister organisations had been conducting similar marches even in New York, London, Sydney, Auckland, Paris, and Ottawa.

After hearing him, the judge asked why, if RSS members had been taking out route marches even in "terrorist-infested areas such as Jammu and Kashmir", could they not do so in Tamil Nadu. He said the police were inviting negative publicity for themselves by not granting permission for route marches and bike rallies.

Advocate General Vijay Narayan said the routes on which the petitioner wanted to hold the marches were not conducive for the purpose. The general public would be put to inconvenience if such marches were permitted during the festival season, he added.

After hearing both sides, the judge directed the counsel for the petitioner to meet State Public Prosecutor R. John Sathyan at his office on Wednesday to resolve the issues relating to the date, time, and place of the marches, and report the outcome of the discussion to the court on Thursday.

'DMK ready to provide legal aid to arrested CJP activists'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin has said the party is ready to provide legal assistance to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) activists who were arrested and remanded in judicial custody.

Quoting a post on X by Abhijeet Dipke, founder and convenor of the CJP, the former Chief Minister said, "How many protesters can this government detain? How many young voices can the BJP silence? The more young people they jail, the more ordinary citizens, with no political affiliation, will take to the streets and show them the true power of the people. Solidarity with Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das. The DMK stands ready to provide them with all necessary legal representation and support." He also included the hashtag #GyaneshKumarMustGo.

In his social media post, Mr. Dipke said Mr. Ranka and Mr. Das were remanded to five days in judicial custody for "unfurling the tricolour" at Jantar Mantar.

Addressing Prime Minister Narendra Modi, he said, "If you're so determined to crush dissent, have the courage to officially declare an Emergency instead of hiding behind these cowardly tactics."

TNPDCL to incur additional cost of ₹5 crore to ₹7 crore per day on purchase of gas power, says Nirmal Kumar

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI/SALEM

Amid the row over the State government purchasing high-cost power, Energy Resources Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar on Wednesday said only 1,000 MW had to be procured, that too only to meet the evening peak demand, for 16 days from October 15 to 31.

Addressing the media at the Secretariat, he said that in the current situation, where only gas-generated power was available, several quotations had been received for purchasing power at a cost of ₹33 to ₹35 per unit. He said a majority of the gas power was to be purchased only through the central agency, NTPC Vidyut Vyapar Nigam (NVVN), and hence, there was no corruption involved in the purchase.

Mr. Nirmal Kumar alleged that the DMK was spreading false news that huge costs would have to be incurred on account of this power purchase, and claimed that the additional cost per day would be only ₹5 crore to ₹7 crore.

"Currently, only gas power is available throughout the country for purchase, and even thermal power, which is available only in Assam, costs ₹17 per unit. Though we have naphtha-powered electricity plants, we are not generating power through them because the cost of generating one unit is ₹45," the Minister said.

Mr. Nirmal Kumar alleged that the current situation had arisen primarily owing to previous governments having failed to draw up any long-term power purchase contracts.

'Mega corruption'

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Wednesday accused the TVK-led government of creating an artificial power shortage to procure electricity at higher rates. He alleged that the move had raised suspicion of "mega corruption" in the purchase of power.

Only 1,000 MW had to be procured, that too only to meet the evening peak demand, the Energy Resources Minister said.

Addressing the media at the party office in Omalur, he questioned the government's purchase of power from private companies at ₹35 a unit, after cancelling agreements signed by the previous DMK government for the purchase of electricity at ₹11 to ₹20 a unit over corruption allegations. The government should have continued or extended the earlier agreements to avoid high-cost procurement, he added.

Citing the ₹2.48 lakh crore debt burden of the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDCL), as mentioned in the government's White Paper, he questioned the rationale behind purchasing electricity at higher rates.

He alleged that the government had delayed power procurement for four months, causing severe power cuts and hardship to the public, and had created a situation in which electricity had to be purchased at any cost. Showing a video of Chief Minister and TVK leader C. Joseph Vijay criticising the DMK government's high-cost power purchases during this year's Assembly election campaign, he wondered why the TVK government was following the same practice.

Left parties flay govt.

The Left parties also voiced opposition to the State government's decision to purchase electricity at ₹35 per unit to address the power deficit.

In a statement, CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugam said no State had ever purchased power at such an exorbitant price. Doing so under the pretext of addressing power cuts was unjustifiable, he said. Across the country, the cost of electricity generated through various sources ranged from ₹2.45 to ₹5.30 per unit, he said. "Given this context, purchasing power at ₹35 per unit is unbelievable and shocking. Taking advantage of Tamil Nadu's power shortage, it amounts to handing over public funds to private corporations. The government must cancel this agreement and procure electricity at a fair price," he said.

In a statement, CPI State secretary M. Veerapandian said questions had arisen as to why the government was turning to the open market when it had options to procure power at lower rates within Tamil Nadu. Given the shadow of doubt cast over the procurement process, the State government must take steps to purchase electricity at lower rates, and in a transparent manner, he said.

'AIADMK leadership should consult with cadre over bypoll loss'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK MLA C.Ve. Shanmugam on Wednesday said the party's leadership should hold a consultation with its functionaries over its defeat in the recent bypolls in the Dharapuram and Madurantakam Assembly constituencies. If the leadership called a meeting, Mr. Shanmugam said he and others were willing to "cooperate" and take steps for the party's welfare.

Addressing the media, he said, "The AIADMK has lost [the bypolls] and everyone knows it. The AIADMK leadership should hold discussions, find out the reasons for the loss, and address them. This is why we have been calling for the general council meeting."

The party cadre needed confidence, and if the leadership could give it to them, the party could emerge stronger, Mr. Shanmugam said.

When asked if he would initiate any steps, Mr. Shanmugam said, "I am not in any [party] position. If those in power take steps, we are ready to cooperate with them."

To a query on the influence of money in the recent bypolls, the former Minister said, "There could be a difference of opinion. But the truth is that money was not given to the voters. It is a welcome change."

Replying to a query on resentment among the party cadre, he said, "Certainly, there is resentment." Maintaining that it was no secret, Mr. Shanmugam said that if the party leadership embraced everyone and took them along, the party could emerge stronger.

Govt. college teachers to protest over TAPS interim pension curbs

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Government college teachers have announced a State-wide protest on Thursday against the government's decision to restrict interim pension for employees with 10 to 18 years of service to ₹10,000.

In a statement, S. Suresh, general secretary, Tamil Nadu Government College Teachers' Association, demanded the immediate withdrawal of a letter issued by the Finance Department on September 11, restricting the pension to a flat rate of ₹10,000, apart from the Dearness Allowance (DA) payout. "From Group D employees to college professors, the letter has put everyone in the same bracket. This goes against the principles of natural justice," he said.

A G.O. issued on June 16 stated that, as an interim measure, till the regulations of the new Tamil Nadu Assured Pension Scheme (TAPS) were finalised, 30% of the last-drawn monthly basic pay or ₹10,000, whichever was higher, would be paid to the retired employees. The September letter, Mr. Suresh said, had shocked all government employees by restricting the interim payment to employees with 10 to 18 years of service to ₹10,000 plus DA.

While the value of the Contributory Pension Scheme for Group D employees was around ₹10 lakh, the same for college teachers was around ₹70 lakh. "How is it fair to bunch all of them in one category," he asked.

The letter said "the excess amount paid, including the dearness relief, shall be recovered in 10 equal instalments from the interim payout/interim family payout from September 2026", causing consternation among the employees, he said.

HC grants bail to accused in caste killing case

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has granted bail, with conditions, to K. Jayapal, the cousin of Surjith, the main accused in the Kavin Selvaganesh caste killing case.

Jayapal had filed an appeal against an order of the II Additional District Judge (PCR), Tirunelveli, declining to grant him bail. He had been arraigned as co-accused in the case.

Justice S. Karthikeyan granted conditional bail to Jayapal. The court said that, even as per the case of the prosecution, the appellant was not directly involved in the crime, but had actively participated in the conspiracy, preparation, and execution of the caste killing.

The court said that, even as per the prosecution, the appellant was not directly involved in the crime, but had actively participated in the conspiracy, preparation, and execution of the caste killing.

The court said that, according to the case of the prosecution, the appellant, being a close relative, intentionally aided the main accused, who destroyed the evidence at his quarry. The allegations against the appellant pertained only to intimidation and aiding in the screening of the evidence subsequent to the occurrence of the crime.

The appellant was arrested on August 13, 2025, and had been incarcerated since then. The prosecution had relied on 70 witnesses, and 37 documents were collected to substantiate its case. There was no likelihood of completion of trial in the near future. Considering the gravity of the offence, the overt act alleged against the appellant, the time to be taken for the completion of the trial, and the quashing of charges in respect of the co-accused, the court said it was inclined to grant bail to the appellant, subject to stringent conditions.

The appellant was directed to report before the trial court every day at 10.30 a.m. and 5.30 p.m. till further orders. He was directed not to enter the place of occurrence of the crime. He was also directed not to contact the victim's family.

Recently, the High Court quashed the charge sheet filed by the CB-CID against Saravanan and Krishnakumari, the parents of Surjith.

Kavin, from Arumugamangalam near Eral in Thoothukudi district, who belonged to a Scheduled Caste community, was in a relationship with S. Subhashini, a Siddha doctor from Palayamkottai. Kavin was murdered in Tirunelveli on July 27, 2025. Surjith, who is Subhashini's younger brother, was arrested on charges of murder.

ED attaches assets of dairy firms in TTD ghee case

The Hindu Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

The Enforcement Directorate (ED), Hyderabad Zonal Office, has provisionally attached assets worth ₹129.85 crore belonging to dairy companies, their promoters and related entities in connection with the alleged supply of adulterated ghee to the Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams (TTD).

The assets belong to Bhole Baba Organic Dairymilk Private Limited; Sri Vyshnavi Dairy Specialities Private Limited, their promoters Vipin Jain and Pomil Jain and their family members; Sukriti Foods Private Limited, its promoter Kailash Chand Mangla and his family members, besides other related entities and individuals.

Three from Keralam killed in building fire in Germany

The victims were identified as Anjali Sheela Joy from Kollam district, Sivin Johny from Ernakulam, and Nova Sabu from Idukki; investigators suspect arson; a Romanian national has been arrested

The Hindu Bureau
KOLLAM/IDUKKI

Three people hailing from Keralam have lost their lives in a devastating apartment building fire in Bochum, Germany. The victims were identified as Anjali Sheela Joy from Kollam district, Sivin Johny from Ernakulam district, and Nova Sabu from Idukki district.

In the wake of the tragedy, Tourism Minister P.C. Vishnunath said the government had initiated necessary action to bring the bodies back to Keralam. He said that authorities are actively coordinating with NORKA and the Indian Embassy in this regard. He also spoke to Ms. Joy's family. Ms. Joy had gone abroad for higher education. Ms. Sabu was from Santhigram near Kattappana in Idukki. A fitness trainer, she had moved to Germany six months ago for a job. Mr. Johny had gone to Germany only about a fortnight ago for higher studies.

Tragic loss: Anjali Sheela Joy from Kollam district and Nova Sabu from Idukki. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Police have arrested a 41-year-old resident of the building on suspicion of murder. He is a Romanian national, German news channel *n-tv* reported, citing the German Press Agency *Deutsche Presse-Agentur (DPA)*. A Bochum police spokesperson told *WDR* that there were initial grounds for suspicion of murder against the man, who had been questioned by officers from the homicide squad.

Police and prosecutors announced the arrest on Wednesday.

Investigators have ruled out a technical defect as the cause of the fire and suspect arson, but whether the fire was deliberately set or started accidentally remains under investigation. The fire broke out in a multi-family residential building in Bochum's Hofstede district.

(With inputs from PTI)

LDF, UDF trade barbs over power situation

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam Assembly on Wednesday witnessed heated exchanges between the United Democratic Front (UDF) government and the Opposition Left Democratic Front (LDF) over power cuts during the monsoon and a scrapped long-term power purchase deal.

Blaming the power crisis on the "inefficiency" of the UDF government, the Opposition staged a walkout after its demand that the House adjourn the day's business and discuss the issue was rejected.

Moving the adjournment motion, G.R. Anil of the Communist Party of India alleged that the crisis was artificially created with the knowledge of the government to pave the way for power sector corporates to enter the State's power sector.

Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said the Kerala State Electricity Board (KSEB), which manages power generation, transmission and distribution within Keralam, would be maintained in the public sector. He said KSEB would be transformed into the "best institution" and that his government intended to float a power policy aimed at addressing the long-term needs of the State.

The Opposition accused the government of viewing the power situation lightly and failing to take adequate precautions despite indications of a potential crisis in May and June.

Migrant workers in Bengaluru caught in SIR maze

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

In Bengaluru's Varthur-Balagere, at least five settlements sit alongside gated apartments and tech parks, where migrant workers from West Bengal have been living in makeshift tents for ₹3,000 to ₹4,000 a month. Women work in these apartments as cooks or helpers, while the men work as cleaners, scrap collectors or delivery partners for instant food and service apps.

"We are four siblings, but we were issued an SIR notice saying more than six progeny are linked to the same person [father]. What followed were multiple loans, totalling more than a lakh, that I took to make repeated trips to my native village, running from pillar to post, but the name, they [officials] say, is 'under adjudication'," said Rafiul Mohammed.

"Our neighbours say we (his family) will be sent to Bangladesh because we could not prove ourselves. But we did whatever we were asked."

Some said that even after submitting documents, their names were deleted from the rolls. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Like Mr. Mohammed, more than 3,500 people, according to the Karnataka Bengali Kalyan Samiti, formed by and for West Bengal-based workers in Bengaluru, are "under adjudication for logical discrepancy", even as the enrolment drive has started across States by the Election Commission of India, where deleted and left-out voters can reapply via Form-6 to seek inclusion.

'Family size' an issue

In West Bengal, more than 20 lakh names will not be part of this enrolment drive as these cases are currently pending before the appellate tribunals.

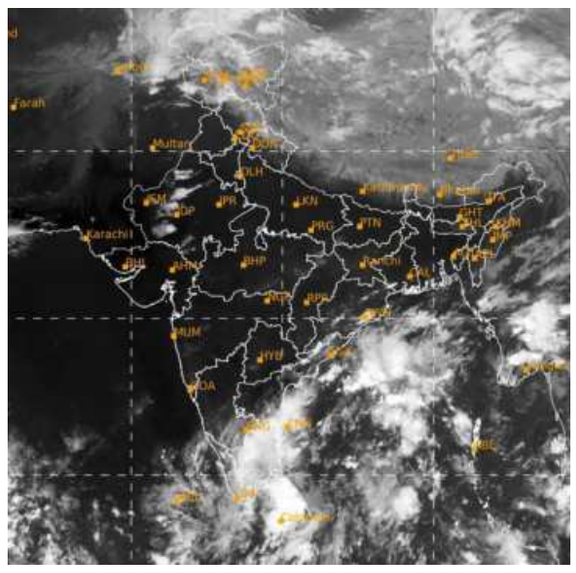
Many of these workers told *The Hindu* that they feel they were targeted because of their "family size".

Others described how the process had left them in cycles of debt, as they had to repeatedly travel to West Bengal to establish their identities.

Some of them said that even after submitting documents, their names were deleted from the electoral rolls, leaving them uncertain about the voter-linked welfare benefits their families received back home.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Punjab, Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Keralam. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha, Telangana, Maharashtra, Konkan & Goa and Lakshadweep

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	33.8	24.0	Kurnool	—	37.5	24.7
Ahmedabad	—	38.2	24.7	Lucknow	—	33.0	21.8
Aizawl	—	30.5	20.4	Madurai	4	32.8	25.6
Bengaluru	—	31.0	21.2	Mangaluru	—	35.1	24.4
Bhopal	—	32.4	20.4	Mumbai	—	37.8	23.7
Bhubaneswar	0.7	33.2	24.2	Mysuru	—	31.2	19.8
Chandigarh	—	32.9	19.6	New Delhi	—	33.3	22.4
Chennai	5	33.2	27.2	Patna	—	33.3	24.8
Coimbatore	—	35.2	24.6	Port Blair	23	30.4	24.1
Dehradun	—	30.2	18.3	Prayagraj	—	34.6	23.4
Gangtok	—	24.1	14.5	Puducherry	14.7	30.4	24.5
Goa	—	37.4	24.7	Pune	—	35.4	20.5
Guwahati	—	33.4	23.4	Raipur	—	33.0	23.8
Hubballi	—	33.0	21.0	Ranchi	—	31.2	19.0
Hyderabad	—	33.9	21.8	Shillong	—	26.0	16.4
Imphal	—	30.8	17.6	Shimla	—	25.0	15.4
Jaipur	—	35.0	24.0	Srinagar	7	18.2	10.5
Kochi	—	32.2	27.0	Thiruvananthapuram	—	30.4	26.0
Kohima	—	22.2	15.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	36.5	26.6
Kolkata	—	33.5	26.5	Vijayawada	—	34.5	25.8
Kozhikode	—	36.7	27.2	Visakhapatnam	0.4	33.0	26.2

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.91	..53	47	 86	...169	
Bengaluru	.29	..36	37	... 106	...158	
Chennai	.24	..10	27	 82	80	
Delhi	.12	..77	40	... 256	...236	
Hyderabad	...1	3	23	... 106	...106	
Kolkata	...8	..45	19	... 132	...123	
Lucknow	...5	..44	35	 79	...118	
Mumbai	...6	..55	40	... 113	...159	
Pune	.18	..88	38	... 108	...131	
Visakhapatnam	...4	..29	17	 24	46	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Baraut, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 240 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Aizawl, Mizoram recorded a healthy AQI score of 17

Air Quality Code: Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

TAMIL NADU TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LTD
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
20, 21 & 22/2026-27	CE/TP & SO/Chennai	Replacement of aged towers
E-02/26-27	CE/TP & SO/Trichy	Electrical works for SS
13,14 &15/26-27	CE/TP & SO/Madurai	Civil work for SS & Line work
ET.14/2026-27	SE/O/Salem	Maintenance for EHT lines
T.2394	SE/Transmission-III	Supply & Laying of 230 KV Cable
T.2395	SE/Transmission-II	Supply of 420 KV Transformer
ET-10 to 14	SE/O/Thanjavur	AMC for EHT Lines

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: **www.tantransco.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**
DIPR/3133/Tender/2026

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
CORRIGENDUM
No. GMA/GS/1521(CMP)(5)-Pt.IV, Dated: 12.10.2026
WALK-IN-INTERVIEW FOR THE POST OF CONTRACT MEDICAL PRACTITIONERS SPECIALIST ON FULL TIME CONTRACT BASIS IN CLW/CHITTARANJAN.
The date of interview for engagement of CMP Specialist at CLW as mentioned under point no. 10 of Notification No. GMA/GS/1521(CMP) (5)-Pt.IV dated 25.09.2026 **is rescheduled on 28.10.2026** instead of 23.10.2026. Other contents stipulated in the notification dated 25.09.2026 remains unchanged.
PR3/523 SPO/(Gaz)/CLW/Chittaranjan
Like us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
M 270	CE/MM	Procurement of 110V DC Annunciation Panels
E 1016	CE/D/ Kanchipuram	Supply and erection of new 33 KV SS with associated equipments at IYYAMPETTAI IN KANCHIPURAM EDC
E 1017	CE/D/ Kanchipuram	Supply and erection of new 33 KV SS with associated equipments at KURUVIMALAI IN KANCHIPURAM EDC
E 1018	CE/D/ Kanchipuram	Supply and erection of new 33 KV SS with associated equipments at SIDCO SENGARAI IN TIRUVALLUR EDC
E 1019	CE/D/ Kanchipuram	Supply and erection of new 33 KV SS with associated equipments at MELMARUVATHUR IN CHENGALPET EDC
E 1020	CE/D/ Kanchipuram	Supply and erection of new 33 KV SS with associated equipments at TIRUTTANI TEMPLE IN THIRUVALLUR EDC
E 1021	CE/D/ Kanchipuram	Supply and erection of new 33 KV SS with associated equipments at ENAMBAKKAM IN THIRUVALLUR EDC
001	CE/Madurai	Establishment of new 33 KV Kovilankulam Outdoor SS except power transformer and breaker
002	CE/Madurai	Establishment of new 33 KV Thiru UthiraKosaMangai Outdoor SS except power transformer and breaker
003	CE/Madurai	Establishment of new 33 KV Kottanathampatty Outdoor SS except power transformer and breaker
004	CE/Madurai	Establishment of new 33 KV SIDCO Uchapatti Outdoor SS except power transformer and breaker
001	CE/Vellore	Establishment of 33 11 KV Nagavedu SS
002	CE/Vellore	Establishment of 33 11 KV kunathur SS
003	CE/Vellore	Establishment of 33 11 KV Natham SS
004	CE/Vellore	Establishment of 33 11 KV Theertham SS
005	CE/Vellore	Establishment of 33 11 KV Upparapalli SS
006	CE/Vellore	Establishment of 33 11 KV Sevaganapalli SS
01	CE/Villupuram	Establishment of New 33 11 KV SS at Ananthapuram with 1x8 MVA Power Transformer in Villupuram EDC
02	CE/Villupuram	Establishment of New 33 11 KV SS at Avatti with 1x8 MVA Power Transformer in Cuddalore EDC
03	CE/Villupuram	Establishment of New 33 11 KV SS at Sozhatharam with 1x8 MVA Power Transformer in Cuddalore EDC
04	CE/Villupuram	Establishment of New 33 11 KV SS at Shandan with 1x8 MVA Power Transformer in Cuddalore EDC
05	CE/Villupuram	Establishment of New 33 11 KV SS at Esanur with 2x8 MVA Power Transformer in Cuddalore EDC
06	CE/Villupuram	Establishment of New 33 11 KV SS at V Kumaramangalam with 2x8 MVA Power Transformer in Cuddalore EDC
E-01	CE/Coimbatore	Manufacture fabrication supply erection testing and commissioning of New Mangalam SS
E-02	CE/Coimbatore	Manufacture fabrication supply erection testing and commissioning New Kambiliyampatty SS
E-03	CE/Coimbatore	Manufacture fabrication supply erection testing and commissioning New Kathankanni SS
E-04	CE/Coimbatore	Manufacture fabrication supply erection testing and commissioning New Anaipalayam SS
TKC 03	CE/Tirunelveli	Supply and Erection of 33 KV SS at TS Puram village in Tirunelveli EDC
TKC 04	CE/Tirunelveli	Supply and Erection of 33 KV SS at Iynthamkattalai village in Tirunelveli EDC
TKC 05	CE/Tirunelveli	Supply and Erection of 33 KV SS at Rayagiri village in Tirunelveli EDC
TKC 06	CE/Tirunelveli	Supply and Erection of 33 KV SS at Kurukkalpatty village in Tirunelveli EDC
18	CE/Erode	Electrical Works for establishment of New Kodumanal 33 11 KV SS total turnkey except Pr Tr and Brkr
08	CE/Karur	Supply and Erection of new Kadavur 33 11 KV SS Electrical works in Karur EDC Except PrTr and Breaker
ST 03	CE / Vellore	Sale of scrap materials available at Central Stores Krishnagiri EDC Krishnagiri

For details of works/Procurement/Due date of submission/Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit the websites **www.tnpdcl.org, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in**
DIPR/3131/Tender/2026

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
e-Tender Notice No. CE-Con-RSP-5-2025. Chief Engineer/RSW, S.E. Railway, GRC,Kolkata-43 invites e-tenders for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in** & the tender will be closed at 15.00 hrs. on due date. **Brief Description of works :** Construction of Road Over Bridge (Full ROB) in lieu of Level Crossing No. AM - 34 at Km - 323/14 -15 between Jamadoba -Bhaga station under Adra Division, Road Over Bridge (only approach portion) in lieu of Level Crossing No. 239 at Rly. Km. 149/29-31 between Railway station Tangarmunda-Dharuadihi at Bamra Railway station yard under Chakradharpur Division, Road Over Bridge (only approach portion) in lieu of Level Crossing No. 256 at Rly. Km. 510/12-14 between Railway station Dhutra-Jharsuguda in Tata-Jharsuguda main line section under Chakradharpur Division and Road Over Bridge (ROB) in lieu of Level Crossing No. 89 at Rly. Km. 246/35-38 between Railway station Khantapara - Panpana under Kharagpur Division in South Eastern Railway. **Approx. Cost :** ₹ 278.47 Crore. **Bid Security :** ₹ 5.57 Crore. **Period of Completion :** 24 months from the date of issue of Letter of Acceptance. **Closing Date :** By 15.00 hrs. (IST) on 06.11.2026. Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/ description/specification of the tenders and submit their Bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **NB:** Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all other tenders.
(PR-895)

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
18	CE / MTPS-II	Daily Maintenance and Preventive or Breakdown maintenance works in Bottom Ash Handling System for 365 days

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: **www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in**
DIPR/3148/Tender/2026

GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA
EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
No. EDN.124/2026/29 **Dated Shillong, the 30th September, 2026**
PUBLIC NOTICE
Conduct of examinations and academic progression of existing enrolled students of CMJ University, Meghalaya
With reference to the UGC letter D.O. No. 8-21/2010(CPP-I/ PU)/78587, dated 02-09-2026, the office of the Administrator, under the Government of Meghalaya, is directed to inform all students of CMJ University as follows: **"All students presently studying Diploma, Undergraduate and Postgraduate programmes at the University may be allowed to appear in examinations conducted under the supervision of an external agency/third party, under the overall responsibility of the State Education Department"**.
Therefore, students are required to complete the form to submit their personal details for the examination using the QR code provided. Failure to submit the details will hinder the examination process, as these details are needed to arrange examinations with third-party institutions. The form link will remain active to accept responses until **01-11-2026**.
Link - **https://forms.gle/3aMvMVWX2DxnNSzv5**
Sd/-
Administrator of CMJ University, Meghalaya & Joint Secretary to the Govt. of Meghalaya
Education Department
MIPR No.: 1769
Dated: 30-09-2026

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF EDUCATION
DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION
Appointment of Vice-Chancellor of Assam University
Applications are invited for the post of **Vice-Chancellor of Assam University.**
The Vice-Chancellor, being the academic as well as administrative head, is expected to be:
- A person possessing the highest level of competence, integrity, morals and institutional commitment.
- A distinguished academician, with a minimum of 10 years' experience as Professor in a University or 10 years' experience in reputed research and/or academic administrative organization with proof of having demonstrated academic leadership
- Preferably not more than 65 years of age as on the closing date of receipt of applications of this advertisement.

Salary and Service Conditions
- The post carries a pay of Rs. 2,10,000/- (Fixed) per month with Special Allowance of Rs. 11,250/- and other usual allowances.
- The terms and conditions of the services will be those as set forth in the Act, Statutes and Ordinances of the University.

Procedure for Appointment
- Appointment will be made from a panel of names recommended by a committee constituted under the provisions Act of the University.
- The advertisement is available on the websites: **https://www.dohe-education.gov.in** and **https://www.aus.ac.in**
- Candidates are required to "**APPLY ONLINE ONLY**" on the Ministry of Education SAMARTH portal as per the link given below:
https://vcrec.samarth.ac.in/index.php/
- The above link will be active from **15.10.2026,** 10:00 Hours to **13.11.2026,** 17:00 Hours.

CBC21201/11/0012/2627

M CH-CHE

Illogical reasons

Delhi's 'logical discrepancy' flags suggest a design that targets Muslims

That the ECI's SIR of electoral rolls has been flawed by design and tuned to exclude genuine electors rather than ensure their full enrolment is now well established. *The Hindu*'s investigation of Delhi's draft rolls and the names that the ECI flagged as "logical discrepancies" shows that the process is not only exclusionary but also insidious. The arbitrary nature of these "discrepancies", especially those relating to family size, suggests that they were chosen to target communities with higher, though declining, fertility rates, for exclusion. Muslims make up 13.6% of Delhi's draft rolls – in line with the 2011 Census – but accounted for 20.3% of those flagged for "logical discrepancies". This number goes up to 30% for those flagged under the five reasons linked to family size. None of these criteria bears on the eligibility of an elector, who should be an Indian citizen, at least 18, ordinarily resident in the constituency and should not be disqualified under the law. Following *Lal Babu Hussein* (1995), a name on an earlier electoral roll has probative value as evidence of citizenship and cannot be struck off without inquiry. The children an elector has, a parent's age at the elector's birth or name spelling are unconnected; neither the ECI's Manual on Electoral Rolls (2023) nor its SIR of 2002-03 provided for such checks.

When the ECI began the SIR in Bihar, the enrolment and claims and objections phases had their infirmities but there was no direct or indirect discrimination by religion. *The Hindu* estimated that 18.4% of those deleted from Bihar's pre-SIR rolls were Muslims, in line with their population share (17.7%, 2011 Census). But in the SIR's Phase 2 in West Bengal, the ECI introduced the "logical discrepancies" check midway. Electors already on draft rolls were flagged on unexplained criteria with ECINET software rather than the statutory Electoral Registration Officers deciding on who got flagged. The impact was severe – 27 lakh electors were deleted following adjudication by judicial officers, after being flagged overwhelmingly for "logical discrepancies"; 22 lakh appealed but just 1,607 electors were reinstated in time for the vote. By September, nearly 93% of the 1.26 lakh appeals that were decided had restored electors to the rolls – an indication of large-scale disenfranchisement before the vote. A sample-based analysis of those excluded after adjudication estimated a much higher share of Muslims than their population share. The same process has now been carried over to Phase 3, including Delhi, where *The Hindu*'s investigation shows a clear skew against Muslim electors. The Supreme Court must now halt the SIR, as a process built on arbitrary criteria with no basis in electoral law, and which discriminates against specific communities, should not be allowed to firm up electoral rolls.

Drugs and bullets

Punjab is seeing a rise in narcotrafficking and targeted killings

A chemist has been charged with killing anti-drug-trafficking activist Parvinder Singh Jhota after his allegedly illegal drug business came under threat. Separately, social media influencer Mad Sandhu was allegedly the victim of a premeditated, transnational syndicate hit that used interstate escape routes. Both events in Punjab involved digital platforms and both events expose a dire gap in public safety. While Mr. Jhota's alleged murderer was a local chemist, the macro-level drug trade in Punjab is intertwined with gangster networks, with the cross-border drug smuggling known to be a key source of illicit funds. Together with a string of targeted killings of police personnel and local politicians, the incidents depict a Punjab caught between local drug trafficking and citizens resorting to vigilantism and crime syndicates carrying out assassinations with disquieting ease. Some events have also raised suspicions of cross-border support and a demand to involve enforcement agencies. The AIIMS Magnitude of Substance Use in India survey estimated that in 2017-18 – the latest year for which it is available – 1.28% of Punjab's population aged 10-75 years had an opioid dependence, versus 0.26% nationally. NCRB data also recorded 106 drug overdose deaths in 2024 versus 89 in 2023, in Punjab, likely an undercount since attribution depends on medical certification and excludes long-term complications and unhygienic habits associated with drug use.

Punjab's geopolitical location renders it an important entry point and market, with the security apparatus hampered by smugglers using multiple transport modes. The Global Initiative Against Transnational Organized Crime reported in June that India's pharmaceutical and chemicals industries also provide bad actors with ample opportunities to divert controlled substances or precursors for illicit use. The State's 'Yugh Nashian Virudh' campaign of 2025 has also claimed 68,850 arrests of alleged traffickers and the attachment or confiscation of assets valued ₹319 crore. However, cases registered differ from convictions and asset attachment differs from forfeiture. Mr. Jhota's hostile tactics also enjoyed public support, and authorities need to examine why the people are overlooking formal reporting channels. Under its narcotics policy, the State has to reduce the availability of harmful drugs, disrupt wholesale supply chains, identify corrupt facilitators, and expand access to rehabilitative care. Paralleling investigations into the coordination of targeted killings, an anti-trafficking strategy must also probe the financing and logistics of networks, to dismantle institutional collusion, and better protect threatened individuals.

A split verdict, faltering remedies and people's power

Kaleeswaram Raj

A lawyer who argued in support of the Petitioners in Anoop Baranwal (2023) and Dr. Jaya Thakur (2026)

Jaya Thakur underscores the limits of judicial intervention and the enduring power of people's movements to defend the Constitution

In *Dr. Jaya Thakur vs Union of India*, a two-judge Bench of the Supreme Court of India was faced with a challenge to the 2023 law governing the appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs). On September 23, 2026, the Court delivered a split verdict. Justice Dipankar Datta held that, since a Constitution Bench in *Anoop Baranwal* (2023) had settled the constitutional position on the mechanism for selecting the CEC and the ECs, the challenge to the 2023 Act needed to be examined in light of the principles laid down in that judgment. The *Baranwal* approach is simple and straightforward: a committee with executive predominance cannot be entrusted with selecting impartial umpires such as the CEC and the ECs. A three-member committee comprising the Prime Minister and another Union Minister clearly demonstrates such executive predominance.

Therefore, the law governing the selection and appointment of the CEC and the ECs must consciously avoid these vices. Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, however, held that, given the importance of the issues involved, the case should be referred to a larger Constitution Bench. After delivering separate and divergent opinions, the judges also passed a common order expressing their desire for an expeditious hearing of the case by a Constitution Bench.

There will be a further delay

The net result of the present order is that a decision on the validity of the legislation governing the appointment of the CEC and the ECs will take further time. A statute that is, on the face of it, illegitimate and unconstitutional will have an extended lifespan solely because of the reference ordered on the basis of Justice Satish Chandra Sharma's opinion. This law, as it is now evident, envisages a Prime Minister's Committee to select the CEC and the ECs, with the Prime Minister and the Cabinet Minister chosen by him forming two-thirds of the Committee, making the Opposition leader's presence merely ornamental.

Had this Bench struck down the controversial law on its own, it would have radically altered India's electoral and judicial history, particularly at a time when people at large are sceptical of electoral institutions and the electoral process. That did not happen. The legitimacy of the 2023 law and the decisions of the Commission are now being questioned by Opposition parties and others, including the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP). Protests are mounting across the country, with many people calling for the resignation of the Chief Election Commissioner, Gyanesh Kumar.

The impact

This demand has a strong moral basis. However, replacing an individual alone cannot provide a permanent solution to systemic flaws. The Court has failed to take up the issue in time, and the present order referring the matter to a larger Bench in Dr. Jaya Thakur will, in effect, amount to an institutional confession of this failure. The statute that overturns the *Baranwal* principle and grants the CEC and the ECs lifelong immunity for their acts and words while in the office, needs to be repealed. A fresh law that incorporates the principle of a neutral body selecting the CEC and the ECs, thereby ensuring neutral umpires in the Commission, should be put in place. It is equally important to revisit the controversial revision of electoral rolls and undo its consequences.

The order in Dr. Jaya Thakur contains certain political and moral lessons. Although it does not decide the challenge, some of Justice Datta's observations are significant. The judge quoted Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's speech of October 28, 1951: "We also find that the Government servants are influencing the elections in favour of the party which is feeding them and their dependents. No less a personality than Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee, at the inaugural session of the Bhartiya Jan Sangh at Delhi recently, openly charged the Government servants of helping the Congress and thereby nullifying the elections from being free and fair. ..... If Parliamentary Democracy fails in this country and it is bound to fail for the reasons mentioned by me, the only result will be rebellion, anarchy and Communism".

History magnifies and inverts reality, inviting the ruling dispensation, which claims the legacy of Shyama Prasad Mukherjee, to confront its own mirror image. Today, amid institutional capture and what is described as centrally orchestrated mass disenfranchisement, Dr. Ambedkar's warning is all the more relevant.

The split judgment has become controversial for another reason as well. The fact that Justice Satish Chandra Sharma's son has served as an empanelled standing counsel for the Election Commission before the Madhya Pradesh High Court raises the possibility of a conflict of interest.

The judge's failure to disclose this association at any point has invited speculation about the impartiality of the adjudicative process. This shatters the moral and even legal foundation of Justice Sharma's order referring the matter to a Constitution Bench, thereby further delaying a decision on the case. Recently, petitions have been filed in the Court for recalling and nullifying Justice Sharma's order. In *Rupa Ashok Hurra vs Ashok Hurra* (2002), a Constitution Bench had indicated that failure on the part of a judge to disclose his connection with the subject-matter or the parties would vitiate the judgment, warranting a revisit.

The Bangalore Principles of Judicial Conduct state that "a judge shall avoid impropriety and the appearance of impropriety in all of the judge's activities". They also stipulate that "a judge shall not participate in the determination of a case in which any member of the judge's family represents a litigant or is associated in any manner with the case". The Restatement of Values of Judicial Life, adopted by the Court in May 1997, contains similar prohibitions.

Beyond the courts

Now, back to the 2023 law. As the country's history has shown, political struggles can have a larger dimension than judicial proceedings. As regarding the draconian laws, the Terrorist and Disruptive Activities (Prevention) Act (TADA) was allowed to lapse and the Prevention of Terrorism Act (POTA) was repealed by the Centre, even though they had earlier received the Court's endorsement.

The National Emergency (1975-77) was upheld by the Court in judgments, including the infamous ADM Jabalpur case (1976), which upheld the suspension of fundamental rights. Ultimately, the people voted Mrs. Gandhi's regime out of power in the subsequent election. Likewise, the controversial farm laws were repealed by Parliament in 2021 following massive protests.

In short, a political and moral reading of the split verdict in *Dr. Jaya Thakur* takes us beyond the Court to recognise the Constitution's potential for survival through peaceful people's movements.

India's China+1 lessons lie within its own States

P.S. Srinivas

Visiting Research Professor at the East Asian Institute, National University of Singapore

Anisha Sircar

Non-Resident Fellow at the East Asian Institute, National University of Singapore

Karnataka and Tamil Nadu are leading examples of how industrial ecosystems attract global manufacturers

"Don't look at India – look at what's happening with specific States," a veteran investor told these writers in one of 50 interviews with senior industry executives, policymakers and experts for a 2026 study at the East Asian Institute on how global firms are reworking their China+1 plans.

However, the national conversation tends to run the other way. Every few months, someone advises India to study Vietnam's industrial parks, Mexico's nearshoring or Poland's supply chains. Meanwhile, two instructive case studies sit right at home – in Tamil Nadu and Karnataka. Global firms do not choose "India" as a homogenous monolithic edifice. They choose a State, and with it, the land, power supply, approvals, workers and suppliers.

Two States, their approaches

At Sriperumbudur, near Chennai, Foxconn employs tens of thousands of people assembling iPhones. Tata Electronics has expanded at Hosur. In January 2026, the Centre approved projects in Tamil Nadu under its Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS), including mobile-phone enclosure units by Yuzhan Technology, a Foxconn-linked firm, and Tata Electronics. These are commitments rather than finished factories, but they reflect the advantages of an industrial ecosystem that has taken decades to build.

None of this began with China+1. Tamil Nadu invested in technical education, built an automobile and components industry around Chennai, and developed the suppliers, skills and administrative experience that new manufacturers look for. Several investors told us that policy continuity is essential and that commitments must be honoured regardless of political turnover. That is now being tested following the change of government in Tamil Nadu in May 2026. One academic respondent argued that Tamil Nadu would have done well irrespective of China. Its industrial base took four or five decades to build; no announcement of an industrial park or round of subsidies can conjure that up. Karnataka followed a different path. Bengaluru began with software and engineering talent, and not Chennai's automobile base. Foxconn's 300-acre campus at Devanahalli, where women reportedly form about 80% of the workforce, aims to create around 50,000 jobs. Tata Electronics took over Wistron's iPhone plant at Narsapura, in a deal agreed in late 2023, and has grown rapidly since.

Tamil Nadu faces limits in land, power and labour, and relies on migrant workers from the northern and central States. It is now seeking to move beyond labour-intensive assembly towards more capital-intensive manufacturing and innovation-led exports.

National policy, State-level delivery

National incentives are integral, too. One manufacturer explained the combined effect of tariffs and production-linked incentives (PLI): "If the duty is 20 per cent and I get a PLI of 6 per cent, competitors cannot compete with me. This is working right here." The PLI scheme for large-scale electronics manufacturing ended on March 31, 2026, and the Cabinet approved a successor on July 15. In January, the Centre cleared 22 proposals under the ECMS, worth ₹41,863 crore and expected to create 33,791 direct jobs across eight States. The Centre describes this spread as "geographically balanced industrial growth". In March, the Cabinet approved easing Press Note 3, which introduced curbs in 2020 on investment from countries sharing a land border with India. These measures help attract investment, but whether that investment takes root depends on what individual States can offer. The factory still has to come up somewhere.

Still, Tamil Nadu ranks only fifth in the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade's (DPIIT) data on foreign direct investment (FDI) equity inflows for October 2019 to March 2026, accounting for about 6%. This is behind Maharashtra (31%), Karnataka (21%), Gujarat (15%) and Delhi (13%).

However, DPIIT records FDI against the State in which the receiving company has its head office, rather than where the money is spent. So, the figures tell us little about where factories are being built.

Assembly is only the first step. One electronics executive told us that "very few components are manufactured in India" and that there is still a "huge reliance on China for major parts and supply chains". Backward linkages remain thin. Another respondent said his firm had set a billion-dollar target for sourcing in India but, after two or three years, had managed to source "about 600 million out of that". Such ecosystems cannot be built in a hurry: "Value addition is a process which takes time – it is a four-to-five-year process."

Electronics exports touched about $48 billion in 2025-26, while imports stood at about $116 billion. Although export growth is impressive, the trade gap suggests that India still has considerable ground to cover in component manufacturing. One executive described the exports as "assembled products with 20 per cent inputs in India".

India's industrial divide

Concentration also carries risks. One respondent said growth is "largely happening in the southern and western parts, not in the most populous States such as Bihar, Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand".

Spreading subsidies thinly will not, by itself, replicate Tamil Nadu's supplier networks or Karnataka's technical labour pool. The key questions are what these States did to prepare land, train workers, clear approvals, nurture suppliers and retain investors, and which of these measures can be replicated, and what rests on decades of accumulated capacity.

India's China+1 debate keeps looking abroad for a model, even as some of the most instructive factories have been coming up all along on the outskirts of Chennai and Bengaluru.

This article draws on 50 interviews for the EAI Special Report, "India, China, and the 'China+1' Strategies of Global Firms" (September 2026), and on P.S. Srinivas, Frank N. Pieke and Alfred Schipke, "India, China and the China+1 Strategy", Global Policy (2026)

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Grand goals, ground reality

On completing 25 years in power, the Prime Minister has set ambitious goals: making India one of the world's three largest economies, venturing into space, achieving Atmanirbhar Bharat, turning India into a global manufacturing hub and hosting the Olympics. The new slogan is "We can do it". We certainly can. But these goals do little to address the immediate concerns of ordinary citizens. While economic growth has created billionaires and numerous multimillionaires, it has failed to ease the common man's daily struggles. With space opening up to private players, public resources could further enrich them, while the common man will have to be content watching rockets being launched. Atmanirbhar Bharat remains an aspiration, with India still dependent on China for critical imports. The ambition to become a global manufacturing hub is welcome, but industrial growth has yet to generate adequate employment or move decisively beyond assembly to domestic production. Hosting the Olympics, too, seems misplaced when millions struggle to access basic necessities. A leader's greatness should be measured not merely by years in office or grand ambitions, but by how many people are freed from material hardship.

A.G. Rajmohan,
Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh

Protest grounds

It is a calculated move to say citizens may protest anywhere, as long as nobody in power will hear them. Jantar Mantar mattered because it sat near Parliament, and its replacements are four, 13 and 15 kilometres away (October 13). Distance alone might be defended, but the details are worse. Ramlila Maidan, the nearest, reportedly has just three dates, all in the last week of December, with an initial booking cost of over ₹1.21 lakh. Jantar Mantar had no comparable fee. A right to protest that must be booked months ahead and paid for in lakhs is a right for the well-funded, not the aggrieved. Students, farmers and workers protest because they have little, and they cannot buy their way to a hearing. Call it an order on venues if you like. In effect, it prices dissent out of the capital, then points to the fine print to say nothing was banned.

Yashvi Patel,
Anand, Gujarat

The gaps in health care

Modern medicine increasingly suffers from a "tunnel vision" approach. The result is fragmented care, where prescriptions are issued in isolation. Equally troubling is the growing reliance on lab reports, with doctors rarely examining patients. Strengthening primary health care, expanding geriatric medicine and fostering communication among specialists can restore trust and safety.

H.N. Ramakrishna,
Bengaluru

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Satyagraha for Constitution-as-commons

Kalpana Kannabiran

Advanced Fellow, Vienna Centre for Advanced Studies, University of Vienna. Views expressed are personal

The events unfolding on the streets of India signal the emergence of a new language of citizenship and a new language of the Constitution. This has been in the making over the past decade and a half. It has taken its time as fashioning a new language and grammar of justice is a process that has to distil public anger against the criminal dispossession by this government. The public face of criminal dispossession brazenly glares down at us: from dwellings and homes, savings, education, and now voting rights.

This is the time when it all comes together – through the fearless confrontation of young protesters with a disproportionately weaponised police; when only those political leaders, who are out on the streets engaging with the armed state in the same manner in which these (extra)ordinary protestors are, retain public credibility and legitimacy; when lawyers preparing to defend resisters (and themselves) know that they will be huddled into vans and booked for practising their profession. This is the time when self-styled monarchs who took possession of their seats of power, grabbed through a daylight robbery of votes, can no longer sit on them, but instead hide behind them, cowering in fear.

This is also the time when judges repeat endless platitudes about how the only protests deserving of judicial attention are 'lawful protests', and assert meekly (within the enclosure of the court) that they are bound by 'judicial discipline' in considering the lawful right to bail for prisoners such as Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam. They make this assertion without stopping to reflect on the unlawful mayhem let loose by the 'rulers' against whom 'lawful protest' is an oxymoron. How does one 'lawfully' challenge the government's politics of maiming, when what has been maimed is the law and courts? To protest is unlawful under authoritarianism; it is lawful in a constitutional democracy. The ruling *diktat* has labelled the common citizen as an *andolanjeevi* – a new extra-statutory category of criminal – who stands accused of the crime of being a citizen who knows their rights. That judges and courts fail to redefine the fundamental meaning of 'judicial discipline' and 'lawful public action' at a time when the Constitution is under siege is tragic.

> The resisters out on the streets today are those who hold Gandhi's talisman and Ambedkar's Preamble in their fight to restore to the people of this country control over their lives

Duty to the nation

This is the country where satyagraha was born and takes new forms at different times. We have now reached a turning point as a country. This fire in our belly must be quelled; not through the use of pellet guns, lathis, and courtly intimidations, but through peaceful protest. It is our birthright.

The Constitution is our commons. It provides the normative ethical framework for citizenship and shared humanity. It speaks to a just future that guarantees dignity, self-respect, autonomy and solidarity while being mindful of discrimination and structural violence, that must be eliminated. Dignity and shared humanity lie at its core – a guarantee of citizenship as birthright. This idea of the 'Constitution-as-commons' helps in bridging different pathways to imagine an idea of justice. In elaborating on this, we need to bring together popular imaginations of justice that we see opening out before us, predicated on the constitutional convivialities made possible by this popular uprising and its precursors.

Courts and judges need to understand this 'constitutional jurisprudence from the streets' and its interpretive methods through a welcoming acknowledgement of the pedagogic import of this collective constitutionalism. This shift in the country has been nothing short of a glimpse at a utopia; therefore, it is important, theoretically and politically, to trace the contours of this possibility – not just for India, but through the Indian experience for a more holistic, pluriversal understanding, without losing sight of the fact that justice is always spatially rooted. That space is now no longer the reductionist enclosure of the court, nor even the fortified monument that is Parliament, but the 'outside'. The streets, under the open skies, is where the Constitution resides today.

Conviviality and the cultural politics of care, as the conscientious resisters demonstrate to us today, can only be located in the context of civic resistance against state violence in India. This politics of care, of which protest and resistance is part, challenges crimes by the state. The resisters out on the streets today are those who hold Gandhi's talisman and Ambedkar's Preamble in their fight to restore to the people of this country control over their lives.

The myth of 'unskilled' labour

Vasudevan Mukunth

According to the Safe in India Foundation, unskilled workers earning under ₹8,000 a month in the automotive sector lost 2.27 fingers per accident on average in 2024 versus 1.54 fingers for skilled workers earning more than ₹20,000. Earlier this year, thousands of industrial workers protested their stagnant wages across Noida and New Delhi. The Uttar Pradesh government responded by giving 'unskilled' workers an interim hike of ₹13,690 a month and 'skilled' workers ₹16,868, despite both groups facing the same inflation.

Based on assessing migrant labourers in Keralam's construction and hospitality sectors, the International Institute of Migration and Development, Thiruvananthapuram, has estimated that 'unskilled' workers experienced 40% more wage theft than skilled workers. Factories often use the label 'unskilled' to justify withholding annual increments, health benefits, and safety training. The Safe in India Foundation report attributed the higher severe injury rate among 'unskilled' workers to employers often tasking such workers with operating dangerous power press machines without adequate training or safety measures. Contractors likewise deny construction workers personal protective equipment and often deny the final month's pay knowing labourers lack legal recourse, and exclude sanitation workers from safety protocols in hazardous occupations.

In fact, the 'unskilled' status is one the state sustains rather than what naturally arises in society. Across sectors, supposedly 'unskilled' workers are expected to have skills such as handling construction materials, coordinating physical work, identifying defects or irregularities in finished products, using hand and power tools effectively, aligning and placing materials accurately, maintaining tolerances during repetitive production, troubleshooting routine production issues, responding appropriately to process issues, carefully handling human waste, working safely in confined spaces, and recognising hazardous gases and other dangerous conditions, among many others.

> The 'unskilled' status is one the state sustains rather than what naturally arises in society

Stratified labour market

'Skill' in India has become an occupational as well as a social category: workers may acquire a considerable amount of embodied knowledge through experience yet remain 'unskilled' in the eyes of institutions because they lack the formal credentials used to recognise, and pay for, skill. India's labour market also remains stratified along caste, class, gender, and, increasingly, migration lines, influencing which forms of labour are considered 'skilled', and so remunerative. The informalisation of jobs – such as municipal corporations hiring contractors to hire sanitation workers on contracts – has also weakened the relationship between competence and occupational status. Ultimately, economic production is sustained on the engagement of millions of workers whose job security it fails to improve.

The Code on Wages requires governments to account for a worker's skill level when fixing minimum wages, together with geographical area, whether the work is arduous or hazardous, and so on. The wage schedules of the Union government then assign floors for workers performing otherwise comparable work. In agriculture, thus, the daily rates in September were ₹528 for unskilled work, ₹578 for semi-skilled work, ₹627 for skilled work, and ₹694 for highly skilled work (in urban centres with the highest costs of living).

Per the government, 'unskilled' agricultural work encompasses weeding and manually watering crops and requires 'only' physical effort and no training or judgment. 'Highly skilled' work, however, demands advanced technical expertise, like calibrating a combine harvester or managing pest outbreaks. But weeding and irrigation also involve learned techniques such as identifying weeds, assessing soil conditions, using tools without damaging plants, and planning work according to weather conditions.

Yet the way India classifies skills, compounded by its preference for institutional recognition, disproportionately concentrates 'unskilled' workers in informal jobs. And the classification is self-reinforcing: lower wages reduce workers' ability to obtain institutional qualifications or avoid precarious employment while precarious employment makes employers less inclined to invest in their workers' training and safety.

mukunth.v@thehindu.co.in

What 107 innings reveal about the Smriti-Shafali opening pair

In their last 15 innings, Shafali's strike rate exceeded 170 and Mandhana's 150, career highs over any 15-innings stretch

DATA POINT

Kapil Gupta

India's new T20I captain Smriti Mandhana and vice-captain Shafali Verma have added 4,080 runs together as openers, 50% more than any other pair in women's T20Is.

On October 6, Smriti was named India's white-ball captain and Shafali her deputy in T20 Internationals (T20Is). India's two leaders are also its openers.

When India meets Zimbabwe in Raipur from October 16, they will face the first ball together. Their partnership is already the most productive in the format. Ball-by-ball data for every women's T20I till October 7 show that in 107 innings since 2019, the two have added 4,080 runs for the first wicket, averaging 39.2 runs per dismissal at 8.34 runs an over.

Australia's Alyssa Healy and Beth Mooney are second with 2,715 runs in 84 innings; the UAE's Esha Oza and Theertha Satish third with 2,588.

The Indian pair also has 32 stands of 50 or more, 12 more than any other pair, and a shared-record six century stands.

The lead is recent: the Indian line steepens from 2025, just as the Australian one stops **(Chart 1)**.

Quick and reliable

Chart 2 compares the 31 opening pairs with at least 20 innings together. A typical pair averages 26 runs per dismissal at under seven an over.

Among the 10 pairs with 1,000-plus runs, none scores faster. England's Danni Wyatt and Sophia Dunkley come closest (8.23 an over) but average 28; South Africa's Laura Wolvaardt and Tazmin Brits average 44.4 but score at 6.85. Only Oman's pair, over just 20 innings, is ahead on both counts. The pairing has changed Smriti too: with Mithali Raj, she opened at 7.07 an over; with Shafali, 8.34.

A pair can average more by surviving longer or by scoring faster. The Indian pair lasts 28 balls per wicket against 25 for other established pairs, but scores over one and a half runs an over faster **(Table 1)**. Of their 11 extra runs per wicket, about seven come from speed and four from staying in longer.

The gap is sharpest in the powerplay: 8.4 an over against 5.8 for other openers, about 15 extra runs in six overs, with boundaries off 22.7% of balls, twice the rate of others. Survival barely differs: 26% of their stands last six overs, against 23%. Bowlers dismiss them as often as any good pair; they just cannot stop the runs first.

After a dip in 2023, when they scored at 7.04 an over, the pair has averaged 48 runs an innings at 9.27 an over since January 2025, against 34 at 7.91 before **(Chart 3)**. Their 973 runs in 2026 are the most in any year.

India won 60 of the 100 completed matches in which this pair opened, but their results varied sharply with the size of the opening stand. When the pair added fewer than 20 runs, India won 51% of matches; for stands of 20-49, the figure was 50%. But once they crossed 50, India won 24 of 29 matches (83%). Until the stand reaches 50, India's win rate barely shifts; beyond it, their chances improve sharply.

Added responsibilities

The appointment puts India's most crucial phase in the hands of its leaders, but carries a risk. In 18% of their innings together, both fell for under 15, leaving India without its captain and vice-captain early. Yet in 65% of innings, at least one scored 30 or more.

Both are currently scoring faster than ever. In their last 15 innings, Shafali's strike rate exceeded 170 and Mandhana's 150, career highs over any 15-innings stretch. The Zimbabwe series will show whether leadership changes their tempo.

Partnership goals

The data for the charts were sourced from Cricsheet (cricsheet.org) ball-by-ball records of women's T20 Internationals till October 7. Run rates use legal deliveries. Win figures exclude ties and no-results

Kapil Gupta is an Assistant Professor of Decision Sciences and Operations Management at IIM Kozhikode

CHART 1: Cumulative opening partnership runs over time for the six most prolific pairs in women's T20Is. Each step represents a partnership

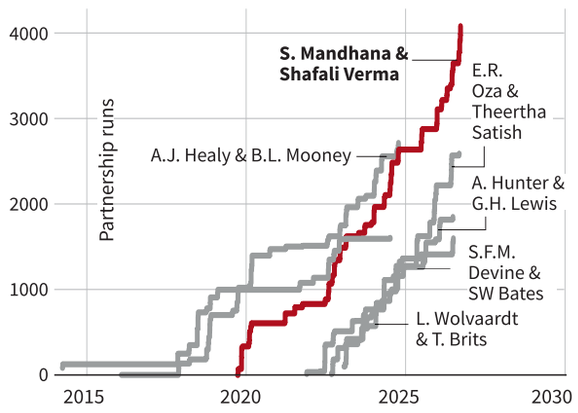


CHART 3: Opening-partnership runs by calendar year, alongside the scoring rate and number of innings. Blue bars represent 2025 and 2026 (through October 7)

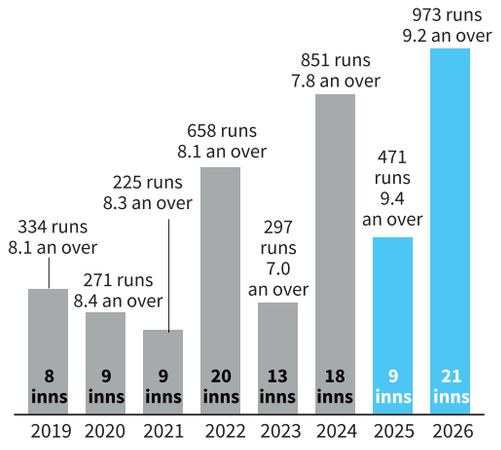


CHART 2: Runs per dismissal versus runs per over. Each circle represents an opening pair with at least 20 innings together. Circle size indicates total runs, while the axes show average runs per dismissal and runs per over. Dashed lines mark the typical pair

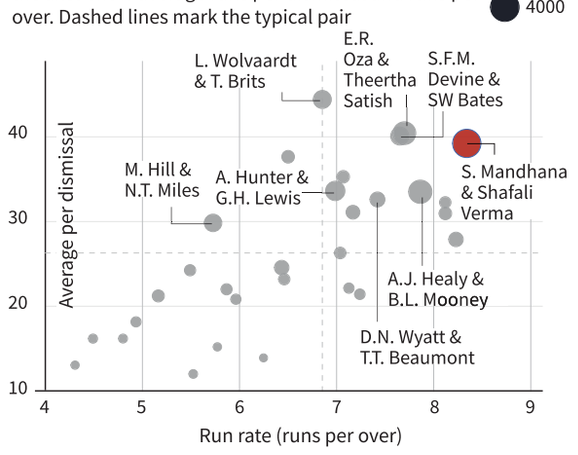


TABLE 1: Comparison of the Smriti-Shafali partnership with other established opening pairs, covering balls faced per wicket, scoring rate and runs per dismissal

Measure	Smriti-Shafali	Other openers
Whole partnership		
Balls faced per wicket	28.2	25.2
Runs per over	8.34	6.79
Runs per dismissal	39.2	28.5
Powerplay (first six overs)		
Powerplay runs per over	8.4	5.8
Powerplay balls hit for four or six	22.7%	11.3%
Powerplay dot balls	46.5%	56.7%
Stands still unbroken after six overs	26%	23%

Note: Powerplay figures count only balls bowled while the opening stand was intact. "Other openers" refers to the other 30 pairs with at least 20 innings together for whole-partnership figures, and all other opening pairs for powerplay figures

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 15, 1976

'Nobody for President' campaign in U.S.

San Francisco, October 14: The 1976 U.S. Presidential campaign is not all Jimmy Carter, Gerry Ford, television debates and fundraising dinners. There's another candidate nobody has yet seen, not even his supporters.

Confetti and tickertape rain down on an open car as it arrives with nobody in the back seat. Nobody is the evening's speaker. Nobody is introduced.

When the cheering dies away, a set of chattering clockwork teeth is placed on the speaker's lectern and clatters on for three minutes.

This is the "Nobody for President" campaign now going into its final weeks with a coast-to-coast tour starting here and ending up in New York on election day, November 2.

Who is behind it? "Nobody" answers campaign organiser Huge Romney, a former poet who calls himself Wavy Gravy.

"We think the office (of President) is ridiculous", he explained in an interview. "I think nobody should have that much power and I want nobody to run my life."

Mr. Gravy claims that Democratic candidate Jimmy Carter may be a tacit supporter of the "Nobody for President" movement.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 15, 1926

Imperial Indian mail

As there was no issue dated October 15, 1926, from the issue dated October 14, 1926

The following is from "The Statesman" of the 13th: A new era as regards comfortable and expedient long-distance railway travelling in India will commence next month, when the East Indian Railway Overland mail train will be replaced by a magnificent train, the Imperial Indian Mail, which, with its handsome colour design of Royal blue and gold, will undoubtedly attract admiring attention throughout its journey from Calcutta to Bombay and vice versa.

Two trains, embodying the latest ideas in luxury travel, are being constructed – one by the East Indian Railway in their Carriage and Wagon Workshops at Lillooah, and the other by the Great Indian Peninsula Railway at Matunga.

'The Statesman' understands that the first train will be sent to Bombay in time to convey to Calcutta.

From Page One

Many youth held as SIR protests rock capital

"We were detained, we were beaten up earlier also. By beating us, they cannot shut us up. Our protests will go on. Until Gyanesh Kumar resigns, we will remain on the roads. We will not back down," a protester said.

Around 800 metres away, Indian Youth Congress workers began a separate march from Patel Chowk Metro Station towards Jantar Mantar. Carrying party flags and placards, they demanded Mr. Kumar's resignation and raised slogans against the Union government.

"Modi*ji*, go back to the tea shop," read one of the placards.

The marchers initially sat outside Patel Chowk Metro Station amid a heavy security presence before proceeding along Ashoka Road. Police continued to warn against unauthorised processions, protests, and gatherings, citing Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita.

The march was stopped near the Parliament Street police station, where protesters were detained and pushed into buses. A few climbed on top of the vehicles and continued raising slogans as the police moved to clear the area.

At both locations, extensive barricading and the deployment of security personnel turned the demonstrations into tense standoffs, with protesters resisting attempts to disperse them and police detaining those who remained on the roads.

Traffic disrupted

The continuing demonstrations disrupted traffic in parts of the New Delhi district on Wednesday. Road closures, barricades, and restrictions imposed to facilitate security arrangements and control the marches led to congestion during the afternoon, leaving commuters navigating diversions and slow-moving traffic. The demonstrations came amid protests and detentions in the national capital since October 10, when the CJP called for a demonstration against SIR and Mr. Kumar.

Will take care of those deleted in Delhi rolls: SC

The application has asked the court to direct the EC to frame an appropriate mechanism for restoration/inclusion of deleted voters without forcing them to apply as first-time voters.

Form 6, prescribed under the Registration of Electors Rules of 1960, requires every applicant to affirm that they are "applying for inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time".

During the enumeration phase of the SIR in Delhi, 47,56,722 electors were excluded from the draft electoral roll under the category of ASDD (Absent, Shifted, Dead or Duplicate). For any person on the ASDD list, the only mechanism for filing a claim for having their name restored in the voter list is through Form 6.

"This creates a fundamental anomaly as all these people were previously enrolled on the voter list but are now required to submit Form 6 and make a declaration that they are seeking inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time, which is factually incorrect and wholly inapplicable to their circumstances," the application said.

Further, it said these persons would become vulnerable to punishment for giving a false declaration under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, which provides for imprisonment for a term which may extend to one year or with fine or with both.

The petition also pointed out that the additional declaration form required to be submitted along with Form 6 was without the force of law and must be struck down.

India's trade deficit with China crosses $100 bn

The widening imbalance has remained a source of concern for New Delhi, with the deficit figuring in last month's talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the BRICS summit.

While India requires large amounts of intermediates from China for manufacturing, the continued reliance on finished goods, including large quantities of electronics and machinery, remains a concern.

India's major exports to China this year have included seafood products, naphtha, and printed circuit boards, which until recently India was buying in bulk from the neighbouring country.

India is also concerned by Chinese export controls in an increasing number of sectors, from fertilizers to rare earths. At last month's meeting in New Delhi, Mr. Modi and Mr. Xi "underlined the need to address each other's concerns, including structural trade imbalance and supply chain issues, and facilitation of meaningful and predictable market access", a statement from the Ministry of External Affairs said. Both leaders also "took note of the progress in people-to-people ties and underscored the need to further promote cultural exchanges, business linkages and greater mobility between the two countries," the statement said, following the normalisation in relations since the October 2024 meeting between the two leaders.

A statement from China's Foreign Ministry after the meeting said the "two sides should also address each other's economic and trade concerns in a balanced way and promote the sound and steady development of economic and trade relations."

Centre seeks public input on demographic changes

Home Ministry's portal invites govt. bodies, public, NGOs and 'international bodies' to submit their views on the impact of these changes on employment, education, healthcare, and local economies

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The demography panel set up by the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has launched a portal to allow government bodies, members of the public, NGOs, and even "international organisations" to submit their input on "frequent demographic changes in the country", preferably post-2011.

The portal said that while these changes are most visibly concentrated in border districts, their impact has extended to affect urban centres, industrial corridors, tribal regions, and other socially and economically sensitive areas, severely impacting public service delivery, local governance, resource distribution, and social cohesion.

It said that these changes are "not attributable to normal fertility or mortality trends but are instead emerging due to external abnormal factors, including illegal immigration, irregular population mobility, and administrative laxity."

The demography panel portal says impact of changes has extended from border districts to urban centres. FILE PHOTO

The Ministry said that the inputs will help the panel to analyse and identify the causes of demographic changes and to recommend a well-organised and permanent operational system for the "legal, fair, and time-bound identification, detention, and deportation of illegal immigrants residing in the country".

The portal mandatorily seeks the mobile phone number, address, and e-mail ID of the respondents, and seeks their consent for the processing of their personal data and analysis of the information provided.

The portal – https://demography.mha.gov.in – says that the High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC), chaired by former Supreme Court judge Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar, was constituted on May 26 to study the "nature, causes and consequences of demographic changes being observed in various parts of the country".

The respondents have been divided into three categories: Union government Ministries, departments, and organisations; State governments and Union Territory administrations; civil society organisations, NGOs, academic institutions, industry and business associations, international organisations, and think tanks; and individual citizens, public representatives, students, and others.

There are eight questions under the individual citizen/public representative/student/others category. One of the questions asks the respondent to "describe the major demographic changes" observed or studied over the past 15 years in the geographical areas the respondent is familiar with, such as villages, towns, cities, districts, States/UTs, regions, or "across India."

The survey seeks views on the principal drivers behind these changes and their impact on sectors such as employment, education, healthcare, housing, infrastructure, public services, the environment, social harmony, and local economies. It also invites respondents to identify challenges arising from demographic trends, highlight successful interventions by governments, local bodies or academic institutions, and share any research, reports, datasets or other evidence relevant to demographic issues.

₹53,428 cr. cleared for social assistance scheme till 2030-31

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Govt. announces the renaming of NSAP as Pradhan Mantri Samajik Sahayata Yojana

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved an outlay of ₹53,428 crore for the continuation of the National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP) for five years, from 2026-27 to 2030-31. It has also renamed the scheme and removed the "Indira Gandhi" prefix from three sub-schemes covering old-age, widow and disability pensions.

The Cabinet also revised the eligibility criteria and assistance rates for disability pension beneficiaries.

The government statement spoke of "continuation of pension schemes for old age and widows and the family benefit scheme in its existing form". The decision to lock in the budget for the next five years has raised questions, with critics arguing that NSAP is already inadequate to meet current socio-economic realities. Unlike several other welfare schemes that use the 2011 Socio-Economic and Caste Census (SECC) data to identify beneficiaries, NSAP caps the beneficiary base for its three pension schemes at 3.09 crore.

"Realising Rights: A Handbook of Welfare in India", published by Azim Premji University, notes that since this ceiling is "neither defined by administrative capacity nor the actual number of eligible rights holders, eligibility as determined in the guidelines does not translate into an entitlement in practice".

Rajendran Narayanan, Associate Professor at Azim Premji University said the decision overlooked the need for pension outlays to keep pace with demographic changes and inflation. "The decision appears to assume that the number of beneficiaries will remain static. Even for the existing beneficiary base, a back-of-the-envelope calculation using a 5% inflation rate shows that ₹55,698 crore would be required," he said.

The government also said that NSAP will be renamed the Pradhan Mantri Samajik Sahayata Yojana.

Canadian Minister highlights scope for closer ties with India

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

India-Canada relations have "enormous potential" amidst an uncertain global scenario, Canada's Foreign Minister Anita Anand said here on Wednesday. Ms. Anand met Prime Minister Narendra Modi and External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar as the two countries reviewed a wide range of issues, including a trade pact and the conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine.

"Nearly 80 years of diplomatic ties have been enriched by generations of families, students and entrepreneurs who have brought our countries closer," said Ms. Anand on X.

Anita Anand

"Canada and India have enormous potential to shape a more prosperous future, together," she said.

Ms. Anand and Mr. Jaishankar participated in a panel discussion titled "Middle Power Moment" along with former British Prime Minister Rishi Sunak and former Australian Prime Minister Kevin Rudd on Wednesday.

Boat that capsized in Bihar had a hole and was overloaded, say police

Amit Bhelari
RAGHOPUR (VAISHALI)

The boat, which capsized in the Ganga in Vaishali district of Bihar on Tuesday, killing 13 minors, was dilapidated with a hole in the deck and was overloaded, police said on Wednesday.

The Vaishali police said the country-made boat could barely carry five people and had sailed after sunset, violating the rules. They said water had entered through the hole.

The Vaishali district administration issued show cause notices to the circle officer and station house officer of Raghopur. The Patna and Bhagalpur district authorities sounded alerts over plying of boats in the Ganga.

Family members mourn the death of a relative who drowned after a boat capsized in the Ganga in Vaishali district on Tuesday. ANI

District Magistrate Varsha Singh said, "Action will be taken against the boat owner, the operator, and everyone involved, including the officials responsible for monitoring the situation. It was a private boat."

"It is the responsibility of the circle officer and the station house officer to prevent such activities by remaining alert and utilising their administrative machinery," she added.

Authorities called off the search operation even as people at Rampur Shyamchand village in Raghopur mourned the deaths.

Union Minister Chirag Paswan, who met the families, said, "If negligence had happened at any level, action will be taken."

Bihar Deputy Chief Minister Bijendra Prasad Yadav and State Cooperative Minister Ram Kripal Yadav visited the incident site on the instructions of Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary and spoke to the family members.

Health Minister Nishant Kumar visited Nalanda Medical College and Hospital and met the injured.

Ms. Singh handed over cheques for ₹4 lakh, the ex gratia amount announced by the Chief Minister, to each family.

Rahul and Priyanka meet kin of Ankita Bhandari

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and his sister, Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, on Wednesday met the parents of the late Ankita Bhandari, who were staging a sit-in protest near India Gate against the appointment of Dushyant Kumar Gautam as the Governor of Sikkim.

Bhandari, who had worked at the Vanantra Resort in Uttarakhand, was killed in 2022 by her employer, Pulkit Arya, the son of a BJP leader, and two of his aides. In August 2025, a sessions court sentenced the three accused to life imprisonment.

Bhandari's kin has continued to demand a probe into the alleged VIP angle in the case. Her parents alleged that Mr. Gautam, a former Rajya Sabha MP and BJP general secretary, was the VIP in question.

Rajnath calls for deeper India-ASEAN defence ties

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Wednesday called for deeper defence and technological cooperation between India and the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN), pitching for joint research, co-production of military equipment and enhanced maritime security to address emerging regional challenges.

Addressing the maiden ASEAN-India Defence Think Tank Forum at the Manohar Parrikar Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses in New Delhi, Mr. Singh said India sought an Indo-Pacific where countries, irrespective of their size, could make independent choices, protect their interests and pursue development peacefully.

He called for mutual trust, respect for sovereignty, adherence to international law and keeping channels of dialogue open

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and DG MP-IDSA Ambassador Sujan R. Chinoy during the ASEAN-India Defence Think Tank Forum. ANI

to address conventional and emerging security threats. "India believes that security is strengthened when countries build capacity together, respect international law and maintain trust through dialogue," he said.

Mr. Singh said India's Act East policy, along with its SAGAR (Security and Growth for All in the Region) and MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions) visions, aligned with ASEAN-led mechanisms central to New Delhi's Indo-Pacific approach.

Highlighting the shared maritime interests of India and Southeast Asian nations, he said cooperation in maritime domain awareness, interoperability and underwater surveillance was essential to maintaining a stable, rules-based maritime order. Designating 2026 as the ASEAN-India Year of Maritime Cooperation offered an opportunity to translate common interests into practical outcomes, he added.

Court makes arrest protection given to journalist 'absolute'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Abhishek Upadhyay had authored reports on the alleged theft of donations from the Ram Temple

The Supreme Court on Wednesday made absolute the interim protection granted to independent journalist Abhishek Upadhyay from coercive action in a road rage case, as well as any subsequent first information reports (FIR).

Mr. Upadhyay had authored investigative online stories on the alleged misappropriation and theft of donations at the Ayodhya Ram Temple.

A Bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi also quashed an Uttar Pradesh Police notice issued to social media platform X to provide Mr. Upadhyay's digital data, generated around three months prior to the road rage incident.

The court found the police version that the data was sought to trace/arrest the petitioner "somewhat in contradiction" with the contents of its notice to the platform.

The court said that any information received by the police pursuant to the notice would not be used against the journalist.

The "arrest of the petitioner shall remain stayed till further notice", the court said. It made absolute its interim orders of August 25 and September 7, which had protected him from arrest and directed him to cooperate with the investigation, respectively.

The Bench ordered that Mr. Upadhyay could challenge the road rage FIR on any grounds. The court has not commented on the merits of the case.

Don't stand in the way of students: Rahul to govt.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday asked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Minister Amit Shah not to stand in the way of protesting students, describing them as the voice of India.

Mr. Gandhi made the remarks after he met students, including activists of the party's students' wing, the National Students' Union of India (NSUI), who were injured during protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral irregularities.

He asked the students to introduce themselves, narrate their ordeal after Delhi Police personnel picked them up from the protesting sites, and then, urged the students to form a human chain.

"Amit Shah *ji*, look at this properly. Here there is no Hindu, no Muslim, no caste, no gender. There is one voice, one protest – it is the voice of Hindustan," he said. Mr. Gandhi described the students as the party's *shers* and *shernis* (lions and lionesses) and assured them that the Congress would stand by them.

CJP leaders jailed for entering Jantar Mantar

Police register FIRs against 14 CJP members, alleging trespass, obstruction of personnel on duty; Dipke accuses govt. of imposing 'unofficial Emergency'; peaceful protest is not a crime, says Rahul

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Cockroach Janta Party leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were remanded in judicial custody for five days on Wednesday, a day after they were detained along with 12 others for allegedly entering Jantar Mantar, which the Delhi Police denotified as a designated protest site on Monday.

The police registered two first information reports (FIRs) against them over allegations of trespass, disobedience of official orders, and obstruction of police personnel on duty. Ajinkya Shinde, who was also placed under preventive arrest, was released after furnishing a personal bond and surety of ₹5,000, with an undertaking to maintain peace and good behaviour for six months, according to a police statement.

The CJP members reached Jantar Mantar on Tuesday by passing through private premises. Police personnel deployed at the site attempted to stop them, but the group allegedly obstructed the personnel in the discharge of their official duties, the police said. Subsequently, Mr. Das, Mr. Ranka and Mr. Shinde were placed under preventive arrest over what the police described as repeated attempts to disturb public peace and violate the law. Their attempts to use social media to instigate others to engage in similar activities were also taken into consideration, the police said.

In judicial custody: CJP leaders Ajinkya Shinde, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka in New Delhi on Wednesday. REUTERS

They were produced before a Special Executive Magistrate, where proceedings were initiated under Sections 126 and 170 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS). Section 126 empowers an Executive Magistrate to initiate proceedings when there is reason to believe that a person may breach the peace, and to require an undertaking to maintain peace for a period of up to one year. Section 170 empowers the police to arrest a person without a warrant to prevent the commission of a cognisable offence when it cannot otherwise be prevented.

Reacting to the development, CJP founder Abhijit Dipke accused the Narendra Modi government of imposing an "unofficial Emergency", and questioned why party members had been sent to judicial custody over their protest at Jantar Mantar.

"I want to tell Mr. Modi that if you want to impose an Emergency in the country, do it officially. Why are you running an unofficial emergency where people are sent to five days of detention just for waving the national flag at Jantar Mantar?" he said.

'Act of cowardice'

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, said on X, "Waving the Tricolour at Jantar Mantar in a peaceful protest is not a crime. Jailing youth for it is an act of cowardice."

"Students. Youth. Journalists. The INDIA bloc. Different banners, one cause. All protests are one: citizens demanding their constitutional right. Jantar Mantar belongs to the people of India. We will reclaim it," he said.

Youth organisations took out a protest against the jailing of the leaders.

Denotifying Jantar Mantar pushes dissent 'out of sight, out of mind', says plea in SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court may list for hearing on October 26 a petition challenging the denotification of the area near Jantar Mantar as a designated site of protest in the national capital.

Rendering Jantar Mantar inaccessible will push dissent "out of sight and out of mind", the plea said, noting that a protest carried out far from the earshot of ordinary citizens loses much of its practical impact.

The petition by Swaty Singh, appearing through advocate Akanksha Mehra, was successfully registered and numbered on Wednesday. It has arraigned the Union government and the Delhi Police Commissioner as respondents.

The "right to protest is not merely a right to assemble at a designated physical space", the petition said. "It is a right to communicate grievances, express dissent and draw the attention of the public authorities and society at large towards matters requiring redressal," it said.

The authorities have found three alternative sites, but the petition said they are located on the outskirts of the national capital, far away from the corridors of power, Parliament, Supreme Court, Ministries, and public offices of central Delhi.

Site of protest: Jantar Mantar site's proximity to the power centres makes it a highly visible landmark. PTI

Public accessibility

Ms. Singh said the local protest cannot be dismissed as an "inconsequential administrative consideration". The Jantar Mantar site's proximity to the power centres of the state, accessibility to the public, and visibility to the intended audience may directly affect the power of dissent, she added.

"Relocating protests to distant or outlying areas of Delhi, particularly where such relocation materially increases the burden of participation and distances demonstrators from the authorities to whom their grievances are addressed, may substantially diminish the communicative purpose of peaceful assembly," the petition noted.

Ms. Singh said that while the denotification order was imposed with immediate administrative effect, amidst the ongoing protest, the government has not issued the Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for protesters to access the three new venues.

"Thus, the standing order, on its face, alters the existing arrangement without itself setting out a complete mechanism governing access to the new venues," the plea said.

Delhi Metro network was 'fully functional' on Oct. 10, says DMRC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Over 85% of the network remained fully operational and functional for commuters, it said

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) and its chairperson filed separate affidavits in the Supreme Court on Wednesday, stating that the Metro network remained "fully functional" on October 10, recording 32 lakh passengers.

"There was zero reduction in the total volume of metro operation or the number of train trips," the DMRC said.

Though the DMRC admitted that commuter traffic was "slightly lower" than the typical 58 lakh passengers on a "normal" second Saturday, it attributed the drop to public caution amid protests rather than administrative paralysis. It said ordinary citizens were "compelled to forgo their usual day-to-day activities".

The day saw heavy security crackdowns in the capital against demonstrations demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Petitioners like CPI (M) general secretary M.A. Baby and advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi had argued that widespread barricading and station closures violated an October 9 order mandating proportionate movement restrictions.

Defending its actions, the DMRC said entry and exit regulations were limited to 45 of the network's 303 stations on October 10.

"Over 85% of the network (258 stations) remained fully operational, accessible, and functional for commuters," it said.

SC to hear Opposition's plea on SIR, CEC today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court will hear on Thursday a joint petition filed by Opposition leaders led by Rahul Gandhi seeking a full disclosure of "files, agendas, minutes, notings and objections" recorded by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi on the special intensive revision (SIR).

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi are presiding over the Bench.

Mr. Gandhi sought an interim direction to suspend the SIR pending consideration and adjudication of the issues raised in the petition in order to protect the rights of eligible electors and preserving the integrity of the electoral process. Petitions challenging the police crackdown on protesters are also listed before the Bench.

Questions raised over police's failure to make prohibitory orders public

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The detention of protesters across the national capital while demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral irregularities has raised questions over the Delhi Police's failure to make publicly available Section 163 prohibitory orders that it says are in force.

The provision empowers an Executive Magistrate to issue written orders when "immediate prevention or a speedy remedy" is necessary to prevent danger to human life or safety, disturbance of public tranquillity, or other specified threats.

A Section 163 BNSS order accessed by *The Hindu*, issued on August 23 by Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Ajay Sharma, shows the restrictions are confined to the Parliament Street police sub-division and expressly exclude a specifically demarcated area on Jantar Mantar Road. The order, in force until October 21, prohibits assembly of five or more persons, public meetings, processions, slogan-shouting, and speeches, among other activities.

No clarity: Students being detained during a protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Delhi Police sources refused to confirm to *The Hindu* whether separate Section 163 BNSS orders for the other sub-divisions of New Delhi district – Connaught Place, Chanakyapuri and Barakhamba Road – or for the Jantar Mantar area had been made publicly available. They said hoardings had been put up and announcements were being made in these areas informing people that prohibitory orders were in force.

Former Supreme Court judge Abhay S. Oka said making prohibitory orders publicly available was necessary to give effect to the statutory right under Section 163(5) of the BNSS, which allows an aggrieved person to seek their rescission or alteration.

"When sub-section (5) of Section 163 expressly gives liberty to any person aggrieved by prohibitory orders to apply for modification or cancellation, there is a statutory mandate that the orders be published in the public domain. They cannot be kept confidential," Mr. Oka said. He added that public announcements or hoardings merely stating that prohibitory orders were in force would not satisfy this requirement.

Delhi-based advocate Abhinav Sekhri said the lack of public access to such orders was not new.

"For our research [for a report], we got access to a lot of these orders through Right to Information responses," he said. He pointed to the practice of reissuing "cyclostyled" orders as soon as their two-month statutory limit expired.

(With inputs from Vijaita Singh and Lavpreet Kaur)

Cong. slams Shah over 'infiltrators' remark

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Wednesday asked Union Minister Amit Shah to disclose how many alleged infiltrators had been detected, deleted from electoral rolls, and deported following the special intensive revision.

It accused the Centre of invoking the infiltration issue to divert attention from its allegations of large-scale disenfranchisement. Mr. Shah had accused Congress leader Rahul Gandhi of wanting to get infiltrators registered as voters.

"How many *ghuspaithiye* (infiltrators) were detected? How many *ghuspaithiye* were deleted? How many *ghuspaithiye* were deported," Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said.

He asked whether Mr. Shah was suggesting that the nearly 14 crore people allegedly deprived of their rights were infiltrators.

In battle of cultural narratives, Rahul blends Puranic lore and pop culture idioms

NEWS ANALYSIS

Anuj Kumar

One of the key takeaways from Rahul Gandhi's press conference on Monday was his use of *Shivji ki Baraat* to counter the BJP's narrative of top-down command and control with the Opposition's fluid, decentralised style of protest.

Shivji Ki Baraat refers to the highly unusual wedding procession of Lord Shiva as he travelled to marry Goddess Parvati. This event is central to Hindu texts like the Shiva Purana and Tulsidas's *Ramcharitmanas*. By embedding Puranic iconography into a press conference about institutional accountability, Mr. Gandhi challenged the BJP's monopoly on religious symbolism.

It is said Lord Shiva's wedding procession was an unprecedented gathering that brought together entities who were otherwise bitter enemies or social outcasts. With the INDIA alliance partners led by Yadav heirs (Akhilesh and Tejaswi) of Mandal politics on one side and the emerging face of Left politics, Neha Bora, on the other, Mr. Gandhi attempted to translate the Opposition's fight into a multi-polar collective where there is no singular 'leader' on a pedestal.

Counter imagery

The BJP leadership quickly moved to counter the imagery, aggressively reframing the metaphor to fit their established political play book. Top Ministers counter-attacked by invoking polarising terms, calling the alliance a "*Huddangiyo ki Jamaat*" (a congregation of anarchists). Despite the push-back, political observers note that Mr. Gandhi's shift to present internal contradictions as Shaivite imagery of cosmic dissidence is giving the Opposition momentum as the BJP's imagination of a moral kingdom of Ram Rajya develops cracks.

By stating that the movement is "*Tandav*, Lord Shiva's dance" and there is "no need for a plan", Mr. Gandhi subverted the BJP's frequent criticism of the Opposition being "disorganised" or "chaotic", recasting their unpredictable moves as an organic, divine, and unstoppable force.

When Mr Gandhi said, "Anyone can join *Shivji ki baraat*... any living creature (*jeev*) can come, we will not stop them," he perhaps implicitly acknowledged the highly unconventional alliance of diverse political forces, ranging from the unyielding street resistance of Left-wing student groups to the fiercely independent Cockroach Janta Party. He addressed the image of a Khichdi (hodgepodge) coalition with no ideological unity and a common goal for the *baraat*: protecting the Constitution and democratic institutions against perceived over-centralisation.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi helps party chief Mallikarjun Kharge put on a Batman mask during a march in New Delhi. REUTERS

Mr. Gandhi also contrasted the fluidity of the protest with a more rigid political structure, historically which he described as having a designated "king", and an "operator", and where the public followed behind the chariot, suggesting that the public has moved on from the era of Rath Yatras.

While Mr. Gandhi has used the Lord Shiva's symbols inside Parliament, such as showing the *Abhaya Mudra* or posters of deities, to talk about fearlessness, this press conference was different because the metaphor materialised into real-time action on the streets and prime-time television within minutes.

Digital creators responded with Instagram reels of Neha Bora's temple run from R.K. Ashram Marg to Connaught Place with the popular background song, *Jab Zid Par Aa Gayi Parvati* (When Parvati stood her ground) from Hanuman Ansh. The song has been a rage, but by shifting the context, it has come to signify fierce feminine resistance to authority.

Over the years, Faiz Ahmad Faiz's *Hum Dekhenge* has been the default soundtrack of the progressive Leftist movement, but this Navaratri, social media is abuzz with the popular devotional number, *Sabse Bada Tera Naam O Sheronwali* (Suhag), with visuals of women protesters being detained.

Batman connection

At the same time, the Congress IT cell is working on casting Mr. Gandhi as Batman. It started with an "Ask me anything" session on Instagram in August, where a user asked Mr. Gandhi if he was Batman. When Mr. Gandhi was filmed scaling high yellow police barricades, the party's social media team spliced this footage with cinematic clips of Batman overlooking Gotham City, cementing the imagery.

During the march, a supporter passed a Batman mask through the crowd to the bus carrying senior Opposition leaders. Mr. Gandhi posed with the mask and helped Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge try it on as well.

The ruling party accused the Opposition of turning serious debate into a theatrical pop culture stunt, with Minister Jayant Chaudhary posting "Delhi isn't Gotham, and we don't need a dark superhero and Robin" on X.

A young Congress worker said that Gotham City people also believed they did not need a superhero. On a deeper, mythological level, he said, the imagery of Lord Shiva and Batman shows striking parallels.

By deploying both symbols simultaneously during the protests, the party tapped into a shared psychological image of the "righteous outsider" fighting a "compromised institutional framework" to protect ordinary citizens.

INBRIEF

4 Indian airlines cancel flights to Saudi Arabia till October 17

IndiGo, Air India Express, Air India, and Akasa Air on Tuesday announced cancelling flights connecting Saudi Arabian cities in view of the evolving situation in the Gulf country. IndiGo said that flights to and from Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Madinah stand cancelled until October 17. While announcing cancellation of flights to and from Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah till October 17, Air India said it was closely monitoring and assessing the developments in the region. The airline said it was offering a full refund on cancellation for the affected passengers. Meanwhile, Akasa Air said it has extended the suspension of all flights to and from Riyadh and Jeddah until October 17. PTI

Power bank model banned on flights after fire incident

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has prohibited MOBIKINS MK-PB-04 power bank on all flights to, from and within India. This comes after a power bank on an IndiGo flight from Chandigarh to Chennai exploded inside the overhead bin on October 11, forcing the flight to divert to Hyderabad, where emergency evacuation was carried out. In an airworthiness information circular (AIC) dated September 29, 2026, the DGCA directed airlines and passengers to ensure that the specified power bank is not carried on board aircraft, either as passenger baggage or as cargo. The prohibition covers both checked-in and cabin baggage. The circular cites potential safety risks associated with the device.

SC mandates insurance on offline railway tickets too

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court has issued a mandatory directive that tickets sold across counters at every railway station nationwide must include travel insurance coverage identical to online bookings. A Bench of Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and R. Mahadevan directed the railway authorities to put the order into effect from October 27, 2026.

The order warned that failure to implement this mechanism would place direct liability squarely on the Railway Board. "At present, only people purchasing tickets online are provided the benefit of insurance coverage upon payment of a nominal additional amount. The court had granted sufficient time to the authorities to devise a mechanism extending such coverage to persons belonging to the lowest strata of society, who, in most cases, purchase their tickets at the railway reservation counters," the court observed, pointing out that the Railways had made no progress on providing insurance cover to all passengers.

The direction was based on a writ petition filed in the aftermath of the June 2023 Odisha train accident.

No order yet on extra 50 days of work for FRA title holders

Adivasis were entitled to additional work under MGNREGA; VB-G RAM G Act, which guarantees 125 days of employment per household in a year, has no tier for beneficiaries of Forest Rights Act

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

In the absence of a notification, uncertainty continues over work opportunities for Adivasi households holding FRA titles. FILE PHOTO

Uncertainty continues for Adivasi households holding Forest Rights Act (FRA) titles, who were entitled under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) to an additional 50 days of work over and above the 100-day annual guarantee under the UPA-era law. The new rural employment programme, the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act (VB-G RAM G), which was rolled out on July 1, is yet to issue a notification clarifying the status of this entitlement.

In a reply dated October 6 to an application under the Right to Information Act filed by Chakkradhar Buddha of the National Campaign for People's Right to Information (NCPRI), the Rural Development Ministry said that "no separate order, circular or guideline prescribing any additional wage employment entitlement for FRA title holders under VB-G RAM G has been issued as on date".

The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025, guarantees 125 days of wage employment per rural household in a financial year. It has no separate tier for FRA title holders. Section 5(4) states that the Centre or a State government may provide work beyond the guaranteed days within the limits of its economic capacity. The provision is discretionary and names no specific group. Section 7 allows the Centre, on a State's recommendation, to grant relaxations during natural calamities, including enhanced wage-employment provisioning.

In the absence of such a notification, uncertainty continues over whether Adivasi households holding FRA titles will receive only 125 days of guaranteed employment, on a par with other beneficiaries across the country, or 175 days, including the additional 50 days of employment available to them under MGNREGA.

Sources in the Ministry said the government would shortly be issuing a notification approving an additional 50 days of work.

"As there are six more months still available in the financial year, FRA beneficiaries can easily avail of the additional 50 days anytime during this period after completing 125 days," a senior Ministry official said.

Under MGNREGA, the additional entitlement began only in January 2014. An additional 50 days of guaranteed work had first been introduced for drought-prone areas in 2012. Even during the UPA regime, it took at least two years of deliberations within the government before the additional guaranteed work was approved.

The implementation of this additional entitlement has also remained patchy. Andhra Pradesh is the only State that performed well.

Data available with the Union Rural Development Ministry for 2025-26 reveal that under MGNREGA, only 15% of the 14 lakh households eligible for 150 days of work availed themselves of the benefit. Odisha had the highest number of registered households at 3,72,089, of which 71,696 availed themselves of the additional days.

Chhattisgarh had 3,20,651 registered households and 36,716 beneficiaries; Madhya Pradesh had 2,21,674 registered households and 29,065 beneficiaries; Andhra Pradesh had 1,70,851 registered households and 36,008 beneficiaries; Tripura had 1,08,532 registered households and 22,251 beneficiaries; and Maharashtra had 96,559 registered households and 8,063 beneficiaries. These six States account for 12.9 lakh of the registered households.

Railway staff to get bonus equivalent to 78 days' wages

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved payment of productivity-linked bonus (PLB) of 78 days totalling ₹2,009.61 crore to 11,40,770 railway employees.

Union Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said that the bonus was approved in recognition of "the excellent performance by the Railway staff".

Mr. Vaishnaw said payment of PLB to eligible railway employees is made each year before the Durga Puja and Dasara holidays.

"This year also, PLB amount equivalent to 78 days' wages is being paid to about 11.4 lakh non-gazetted Railway employees. The payment of PLB acts as an incentive to motivate the railway employees for working towards improvement in the performance of the Railways," Mr. Vaishnaw said.

The maximum amount payable per eligible railway employee is ₹17,951 for 78 days. The amount will be paid to various categories of Railway staff, such as Track Maintainers, Loco Pilots, Train Managers (Guards), Station Masters, Supervisors, Technicians, and other Group 'C staff'.

BJP women's wing asks for NCW action on Cong. MP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A high-level BJP Mahila Morcha delegation on Wednesday met National Commission for Women (NCW) Chairperson Vijaya Rahatkar and submitted a memorandum seeking action in the alleged sexual harassment case involving Congress MP and former JNU professor Angomcha Bimol Akoijam.

The delegation was led by Mahila Morcha incharge Daggubati Purandeswari and BJP Mahila Morcha national president Roop Kumari Chaudhary.

Ms. Chaudhary said the delegation had urged the NCW Chairperson to take cognisance of the matter. She also questioned the Congress party's "silence" on the issue.

Bauxite mining proposal in Odisha's Balda hills threatens future of rare ground gecko

Divya Gandhi
BENGALURU

Facing oblivion: The Jeypore ground gecko was presumed extinct for 130 years until it was rediscovered in 2010. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

In the crevices of boulders and beneath the rustle of leaf litter in the hills of the Eastern Ghats in Odisha and Andhra Pradesh lives a tiny population of the strikingly-patterned Jeypore ground gecko, which was presumed extinct for 130 years until it was rediscovered in 2010.

Just four individuals of this endangered species have been documented in the past year in Odisha's Balda hills, worryingly, within the site of a proposed bauxite mining project by an Adani-linked group.

The nocturnal gecko, some 3.6 inches long, with a comparatively large head, and a yellow-orange body, was originally documented in 1878 by the British naturalist Richard Henry Beddome. More than a century later, in 2010, herpetologists Ishan Agarwal and Aniruddha Datta-Roy rediscovered a specimen in Odisha's Koraput district.

Later, there were more sightings: one in 2025, and three this year, including one this month. The gecko's behaviour, habits and lifecycle continue to elude scientists.

What is known, however, is that its habitat is fast shrinking. In fact, the habitat where it was first sighted in the 1870s, Potangi in Odisha, has already been lost to bauxite mining by the National Aluminium Company Limited (NALCO), where the animal is believed to be now extinct.

And today, the spectre of Adani's opencast bauxite mine proposal, covering 147 hectares of forest in the Balda hills, within the Nageswari reserve forest, threatens the future of this vulnerable species.

Adivasi uprising

The bauxite mining project has also been the site of much contention among resident Adivasis of the Nageswari reserve forest, who have protested the proposal for the past two years. The Bondo and Porja Adivasis, whose ancestral land this is, lodged a complaint against the Adani-subsidiary Kalinga Alumina Ltd. in February, but to no avail.

"The communities have also applied for forest rights over the hill, which the government has refused to recognise," naturalist Yuvan Aves told *The Hindu*. "There was a demonstration earlier this month too, and when the Adani group flew drones to scope the area, the Adivasi people stopped the exercise, asserting that this is their ancestral land."

Mr. Agarwal said that the gecko is "an ecologically and biogeographically significant species having split from its closest relatives over 20 million years ago." This is a relatively range-restricted species that is only found in high-elevation (900-1,400 metres) forests in the Eastern Ghats. "Anything that threatens their habitat is the major risk. Coffee [though we don't understand to what extent], hydel, mining are all potential threats," he told *The Hindu*.

ED seizes assets worth ₹2,032 cr. of Reliance Power

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has seized assets worth ₹2,032.81 crore belonging to Reliance Power Limited in India under the Foreign Exchange Management Act, the agency said on Wednesday.

The assets include the bank balances of Reliance Power Ltd., and its shareholding in Sasan Power Ltd. Their cumulative value is equivalent to that of foreign exchange held outside India, allegedly in contravention of the Act, according to the ED.

"Investigation was initiated on the basis of information received from the Securities and Exchange Board of India, pertaining to write-offs/provisions aggregating ₹2,101.46 crore made by Reliance Power Ltd. in its books of account. These write-offs were related to overseas investments and advances made to companies in the British Virgin Islands and the Cayman Islands," the ED said.

Meanwhile, Reliance Power Ltd. disputed the allegations, saying it would take all appropriate steps to safeguard its interests, as well as the interests of all its shareholders.

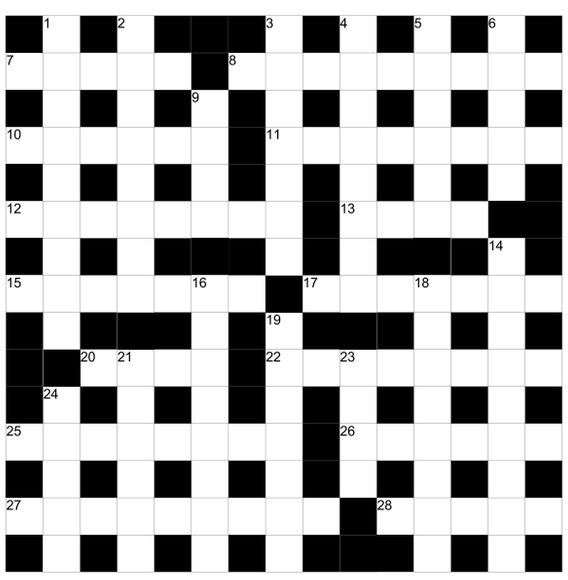
In March, the agency had conducted searches in the same matter. "Investigation has revealed that Reliance Natural Resources Ltd (since merged with Reliance Power Ltd.) raised $300 million through Foreign Currency Convertible Bonds in 2006," it said.

TH CROSSWORD + 14924

(set by Mythical)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



ACROSS

7. Tolerate burn (5)
8. Fighting with others leads individuals nowhere good primarily (9)
10. Some excitement all around? It could make one sick (6)
11. Ill-treats player's family members (8)
12. Attack popular victor when ace returns (8)
13. Be different occasionally! That's good in France (4)
15. Injured kitten ultimately recovered, healed (7)
17. Jogs memory of confused nursemaid after a uniform goes missing (7)
20. Lying about research centre on island somewhere in Indonesia (4)
22. Say, man from Zagreb ordered raincoat (8)
25. Mentioned favour after leader left with communist (8)
26. Bond with judge having lunch (6)
27. A most harsh setter offering sweetener (9)
28. Government control discussed (5)

DOWN

1. Renowned expert to fund books (9)
2. Tense agreement (8)
3. Quietly object to host (7)
4. This group row affected seam bowlers (8)
5. Likely seen going around Presidential Palace (6)
6. Foolish sign painter crossing out every other letter (5)
9. Bill given top quality fruit (4)
14. Notice vehicle near gate needing repair? Good! (9)
16. Resettle girl in Sharjah, perhaps (8)
18. Broke thin reed casually (2,3,3)
19. A scoundrel essentially surveying my school? (7)
21. Rings sound artist in recess (6)
23. Heartily dislike obscenity (4)
24. Basically, brutish evildoer always showing temper (5)

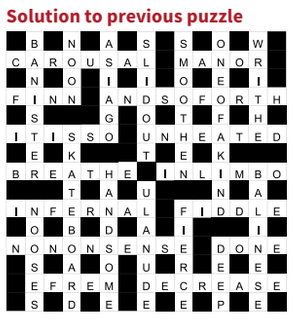
SUDOKU

	7	6						
5			1					
2	8	1				9	5	
	2	8	4	6				
	6			1			2	
				9	7	1	6	
	4	5				3	8	9
					6			7
						2	4	

No.SS7032 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

5	7	1	6	8	2	3	4	9
9	4	3	7	5	1	6	8	2
6	8	2	4	3	9	7	5	1
2	9	8	1	4	6	5	7	3
3	5	7	2	9	8	1	6	4
1	6	4	5	7	3	2	9	8
7	2	9	3	6	4	8	1	5
8	3	6	9	1	5	4	2	7
4	1	5	8	2	7	9	3	6

FAITH

Rejection of Vidura's advice

Dhritarashtra was aware that because of his envy, Duryodhana resorted to cruel ways to suppress the Pandavas, said Kidambi Narayanan in a discourse. He knew that Yudhishthira was being invited to play a game of dice when Sakuni was bent on being dishonest. He didn't lift a finger to stop Dushasana, when he pulled Draupadi's saree, with a view to shaming her in court. Because he knew that his sons were unjust, Dhritarashtra was afraid of public reaction. He was also afraid that the sins of his sons would catch up with them. So, he often sought the advice of Vidura, who was known to be level-headed, righteous and knowledgeable in the dharma sastras. Vidura never tired of answering the king's request for help. Every time he was sent for and asked to offer words of counsel, he did so without hesitation. He told Dhritarashtra how his sons should behave, and what his duties as a king were. When the Pandavas and Draupadi left for the forest, Dhritarashtra was agitated fearing that his subjects might revolt. He sent for Vidura, and sought his advice.

Vidura pointed out to Dhritarashtra how unjust his sons had been and that the only way forward was for Dushasana to apologise to Bhima in the very court in which Draupadi had been humiliated. He also must seek Draupadi's forgiveness, said Vidura. As always, Dhritarashtra was unwilling to accept Vidura's advice. He accused Vidura of being partial to the Pandavas, and of having only their welfare in mind. He felt that Vidura's advice was one-sided, and that if he followed what Vidura advocated it would be unfair to his sons. So he told Vidura to leave the court if he chose.

INBRIEF

Govt. to roll out BS-VII norms for new cars from April 2029

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) is planning to roll out stricter BS-VII emission standards for new cars and SUVs from April 1, 2029, according to a draft gazette notification. The ministry said in an October 12 draft notification that it will implement all new norms in three phases spanning 6 years from April 2029 to April 2035. PTI

Jio Platforms to launch 'India's biggest ever' ₹30,213-cr. IPO

Jio Platforms Ltd. will launch a ₹30,213-crore initial public offering (IPO), making it India's biggest ever, surpassing Hyundai Motor India's ₹27,859-crore issue. The price band has been fixed at ₹1,065-₹1,119 per equity share, with a face value of ₹10. Investors can bid for a minimum of 12 shares and in multiples of 12 thereafter. The IPO will open for subscription on October 21, 2026, and close on Friday, October 23.

Tata Trusts row: Noel, Neville move courts with caveats

Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata and his son Neville have filed caveats in city courts in the row surrounding Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh, sources said on Wednesday. The caveats filed in the Bombay High Court and also in the Mumbai City Civil Court will ensure that they are heard before the passing of any orders. Both the father and son moved the courts with their caveats on October 7, as per official records. PTI

Cabinet okays IDBI Bank sale to Fairfax for ₹52,878 cr.

Largest FDI deal in the financial sector in India's history; with the sale, the government's stake in the bank will decline to 15% and the Life Insurance Corporation's stake will come down to 19%

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved the 'strategic restructuring' of IDBI Bank, with Fairfax set to acquire a stake in the lender for ₹52,878 crore, the Centre announced. With this, the government's stake in the bank will fall to 15% and Life Insurance Corporation's (LIC) stake will come down to 19%.

The government termed the deal a strategic restructuring rather than strategic disinvestment, adding that it would be the largest foreign direct investment in the financial sector in India's history. The government currently holds 45.5% of IDBI Bank, while LIC holds 49.2%.

IDBI Bank, having suffered from poor financial health for years, had been put under a Prompt Corrective Action (PCA) framework in 2017.

In January 2019, LIC took over controlling stake in the bank by infusing ₹21,624 crore into it and being allotted preferential shares in return.

As a result, the government's stake in the bank fell below 51% and the RBI classified it as a private bank since then.

Ailment history: IDBI Bank, which suffered from poor financial health, was put under Prompt Corrective Action in 2017. REUTERS

"It was against this backdrop that the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved strategic restructuring of the IDBI Bank Ltd., and in compliance thereof, it was decided that an aggregate 60.72% of the equity stake in the IDBI Bank Ltd be sold to a strategic buyer, of which, the GoI share would be 30.48% and the LIC share would be 30.24%, leaving a residual shareholding of 15% with the GoI and 19% with the LIC," the government said.

It further said that the winning bidder, out of two parties that finally qualified for bidding, was Canada-headquartered Fairfax Financial Holdings with a bid fixed at ₹81 per share.

Sources in the Ministry of Finance said this strategic restructuring does not change anything for the regulation of the banks or its customer-facing duties.

The bank has seen a significant turnaround in its financial health since it became a private bank. Its gross non-performing asset ratio fell from 31.8% in September 2018 to 2.3% as of March 2026. Its capital adequacy ratio rebounded from 6.22% in 2018 to 26.65% in March 2026. It recorded a net profit of ₹9,513 crore in FY26.

BoB tanks 3.5% as NMC founder sues it for $15 bn

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Bank of Baroda (BoB) shares fell 3.47% to ₹229.35 on the BSE on Wednesday after reports that B.R. Shetty, founder of the failed UAE-based NMC Healthcare, had filed a $15-billion damages suit against the bank and 25 others.

The bank said it had not been served with any such suit. Mr. Shetty, 84, has approached the Bombay High Court, alleging that the defendants acted "as an instrument in the siphoning of funds" that led to the collapse of his business empire. The suit names BoB, 10 current and former bank officers, former NMC executives Prasanth and Promoth Manghat, their family members and associates, and two domestic entities.

The suit seeks $5 billion each in direct and consequential damages jointly and severally against the defendants, besides $5 billion exclusively from BoB for loss of reputation and goodwill, along with 18% annual interest.

BoB said it was pursuing recovery of about ₹2,800 crore from Mr. Shetty and had obtained decrees against him in the UAE and DIFC Courts.

The bank added that a similar suit filed by Mr. Shetty in New York was dismissed in July 2024.

Centre to unveil national power data sharing framework

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Pankaj Agarwal

The government is set to roll out the National Electricity Data Sharing Framework in October to facilitate structured and secure data sharing in the power sector, Pankaj Agarwal, Secretary at the Union Power Ministry, said on Wednesday.

A national-level data governance committee, comprising government officials and industry representatives, will also be constituted to ensure a coordinated approach. The committee will be chaired by the Central Electricity Authority (CEA) Chairperson.

"After consultations with stakeholders, we have prepared the National Electricity Data Sharing framework and would want to assure that we would be launching this in October itself," Mr. Agarwal said. The Power Ministry had floated the draft framework for stakeholder consultation in June.

It lays down broad principles for structured, secure and transparent data sharing, while ensuring non-discriminatory access and protecting critical information infrastructure.

The voluntary framework is intended to help utilities establish common data structures and provide clarity on what information can be shared, enabling startups and other industry players to use large datasets for analysis and decision-making, he told reporters on the sidelines of the Central Electricity Authority's Brainstorming Conclave on the use of artificial intelligence in the sector.

Providing clarity

"The whole idea is to give clarity, rather a starting point to utilities about data sharing – what kind of data they can share, what should be the data structure. If you want the industry, [potentially] start-ups, to utilise the large volume of data sets – then they have to be consistent, similar in structure, so that they can be gainfully leveraged for giving various decision options," Mr. Agarwal said.

Separately, Jitin Prasada, Minister of State for Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), said the government would roll out a policy for data centres, positioning India as a potential destination for hyperscale facilities.

Hyundai Pune unit to get ₹4,000 cr. more

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Hyundai Motor India Ltd. (HMIL) will invest an additional ₹4,000 crore in it's Pune plant by 2030 taking the total to ₹11,000 crore.

The plant's current annual installed capacity of 1,70,000 units will rise in phases to 3,20,000 units by 2030, MD & CEO Tarun Garg said. The firm said it would raise localisation from 83% to 92%.

The plant, the firm's second after Chennai, was opened by Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis.

Euisun Chung, executive chair - Hyundai Motor Group HMG, Jaehoon Chang, vice chair - HMG, José Muñoz, president & CEO - Hyundai Motor Company (HMC) were present.

HMIL also celebrated the achievement of cumulative exports of 4 million passenger vehicles from India since 1999, underscoring its contribution towards establishing India as a global automotive manufacturing and export hub.

Devendra Fadnavis at the Pune plant inauguration.

Mr. Euisun Chung, said, "India is one of Hyundai's most important and strategic markets globally. The inauguration of the Pune plant reflects our long-term commitment to India's growth."

Food, fuel nudge wholesale inflation in Sept. to 11.4%

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Wholesale price inflation rose to 11.4% in September, a record-breaking high during the 2.5 years for which there is data for the new series of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) and a 49-month-high as per the much longer old series on pricier food and fuel.

The new series of the WPI has 2022-23 as base year and so the data goes back till only April 2024. The older series, with base year of 2011-12, has a much longer historical database.

"The non-food manufactured goods (core WPI) segment accounted for more than half of the 147 bps uptick in the headline inflation print in September relative to August 2026, reflecting the impact of the pass-through of input cost pressures," Rahul Agrawal, principal economist at ICRA said.

Inflation in fuel and power rose to 25.85% in September.

Food sharply up

Inflation in the food articles component of the WPI came in at 8.1% in September 2026, up sharply from 5.7% in the previous month. However, this was also on a low base as prices in this component had contracted 6.8% in September last year.

The non-food primary articles segment also saw elevated inflation levels of 10.3% in September though this was the lowest in four months. Inflation in manufactured goods stood at a series-high of 9.8%, up from 8.4% in August 2026.

"The increase in wholesale inflation across food articles, fuel and power, and manufactured products highlights the need for businesses to closely monitor input costs and pricing conditions," Anil Gupta, president, of the PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry said.

Inflation in fuel and power rose to 25.85% in September though this was the highest in only three months with the pace of price rise having been higher in May and June.

SEBI targets 4 lakh accredited investors via expanded AIF

Gowri Lakshmi
MUMBAI

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is likely to issue a circular shortly to expand the framework for alternative investment funds (AIFs), including provisions to recognise assets with high growth potential, said Sandip Pradhan, whole-time member of the capital markets regulator.

"The revised framework is evolving, we already had a board meeting and very soon we will be coming out with a circular that we are also adding one more aspect, that is the assets of high growth or movement in the security market," Mr. Pradhan said at the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) Alternative Investments Summit here.

SEBI will be shortly coming out with a circular on revised AIF.

The inclusion is expected to expand the pool of accredited investors in the AIF industry to four lakh from the current 1 lakh.

AIFs are privately-pooled investment vehicles that raise capital from institutional investors and high-net-worth individuals to invest in alternative asset classes, including unlisted securities and other non-traditional investments. Given exposure to complex and potentially illiquid assets, they carry higher risks and are subject to a regulatory framework distinct from that governing retail investment products.

SEBI's August 2026 consultation paper proposes easing the eligibility criteria for accredited investors. Under Proposal 6, individuals with at least ₹5 crore and companies with at least ₹20 crore invested in securities could qualify, with electronic consolidated account statements (eCAS) or broker statements accepted as proof.

Panel to study issues of sugarcane farmers

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The panel will also examine the demand for revision of the ex-mill Minimum Selling Price of sugar

The Centre set up a four-member panel under former NITI Aayog Member Ramesh Chand to examine issues raised by sugarcane farmers and recommend "appropriate measures" for addressing these. Representatives of sugarcane farmers from Karnataka and Maharashtra met Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan and Union Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution Pralhad Joshi demanding the Centre raise support price for sugarcane.

A release issued by the Union Food Ministry said the panel would examine the demand taking into account cultivation costs and other factors. "It will also examine the demand for revision of the ex-mill Minimum Selling Price (MSP) of sugar in the context of sugar output cost, market realisation and the financial viability of sugar mills.

Other key areas of examination would include existing mechanisms for testing and reporting sugar recovery, steps to ensure transparent verification of recovery and prevailing sugarcane weighment practices at sugar mills.

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED
OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001, Odisha
CIN: U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in
OMC ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LTD. Mining Happiness

CORRIGENDUM

The **National E-auction Notice (19.10.2026 – 219th & 220th E-auction) of Iron Ore CLO & Iron Ore Fines** published in the "Pragativadi, The Hindu and The New Indian Express" dtd.13.10.2026 **has been rescheduled to be held on dt. 21.10.2026 from 11.00 AM to 2.00 PM.**

For details, please visit the website of MSTC i.e. **www.mstcecommerce.com**

Chief General Manager (S&M)

30001/124/2627 OIPR-30001/30005/1/26-27/0095

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED
OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001, Odisha
CIN: U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in
OMC ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LTD. Mining Happiness

CORRIGENDUM

The **National E-auction Notice on dt.19.10.2026 of Manganese Ore** published in the "Pragativadi, The Hindu and The New Indian Express" on dtd.13.10.2026 **has been rescheduled to be held on dt.21.10.2026 from 11.00 AM to 2.00 PM.**

For details, please visit the website of MSTC i.e. **www.mstcecommerce.com**

Chief General Manager (S&M)

30001/125/2627 OIPR-30001/30005/1/26-27/0096

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - e-Procurement Notice
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER,
CENTRAL MINOR IRRIGATION CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR
Phone-0674-2540559 ; Mail ID : cmic.bbsr@gmail.com;
No.1844 /CMIC Date : 12.10.2026

CANCELLATION OF TENDER

Cancellation Notice of Bid Identification No- ACE - CMIC-2 of 2026-27

The e-procurement Notice No-ACE — CMIC-02 of 2026-27 of work ID No-2026-CEMIB_141741_1, invited by the Additional Chief Engineer, Central Minor Irrigation Circle, Bhubaneswar vide letter no 1714 dated- 21.09.2026 is hereby Cancelled due to Technical Error.

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement market place **http.//tendersodisha.gov.in** .

Additional Chief Engineer,
Central M.I.Circle, Bhubaneswar.

32001/1041/2627 OIPR-32001/32047/1/26-27/0005

जवाहरलाल स्नातकोत्तर आयुर्विज्ञान शिक्षा एवं अनुसंधान संस्थान
JAWAHARLAL INSTITUTE OF POSTGRADUATE MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH
(स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार के अधीन राष्ट्रीय महत्व का संस्थान)
(An Institution of National Importance under Ministry of Health & Family Welfare)
भारत सरकार / GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, धन्वंतरि नगर, पुदुच्चेरी / Dhanvantari Nagar, Puducherry- 605 006
वेबसाइट / Website: www.jipmer.edu.in ई—मेल / Email: jipmer.deputation@gmail.com दूरभाष / Phone: 0413-2296022

No. JP/ADMN-1/REC03(1)/1/2026 Dated: 15.10.2026

The Director, JIPMER, Puducherry invites applications from eligible officers of the Central / State / Union Territory Governments / Universities / Central Statutory / Autonomous Bodies / Public Sector Undertakings / Research and Development Organizations for the post of **Financial Advisor** (on deputation basis), as under:

Sl. No	Name of the post	Pay Matrix (as per 7th CPC)	Vacancy
1	**Financial Advisor**	Level-12 (₹78,800 – 2,09,200)	1

The format of the application and other details regarding pay scale, age, qualification, experience and other conditions of eligibility for the above post are available on the JIPMER website **"www.jipmer.edu.in".** The last date for receipt of filled-in applications is **16.11.2026 till 4.30 P.M.**

DIRECTOR

JERUSALEM

Netanyahu says he is not seeking to attack Iran before Israel election

AP

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said on Wednesday that he was not in favour of a pre-emptive strike against Iran before Israel's October 27 election but also warned Tehran and its proxies against striking Israel. "It is not convenient for us, it's no good," Netanyahu said in an interview on Israel's Army Radio. REUTERS

WASHINGTON

Russian diesel deal 'not for us', but for world markets, says Trump

REUTERS

Facing criticism over the diesel deal with Russia, U.S. President Donald Trump said the fuel from Moscow's refineries was meant to stabilise the global market, which has been hit by high prices. "That's a diesel deal. Not for us. That's being released into the world. That's not being released to us," he said on Tuesday. PTI

MIKHMAS

Israeli settlers set fire to mosque, graffiti outside walls in West Bank

REUTERS

Israeli settlers set fire to a mosque and graffitied its outside walls on Wednesday in the occupied West Bank village of Mikhmas, sources and the Israeli military said. Rouhi Fattouh, president of the Palestinian National Council, described the attack as "a barbaric act and a dangerous escalation in settler terrorism". AFP

WASHINGTON

U.S. judge backs *CNN*, *MS Now*, *Politico* access to White House

AFP

A federal judge blocked on Tuesday the White House from banning *CNN*, *MS Now* and *Politico* journalists, following U.S. President Donald Trump's decision to ban the news outlets last month. District Judge Timothy Kelly ruled that the Trump administration must grant the journalists access to the White House. AFP

Houthis vow more strikes on Saudi airports, oil sites after Aramco hit

An attack on Aramco's Dhahran headquarters reportedly caused a blaze spreading across several floors; the group says its strikes on 'legitimate targets' are a retaliation for Saudi attacks on Yemen and the kingdom's support for Yemeni govt. forces

Reuters
RIYADH/DUBAI

Yemen's Houthis (Ansar Allah) vowed on Wednesday to press on with attacks on airports and oil facilities in Saudi Arabia, a day after a strike that sources said caused extensive damage to the headquarters of oil giant Saudi Aramco.

The Houthis said the threatened locations were legitimate targets and described their attacks as retaliation for Saudi strikes on Yemen, threatening to escalate a conflict reignited by the U.S.-Iran confrontation in the Gulf.

Critical strike: The headquarters of Saudi Aramco in Dhahran, Saudi Arabia, before it was attacked on Tuesday night. REUTERS

Saudi Arabia has faced widening Houthi strikes over the past week, including an attack on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh on Saturday that killed 13 people.

Tuesday night's attack on Saudi Aramco's base in the eastern city of Dhahran caused a fire that spread across several floors, three people with knowledge of the matter told *Reuters*. The Saudi Energy Ministry had said the strike caused a limited fire.

Operations at Aramco were continuing normally, with employees working from home, according to two of the sources.

The escalating conflict has dealt a blow to Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman's ambitious plans to transform and diversify the Saudi economy and reduce its reliance on oil.

The Houthis say they have been retaliating for the kingdom's backing of Yemeni government forces in the Yemen war that restarted last month.

The Saudi-led coalition said it had intercepted a ballistic missile fired by the Houthis towards Riyadh on Wednesday, and several loud booms were heard in the Saudi capital.

Saudi authorities earlier issued an alert for a possible aerial threat in Riyadh on Wednesday before the warning was lifted, a witness said.

In their statement on Wednesday, the Houthis said they had launched ballistic missiles, cruise missiles and drones at the Saudi Aramco facilities in Dhahran, Riyadh airport and an Aramco refinery in Riyadh.

Ukraine accuses U.S. of aiding Russia amid strikes

Agence France-Presse
KYIV

Ukrainian firefighters extinguish a blaze at the site of a Russian missile strike at an apartment building in Kyiv on Wednesday. AFP

Ukraine on Wednesday accused the United States of helping Russia, saying Washington failed to warn it of incoming missile strikes and slowed the Starlink system it relies on for its battlefield communications and frontline logistics.

U.S. President Donald Trump on Tuesday insisted Washington was still helping Ukraine, while a U.S. official said on Wednesday that its policy had "not changed". The EU also said there were "no indications" sharing had stopped.

Ballistic missiles have now struck the Ukrainian capital, Kyiv, for two nights running – before air raid sirens could sound in time to warn people to take cover in basements, bomb shelters or metro stations.

Energy facilities were targeted, cutting power to more than 600,000, despite Mr. Trump's surprise announcement of an "energy ceasefire" in the nearly five-year conflict.

"Russia has never before shown such ostentatious disrespect toward the United States," Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said.

Six people were killed and dozens more wounded in Kyiv on Wednesday, the authorities said, while significant damage to facilities and equipment knocked out power to swathes of the city.

UN wants Lebanon stability as UNIFIL mandate nears end

Agence France-Presse
BEIRUT

A visiting senior United Nations official on Wednesday reaffirmed the UN's commitment to stability in Lebanon as the mandate of its peacekeeping force in the country is set to expire.

Under-Secretary-General for Peace Operations Jean-Pierre Lacroix met officials as well as representatives of countries contributing to the UN Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL), which counts some 7,500 personnel from nearly 50 countries.

"I thanked them for their critical support to UNIFIL and reiterated the UN's strong commitment to supporting peace and stability in Lebanon," Mr. Lacroix said.

Jean-Pierre Lacroix

UNIFIL has served as a buffer between Israel and Lebanon since 1978.

Under U.S. pressure, the UN Security Council last year voted to end UNIFIL's mandate on December 31, 2026.

Iran says a ship sank after hitting a mine in Strait of Hormuz

Agence France-Presse
DUBAI

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said on Wednesday that a ship caught fire and sank in the Strait of Hormuz because of a mine, while British security firm Vanguard also reported a sinking.

"A container ship attempting to cross the Strait of Hormuz using an unauthorised and dangerous shipping lane struck a mine that exploded," said the navy of the Revolutionary Guards, the ideological arm of Iran's military.

Images released by the Guards show a plume of black smoke rising from a ship, while dozens of containers that have fallen into the sea float on the water. The Guards said the ship was carrying more than 2,500 containers.

According to Vanguard, the *GFS Pride*, a Singapore-flagged container ship, was struck by a projectile on Tuesday and sank. It was not clear if the two statements referred to the same ship. Vanguard reported three other ships struck on Tuesday, with two of them continuing on their way and the fate of the third unknown.

The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Centre reported on Wednesday that two container ships were struck on Tuesday by projectiles.

Saudi top court sets aside Sri Lankan migrant worker's death sentence

Meera Srinivasan
COLOMBO

The Supreme Court of Saudi Arabia on Wednesday set aside the death penalty awarded to a Sri Lankan migrant worker over a Facebook post that was deemed blasphemous.

"On 13 October 2026, the Supreme Court of Saudi Arabia set aside the judgment imposing the death penalty on Anojan Sivarasa. This follows sustained diplomatic and legal efforts by the Government of Sri Lanka," Sri Lanka's Deputy Foreign Minister Arun Hemachandra announced in a social media post, terming the development "a major relief" for the 24-year-old engineer hailing from the island's eastern Ampara district.

Sivarasa Anojan

According to senior lawyer and President's Counsel Upul Kumarapperuma, who was on the team sent to Riyadh by the Sri Lankan government, Anojan's death penalty was set aside by the Supreme Court of Saudi Arabia and referred to the lower court that originally heard the case. "The case is expected to be heard within two weeks, and a fresh sentence is likely," he told *The Hindu* on Wednesday.

In a social media post, President Anura Kumara Dissanayake said the development "brings immense relief to Anojan, his family, and all Sri Lankans who have followed his case with deep concern". The move "reflects the value of patient diplomacy, respect for the legal processes of a friendly nation, and the tireless work of those who stood by a Sri Lankan citizen abroad," he said, adding: "No Sri Lankan who leaves our shores in search of a livelihood should ever feel that they stand alone."

Anojan's Facebook comment, posted in June this year, was part of a heated exchange among social media users over a video of a Muslim man attacking a dog named Subramani, which had drawn media attention even as it accompanied Hindu pilgrims to the Kataragama temple, a famed shrine for the deity Skanda in southern Sri Lanka. Accused of "verbally insulting and offending Prophet Muhammad", Anojan – who subsequently posted a public apology – was sentenced to five years in prison initially. In September, the Saudi Court of Appeal in the Eastern Region awarded him a death sentence.

BUSINESS CONNECT
A Business Initiative

Joyalukkas Offers 50% Off

Joyalukkas has launched its 'Joywali Diwali' campaign, offering a flat 50 percent off on wastage and making charges across its jewellery range at showrooms across India until November 8, 2026. The offer covers gold, diamond, uncut diamond, precious stone, platinum and silver jewellery. Customers can choose from more their range of over one million designs, ranging from traditional Indian and ethno-contemporary creations to Italian, Turkish and global styles. Customers can also exchange old gold with zero deduction or receive instant cash within 15 minutes. Purchases come with free lifetime maintenance, one year of free insurance and a buyback guarantee. Dr. Joy Alukkas, Chairman and Managing Director, Joyalukkas Group, said, "Diwali celebrates new beginnings and the joy of sharing them with the people we love."

SBI Offers Digital Ticketing Kiosk

State Bank of India (SBI), Chennai Circle, has offered a digital ticketing kiosk at the historic Chennai Museum, Egmore, to enable cashless payments and hassle-free entry. The kiosk was inaugurated by School Education, Tamil Development, Information and Publicity Minister Thiru Rajmohan on October. The event was attended by Baskara Pandiyan, IAS, Director, Chennai Museums; Vivekananda Choubey, Chief General Manager, SBI Chennai Circle; and Sanjeev Kumar, General Manager, SBI Chennai Circle, along with SBI's digital team and museum staff. Established in 1851, the museum is among India's oldest. The initiative aims to reduce queues, simplify ticket booking and enhance visitor convenience through digital payments.

LuLu Opens Retail Stores in Chennai

LuLu Group entered Chennai with two retail outlets at Shenoy Nagar and Chennai Central Metro Stations, inaugurated by Tamil Nadu Assembly Speaker JCD Prabhakar in the presence of Chairman M. A. Yusuff Ali. Ministers Raj Mohan and Venkataramanan, and MLAs Kanimozhi Santhosh and V. K. Ramkumar attended. The Shenoy Nagar facility spans approximately one lakh sq. ft., featuring a hypermarket, LuLu Fashion Store and LuLu Connect. The facility also offers parking for more than 1,000 vehicles. At Chennai Central Metro Station, LuLu Daily spans 35,000 sq. ft., catering to metro commuters and residents in the surrounding areas. Both outlets are open to the public from 9 AM to 11 PM. Yusuff Ali announced plans for a mini mall in Tiruppur and expressed interest in establishing a food processing unit in Tamil Nadu. Other attendees included Executive Director M. A. Asharaf Ali and India CEO M. A. Nishad.

Chennai Port Projects' Inauguration

The Prime Minister inaugurated infrastructure projects worth Rs. 113 crore at Chennai Port Authority to strengthen cargo storage, cruise passenger facilities and seafarer welfare, supporting India's Viksit Bharat 2047 vision. Four EXIM godowns, built at Rs. 51.81 crore, add 18,000 sq. m of covered storage, while paved storage yards developed under the Sagarmala Programme provide 9.9 hectares of cargo-handling space at Rs. 43.55 crore. Cruise terminal improvements, costing Rs. 46 crore, double passenger-handling capacity from 400 to 800 per hour, with upgraded immigration, customs and passenger amenities. The Seafarers' Club, developed at Rs. 16.81 crore, offers accommodation, recreational facilities, a gymnasium, dining areas and essential services for visiting maritime personnel. NBCC executed the cruise terminal and club projects.

Elevate and Bay Window in Chennai

Elevate and Bay Window have opened a new experience showroom in Chennai, inaugurated by Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly Speaker Shri JCD Prabhakar. The showroom brings together Elevate's bespoke modular interiors, including kitchens, wardrobes and storage solutions, and Bay Window's furniture, lighting and décor inspired by global design and Indian sensibilities. Composed like a home and arranged room by room, the showroom brings both brands together as a true one-stop destination — one team, one standard. "Four decades of experience let us design and deliver every element of a home to an exacting standard," said Siddhant Anand, Director, Elevate. Bay Window Co-founder Shivani Anand said the brand aims to make global design accessible to modern Indian homes. Operated by Customise Design Studio, the launch marks the brands' expansion across South India.

SERRANOVA AI Vision-Care

Chennai-based ophthalmologist Dr. D. P. Prakash, Chief Eye Surgeon at American Eye Care Centre, unveiled SERRANOVA, a proprietary Agentic AI-powered vision-care platform, at the Second World Summit on Sustainable Living and Wellbeing at the UN Conference Centre in Bangkok. Addressing the gathering, Dr. Prakash highlighted the economic and social consequences of vision impairment in India. He cited an estimated 70 million people living with vision impairment and 4.9 million people who are blind, arguing that preventable or addressable vision problems can have significant consequences for productivity, livelihoods and quality of life. The system integrates eye assessments, screening for six conditions, referral support and eyewear selection, with clinical decisions remaining under human supervision. Developed around the American Master Vision Testing Protocol, it also introduces the Prakash Perfect Vision Score. Dr. Prakash received the Global Change Maker Award from Dr. Giovanni Jing of UNESCO, Italy, recognising his contribution to eye care and sustainable healthcare.

GREAT FEAT

Hope becomes first Windies batter with three tons in men's T20Is

NAGARA GOPAL

Shai Hope became the first West Indies batter with three hundreds in men's T20Is and the fifth player (after England's Phil Salt, Indians Sanju Samson & Tilak Varma, and Pakistan's Sahibzada Farhan) from a full member nation to do so. Incidentally, each of Hope's T20I centuries have been identical scores of 102 not out.

'SELECTION' TALK

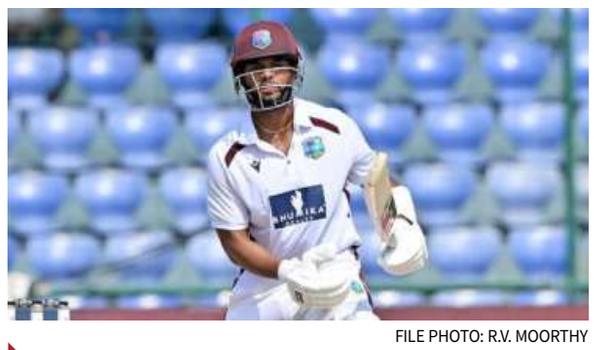
Parthiv doesn't apply, Ojha set to be full-time chairman

FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

Parthiv Patel, tipped to replace Ajit Agarkar as the West Zone representative on the BCCI senior men's selection committee, has not applied for the position, paving the way for Pragyan Ojha to continue as chairman. "The situation could change if the deadline is extended or he changes his mind," a BCCI source said.

A BREAK

Hope rested for West Indies' Test tour of Bangladesh



FILE PHOTO: R.V. MOORTHY

West Indies squad for the two-Test series against Bangladesh: Roston Chase (Capt.), Jomel Warrican, Joshua Bishop, John Campbell, Tagenarine Chanderpaul, Joshua Da Silva, Justin Greaves, Kavem Hodge, Amir Jangoo, Shamar Joseph, Brandon King, Keemo Paul, Kemar Roach, Jayden Seales, Kevin Wickham.

IPL BUZZ

Natarajan returns to SRH, Zeeshan joins DC after player trade

FILE PHOTOS: R.V. MOORTHY & K.V.S. GIRI

Left-arm pacer T. Natarajan returned to Sunrisers Hyderabad while leg-spinner Zeeshan Ansari moved to Delhi Capitals in a player trade between the two IPL franchises on Wednesday. Natarajan will join the 2016 IPL champions for a revised fee of ₹five crore. Zeeshan moves to Delhi Capitals at his existing fee of ₹40 lakh.

Hope and Paul sizzle as West Indies trumps India

The skipper smashes his second century of the series to power the visiting team to 247 before the seamer derails the host's chase with a five-for; the blistering start by Samson not enough

Leading from the front: Hope scored the lion's share of West Indies' runs. NAGARA GOPAL

WI IN INDIA

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

It arrived dressed as a stranger, this refreshed pitch at the Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium, with the promise of a different story. India, squinting into the unknown, chose to chase. But the night peeled back the disguise soon enough, and beneath it lay that same old batting paradise.

Shai Hope's sensational unbeaten century lit the fuse for West Indies' 24-run win over India on Wednesday, dragging the series level at 2-2.

Jewel Andrew, having taken the pitch's measure, got to work for the Windies, raining down on Arshdeep Singh with two boundaries and a six that sailed high over mid-wicket.

Mayank Yadav's pace and bounce backfired, costing him 11 extras.

The visitor tore past 50 in just 15 balls. After Andrew fell to Axar Patel, Shai Hope and Shimron Hetmyer ensured the respite was brief. The Windies registered 79 in the Power-Play, the joint-highest score in this phase (with New Zealand in Thiruvananthapuram earlier this year) against India in T20Is.

The team 100 came in just 42 balls with India reduced to a hapless spectator.

Hope then found a cautious partner in Rovman Powell, who then burst free to help plunder Axar for 22 runs in an over.

Sherfane Rutherford then joined Hope to stitch together a 91-run stand off just 43 balls, Hope raising his arms to celebrate a ton for the second time in the T20I leg.

Sanju Samson loves Hyderabad and his affection shone bright as he clobbered his way to his joint-fastest T20I fifty off 20 balls, with a daunting 248-run chase before him.

Hope turned to executioner of choice Keemo Paul, who came good not once but twice, first striking Samson off the ledger before sending Ishan Kishan back a few deliveries later.

Abhishek Sharma, who regularly renders his partners obsolete, found himself floundering for rhythm.

As the Sunrisers Hyderabad star dealt with his demons, Shreyas Iyer decided to turn aggressor, injecting life back into the packed stands here at Uppal until an athletic effort from Andrew brought an abrupt end.

Just when Abhishek began to find the fence, left-arm spinner Gudakesh Motie struck to remove him and Naman Dhir in consecutive balls. The ask: 116 runs from 48 balls.

Tilak Varma and Nitish Kumar's 32-ball 72 stand lifted hopes high but Paul led the charge with a fifer to dampen any hopes of a win.

Arshdeep retiring hurt was merely the final twist of the knife, hastening a defeat that India tried, in vain, to avoid.

SCOREBOARD

WEST INDIES

Shai Hope (not out) 102 *(50b, 4x4, 9x6)*, Jewel Andrew lbw b Axar 21 *(16b, 2x4, 1x6)*, Shimron Hetmyer c & b Prince 33 *(12b, 4x4, 2x6)*, Rovman Powell c Samson b Arshdeep 24 *(17b, 2x4, 1x6)*, Sherfane Rutherford (not out) 49 *(26b, 4x4, 3x6)*; Extras (lb-4, nb-1, w-13): 18; Total (for three wkts. in 20 overs): 247.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-52 (Andrew, 4.2 overs), 2-110 (Hetmyer, 8.2), 3-156 (Powell, 12.5).

INDIA BOWLING

Mayank 4-0-52-0, Arshdeep 4-0-52-1, Prince 4-0-36-1, Axar 4-0-45-1, Dhir 1-0-19-0, Nitish 3-0-39-0

INDIA

Sanju Samson c Hetmyer b Paul 56 *(23b, 6x4, 4x6)*, Abhishek Sharma c Springer b Motie 29 *(24b, 3x4, 1x6)*, Ishan Kishan c Andrew b Paul 6 *(3b, 1x6)*, Shreyas Iyer c Andrew b Springer 16 *(11b, 2x4)*, Tilak Varma c Powell b Shepherd 43 *(25b, 2x4, 3x6)*, Naman Dhir st. Hope b Motie 0 *(1b)*, Nitish Kumar c Powell b Paul 41 *(20b, 1x4, 4x6)*, Axar Patel c Rutherford b Paul 3 *(5b)*, Prince Yadav b Paul 0 *(1b)*, Arshdeep Singh retd. hurt 5 *(4b, 1x4)*, Mayank Yadav (not out) 0 *(1b)*; Extras (b-4, lb-3, nb-1, w-16): 24; Total (in 19.3 overs): 223.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-60 (Samson, 4.1), 2-67 (Kishan, 4.4), 3-97 (Shreyas, 8.2), 4-130 (Abhishek, 11.3), 5-130 (Dhir, 11.4), 6-200 (Tilak, 16.6), 7-212 (Nitish, 18.2), 8-212 (Prince, 18.3), 9-213 (Axar, 18.5).

WEST INDIES BOWLING

Chase 4-0-43-0, Shamar 2.3-0-47-0, Shepherd 3-0-32-1, Paul 4-0-41-5, Springer 4-0-40-1, Motie 2-0-13-2.

Toss: India; **PoM:** Hope.

West Indies won by 24 runs to level series 2-2.

Fifth and final T20I: October 17, Bengaluru, 7 p.m.

Too hot to handle: Paul ran riot with the ball to seal the win and keep the series alive. NAGARA GOPAL

The bowlers are trying to catch up: Santner

S. Shrivathsan

It is not often that an exceptionally skilled cricketer like Mitchell Santner hopes and prays for a certain setting instead of banking on his box of tricks.

But such has been the ferocity of India's T20 batting that the New Zealand white-ball captain wished for surfaces with some assistance for the bowlers in the forthcoming five-match home series.

"We know how good India is. It has power all the way through, as we have seen against the West Indies with high scores and on flat pitches. Hopefully, the pitches are not too flat here because we know what India can do in small grounds," Santner said during a virtual interaction on Wednesday.

"But if that is the case, we have to find a way to neutralise a powerful attack. We have to turn up, see what is in front of us and adapt as quickly as we can." The left-arm tweaker, who is a master of subtle variations, spelt out possible tactics to keep the batters in check, but it is easier said than done.

"The only way to stop a team like India is by taking wickets throughout [the innings]. It will be good to take wickets in the Power-Play even if we go for a few runs. We need to combat the explosive nature of the batters with plans. In the middle overs, we must see if we can go for six singles [in an over] and apply pressure on them," Santner added.

Santner.
FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

The 34-year-old stressed that the bowlers were left helpless in the shortest format in this day and age. "The batters have adapted faster while the bowlers are trying to catch up. But with the boundary sizes and flat pitches, there is not much we can do."

Santner, however, is not one to shy away from a challenge.

(Watch India tour of New Zealand live and exclusive on Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV starting October 22).

Lot of areas to improve in T20s, says Smriti

ZIM WOMEN IN INDIA

Press Trust of India
RAIPUR

Newly appointed India captain Smriti Mandhana on Wednesday said her team will look to make the most of the six T20Is ahead of the inaugural edition of the Women's Champions Trophy early next year.

Smriti is set to lead India in her first assignment as full-time captain when the hosts take on Zimbabwe in a three-match T20I series starting here on Friday, followed by three ODIs.

"The first bilateral (series) with Zimbabwe, I think, it is very exciting. It is our first time playing against them," said Smriti.

"Sometimes, playing with Zimbabwe and all the Associate nations, it feels like you can learn a lot from them as well because they enjoy playing their cricket."

Smriti said there were a lot of areas of improvement for the Indian team in the shortest format. "We have won the World Cup in the last one-and-a-half-years but there are a few things which we needed to work in the T20 format especially," she said.

"But I would say our strength has been the players who have come in. They've done extremely well."

New era: Smriti is excited about the first-ever series against Zimbabwe. X@BCCIWOMEN

Knights, Marathas continue to excel

APL

Sports Bureau
HYDERABAD

Kakatiya Knights and Mighty Marathas remained on top of the table with 10 points after registering wins over Rajputana Royals and Chola Chiefs in the Archery Premier League Season 2 at People's Plaza on Wednesday.

Yodhas in third spot

In the opening match of the day, Prithivraj Yodhas downed Chero Archers to move into third place with eight points.

Three sudden-death tie-breakers were needed to separate Yodhas and Archers when they met the previous time. In the reverse fixture, however, the former made light work of the latter. Yodhas were led by the 16-year-old recurve archer Gatha Anandrao Khadake, who shot 58 out of a possible 60, and Asian Games compound medallist Ganesh Thirumuru (59). While Yodhas arrested their own mini-slump, Archers slumped to their third straight defeat.

Pulling strings: Gatha was the architect of Yodhas' facile win.
ARCHERY PREMIER LEAGUE

In the day's final contest, Chiefs' woeful run of form continued as they stayed rooted to the bottom with just one win in seven matches, suffering a fifth successive loss.

Five straight wins

In contrast, Marathas, who had started the season with two reverses, have now won five on the bounce.

The scores:

Prithviraj Yodhas bt Chero Archers 5-1 (75-75, 77-75, 77-74).

Kakatiya Knights bt Rajputana Royals 6-2 (74-73, 79-78, 74-75, 76-74).

Mighty Marathas bt Chola Chiefs 6-0 (77-76, 75-72, 78-75).

Bouli's brace helps Punjab edge Odisha

ISL

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

Raphael Messi Bouli enjoyed a dream debut for Punjab FC in the Indian Super League on Wednesday, giving his new club a 2-1 win over Odisha FC at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium.

The 34-year-old, who was a free agent after playing for Jamshedpur last season, remarkably scored in the first and final minute of the game.

All of 39 seconds in, the host opened the scoring through the striker from Cameroon.

With Muhammad Uvais sending in a lovely cross from the left – the pass was perfectly weighted along the turf to carve open the Odisha defence – Bouli had to simply tap the ball into the back of the net.

Punjab had a few other half-chances in the opening exchanges, but Odisha found its footing thereafter. The visitor's equaliser came in the 15th minute. Having been awarded a corner, Lalthathanga Khawlhring exhibited his set-piece prowess by finding an unmarked Thoiba Singh Moirangthem. The 23-year-old from Manipur headed the ball powerfully past Punjab goalkeeper Arshdeep Singh.

Punjab gained the upper hand after the interval. In the 56th minute, Muhammad Suhail did extremely well to run into space on the left flank and cross with the outside of his right boot. The pass picked out Alfred Moya, but the Spaniard's first-time shot sailed well over the crossbar.

Just as the contest seemed set to end in a stalemate, Bouli pounced on a cross from substitute Bishu Sharma on the right wing to seal the deal in the dying seconds of stoppage time.

The result: Punjab FC 2 (Raphael Messi Bouli 1, 90+5) bt Odisha FC 1 (Thoiba Singh Moirangthem 15).

INBRIEF

Harsh packs off Lakshya; Monodip stuns Paranjay

Harsh Marwaha stunned second seed Lakshya Chukka 6-2, 6-4 in a third round boys' under-16 match of the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship in New Delhi on Wednesday. Monodip Dey, the 12th seed, knocked out third-seeded Paranjay Siwach 6-4, 6-4.

Other results (third round): Under-16: Boys: Ribhav Saroha bt Gyansh Manchanda 6-2, 6-4; Yaj Malik bt Kaustubh Singh 6-4, 6-1; Kushagra Arora bt Jeevith Sathish 6-2, 6-0; Vivaan Mirdha bt V. Gunampally 6-3, 6-1.
Girls: Pooja Nagaraj bt T. Sathesh 7-5, 6-1; Aaradhya Meena bt I. Kannan 6-0, 6-2; Akshita Antil bt Vrandika Rajput 7-5, 5-7, 6-1; Ranjhana Sangram bt A. Brahadeeswaran 6-0, 6-1.
Under-14: Boys: Aarav Chhallani bt Jegan Senthil 6-1, 6-2; Puneeth Manohar bt Devansh Kamboj 6-3, 6-3; Nibras Hussain bt Manav Patel 6-3, 6-3; Sparsh Patil bt Aditya Kamat 6-4, 6-1.
Girls: Rishita Yadav bt Sarena Gahlot 6-4, 7-6(3); Sidhhi Pandey bt Tanya Bhatnagar 6-1, 6-1; Zoha Qureshi bt Aaral Vashishta 6-1, 6-1; Aaradhana Tehlan bt P. Vattaprambil 7-5, 6-2.

Sindhu, Lakshya exit in first round; Srikanth, Tanvi win

P.V. Sindhu and Lakshya Sen made early exits while K. Srikanth and Tanvi Sharma advanced to the second round of the Denmark Open badminton in Odense on Tuesday.

The results (first round): Women: Yvonne Li bt P.V. Sindhu 13-21, 25-23, 21-19; Tanvi Sharma bt Natsuki Nidaira 21-17, 16-21, 21-19; Han Qianxi bt Unnati Hooda 23-21, 16-21, 21-16.
Men: Chou Tien Chen bt Lakshya Sen 21-18, 13-21, 21-15; K. Srikanth bt Arnaud Merkle 22-20, 21-19; Alwi Farhan bt Ayush Shetty 21-11, 13-21, 21-10.
Doubles: He Jiting & Ren Xiangyu bt Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty 12-21, 21-15, 21-19.

Ankur, Diya reign supreme in National ranking table tennis

Ankur Bhattacharjee and Diya Chitale lifted the men's and women's titles of the National ranking table tennis tournament, which concluded in Panchkula, Haryana.

The results: Men: Final: Ankur Bhattacharjee (Har) bt Raegan Albuquerque (Mah) 11-8, 3-11, 6-11, 11-8, 11-9, 6-11, 11-5. **Semifinals:** Ankur bt Jeet Chandra (RSPB) 13-11, 8-11, 11-7, 12-10, 11-6; Raegan bt Manav Thakkar (PSPB) 5-11, 11-5, 11-9, 8-11, 12-10, 11-8. **Women: Final:** Diya Chitale (RBI) bt Syndrela Das (WB) 11-6, 11-8, 11-7, 6-11, 9-11, 8-11, 11-9. **Semifinals:** Syndrela bt Sutirtha Mukherjee (RSPB) 9-11, 7-11, 11-4, 11-4, 12-10, 9-11, 11-6; Diya bt Swastika Ghosh (PSPB) 11-4, 8-11, 11-6, 11-9, 11-9.

BCCI steps in to halt forfeitures by Arunachal

The BCCI has stepped in to prevent Arunachal Pradesh from forfeiting further matches this season by organising selection trials for the State's men's and women's teams across age groups and at the senior level. BCCI Apex Council member M. Khairul Jamal Majumdar will convene the selection process, which will be overseen by an independent panel.

LIVE TELECAST

Golf: India Championships, day 1, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 11.30 a.m.
Archery Premier League: Sony LIV app, 7.30 p.m.

TN's match peters out into a draw, Rajasthan picks up three points

The host sets a safe target of 282 which the visitors don't pursue in earnest; Lomror notches up his second half-century of the match; Jagadeesan and Sai Sudharsan get some batting time

RANJI TROPHY

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

For Rajasthan, the final day of the Elite Group-D Ranji Trophy match against Tamil Nadu at the Sawai Mansingh Stadium here on Wednesday was a matter of prudence. Assured of three points for its first-innings lead, it batted to set a safe target. Tamil Nadu, needing 282 runs in just under two sessions, chose preservation over adventure. By tea, the captains shook hands, settling for a draw.

In the morning session, Kartik Sharma (42) offered another glimpse of his attacking instinct, standing tall to launch Saravana Kumar over long-off for six. The 20-year-old had supplied a bit of adventure in the final session on Tuesday, hitting Washington Sundar to deep mid-wicket for six before ducking under a bouncer from Deepesh and guiding it over the 'keeper's head for four.

Time was of the essence if Tamil Nadu was to push for a win, and new coach Yo Mahesh embodied that sense of urgency.

Innovative: Lomror's knock was embellished with some delightful strokes. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Like a football manager on the touchline, he was constantly on the edge. He paced the boundary, relayed instructions, and lived almost every ball on his feet.

When Sai Kishore trapped Kartik plumb in front, he was elated.

But Mahipal Lomror brought up his second fifty of the match (84, 170b, 7x4) and added 83 runs for the sixth wicket with Kukna Ajay Singh (32 n.o.).

Lomror's knock featured a scoop attempt against pace, a pull off Saravana Kumar to wide long-on for four, and back-to-back sweeps off Washington to deep square leg for fours. After lunch, he missed a sweep to be bowled by Washington, prompting Rajasthan to declare.

Tamil Nadu openers Jagadeesan (42 n.o.) and Sai Sudharsan (26 n.o.) put on an unbroken 73-run stand.

The scores:

Rajasthan — 1st innings: 363.
Tamil Nadu — 1st innings: 274.
Rajasthan — 2nd innings: Sachin Yadav b Sai Kishore 0, Rohan Rajbhar st. Jagadeesan b Sai Kishore 10, Sumit Godara c Sonu b Saravana Kumar 2, Karan Lamba b Sonu 13, Mahipal Lomror b Washington 84, Kartik Sharma lbw b Sai Kishore 42, Kukna Ajay Singh (not out) 32; Extras (b-2, lb-5, w-2): 9; Total (for six wkts. decl. in 70.1 overs): 192.
Fall of wickets: 1-0, 2-3, 3-25, 4-31, 5-109, 6-192.
Tamil Nadu bowling: Sai Kishore 26-3-50-3, Saravana Kumar 10-2-27-1, Washington 19.1-4-44-1, Sonu 7-0-21-1, Deepesh 6-0-38-0, Pradosh Ranjan Paul 2-0-5-0.
Tamil Nadu — 2nd innings: Sai Sudharsan (not out) 26, N. Jagadeesan (not out) 42; Extras (b-2, lb-3): 5; Total (for no loss in 23 overs): 73.
Rajasthan bowling: Suthar 12-4-24-0, Akash 2-0-2-0, Kukna 9-0-42-0.

RANJI TROPHY SCORES — ROUND ONE, FOURTH & FINAL DAY

Productive spell: Andhra's Lalith scalped five in Karnataka's second innings. K.V.S. GIRI

Elite: Group A: At Panaji: Baroda 472/8 decl. bt Goa 199 & 138 in 68 overs (Shivendra Bhujbal 46, Abhinav Tejrana 47, Mahesh Pithiya 4/66, Bhargav Bhatt 5/32). **Points: Goa 0(0), Baroda 7(7).**
At Srinagar: Madhya Pradesh 196 & 249/6 decl. in 80 overs (Shubham Sharma 106 n.o.) drew with Jammu & Kashmir 120 & 88/7 in 34 overs. **J&K 1(1), MP 3(3).**
At Nagpur: Vidarbha 428 & 175/3 decl. in 36 overs (Aman Mokhade 65, Dhruv Shorey 69 n.o.) bt Pondicherry 313 & 130 in 41.1 overs (Prasad Pawar 48, Harsh Dubey 4/29). **Vidarbha 6(6), Pondicherry 0(0).**
Group B: At Vijayawada: Karnataka 274 & 337/9 decl. in 103 overs (Manvanth Kumar 44, Karun Nair 155 n.o., Lalith Mohan 5/117) drew with Andhra 418 & 104/4 in 44 overs. **Andhra 3(3), Karnataka 1(1).**
At New Chandigarh: Assam 373 & 157/6 in 61 overs (Denish Das 45) drew with Punjab 478/6 decl. in 127 overs (Vihaan Malhotra 103, Harnoor Singh 54, Salil Arora 110, Emanjot Singh Chahal 114 n.o.). **Punjab 3(3), Assam 1(1).**
At Rajkot: Saurashtra 392 & 229/1 in 67 overs (Harvik Desai 68, Chirag Jani 127 n.o.) drew with Chhattisgarh 312. **Saurashtra 3(3), Chhattisgarh 1(1).**
Group C: At Jamshedpur: Jharkhand 587 drew with Kerala 395 in 127.5 overs (Abhishek P. Nair 126, Rohan Kunnummal 44, Salman Nizar 43, Aditya Sarvate 95, Manishi Singh 4/92, Utkarsh Singh 4/69) & 62/2 in 19.3 overs. **Jharkhand 3(3), Kerala 1(1).**
At Kalyani: Delhi 240 & 277 in 106.2 overs (Ayush Badoni 85) lost to Bengal 429 & 89/1 in 15.3 overs. **Bengal 6(6), Delhi 0(0).**
At Ahmedabad: Odisha 324 & 161 in 46.1 overs (Sandeep Pattnaik 65, Ninad Rathva 53, Siddharth Desai 5/36) lost to Gujarat 439 & 47/0 in 9.3 overs. **Gujarat 7(7), Odisha 0(0).**
At New Delhi: Maharashtra 333 & 141 in 56 overs (Ankit Bawne 48, Rajvardhan Hangargekar 43, Arjun Sharma 5/58) bt Services 227 & 120 in 63.3 overs (Vicky Ostwal 5/50). **Maharashtra 6(6), Services 0(0).**
Group D: At Lahli: Himachal Pradesh 253 & 113 lost to Haryana 296 & 74/3 in 18.1 overs. **Haryana 6(6), HP 0(0).**
At Mumbai (Brabourne Stadium): Railways 278 & 272/4 in 86 overs (Suraj Ahuja 53, Vivek Singh 58, Eshaan Goyal 53, Bhargav Merai 51) drew with Uttarakhand 470. **Railways 1(1), Uttarakhand 3(3).**
At Jaipur: Rajasthan 363 & 192/6 decl. in 70.1 overs (Mahipal Lomror 84, Kartik Sharma 42) drew with Tamil Nadu 274 & 73/0 in 23 overs (N. Jagadeesan 42 n.o.). **Rajasthan 3(3), TN 1(1).**
Plate: At Rangpo: Sikkim 245 & 291/7 in 96.1 overs (Parth Palawat 66, Gurinder Singh 100 n.o.) drew with Meghalaya 395. **Sikkim 1(1), Meghalaya 3(3).**
At Nadiad: Mizoram 183 & 295 lost to Manipur 251 & 228/7 in 71.2 overs (Johnson Singh 51, Jotin Pheiroijam 105 n.o.). **Mizoram 0(0), Manipur 6(6).**

Lower-order's lack of application cost us, reckons Sai Kishore

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

Tamil Nadu skipper Sai Kishore attributed his team's failure to take a first-innings lead against Rajasthan to the lower-order's lack of application.

He also felt the pitch became increasingly spin-friendly as the match progressed, giving the toss (won by Rajasthan), a significant bearing on the contest.

"I think it was a lack of application. We lost our last four wickets for very few runs (10) and the lower-order has to contribute in First Class cricket. When we bowled, there was hardly any assistance from the pitch and it played more like a seaming wicket. But as the game progressed, it started offering more to the spinners, making it a toss-oriented wicket. Still, we should have contributed more with the bat," he said.

Sai Kishore. FILE PHOTO: BISWARANJAN ROUT

Sai Kishore credited Mahipal Lomror (84) and Kartik Sharma (42) with steering Rajasthan to safety in the second innings.

"To be fair, Mahipal played really well. He counter-attacked us really well from a very difficult situation (25 for three). Even Kartik, for that matter (came in at 31 for four). He might not have scored a lot of runs, but made enough impact for them to secure those three points," he said.

Coach Yo Mahesh highlighted the positives. "We would have loved to take the first-innings lead, but there are a lot of positives. Playing away from home, the toss is critical. Deepesh (three for 89) and Saravana Kumar (three for 68) took three wickets each, Sai Kishore did well with the ball in the second innings (three for 50), and three of our batters did well (Andre Siddarth, Jagadeesan, and Pradosh Ranjan Paul)," he said.

Sai Sudharsan gathering info before the tour down under

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

Sai Sudharsan said on Wednesday that the National selectors had asked him to play in the Ranji Trophy as part of his preparation for India's upcoming tour of New Zealand.

Having been on India-A duty in Puducherry, he arrived here "at 10.40 p.m." on the eve of Tamil Nadu's Ranji Trophy opener against Rajasthan (October 10).

"There was a day's break between games in Puducherry. On that day (October 10), our manager told me that the selectors had asked me to play the Ranji Trophy.

"After the first day's play here, I spoke with Pragyan Ojha (interim chief National selector). He said it would be good for the upcoming New Zealand series – for preparation and all. That was the clarity from their side."

Sai Sudharsan. S. PRASANNA VENKATESAN

He has been "watching a lot of old videos" of India's Tests in New Zealand to understand the conditions and how best to bat there.

"I have gathered a little information. It will be a bit windy, and there will be good bounce. It will be almost similar to England, but there will be a bit more lateral movement.

Grabbing knowledge

"Sachin *paaji* has scored there, so I watched his batting. I watched Dravid sir's batting. I try to grab knowledge from that and execute whatever is possible for me," he said.

On missing the Test series in Sri Lanka because of a toe stress fracture, the 24-year-old said: "I wasn't disappointed because I believe everything good is ahead of us. The last few injuries have been freakish, but because of them, I've probably gotten better with my habits and have a better understanding of how to take care of my body... how much I bat and things like that".

BFI's internal battle intensifies

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

In a retaliatory move, Boxing Federation of India (BFI) president Ajay Singh has suspended secretary general Pramod Kumar, who earlier moved a no-confidence motion against the federation chief, on various grounds.

In a letter issued on Tuesday, Ajay said several enquiries are pending against Pramod, who was earlier served a show-cause notice, "with respect to various acts and financial decisions taken by him."

In response, Pramod suspended Ajay on Wednesday.

India's skill and Australia's expertise — charting a joint gameplan

Lavanya L
CHENNAI

At Khel Connect, a symposium organised by the Australia India Institute (AII) and funded by the Australian Government Department of Education, educators, sporting administrators and industry leaders from both countries met over two days this week to discuss closer collaboration in high performance, community engagement and commercial expertise.

"This symposium is really about bringing two forces together by pairing Australia's deep expertise with India's scale, ambition and talent," AII CEO Lisa Singh said.

"There is growth in sports consumption tech as well. India can greatly contribute there," Anupam Goswami, league commissioner of Pro Kabaddi League, added.

Rob Aughey, Head of Discipline, Exercise and Sports Science at Federation University, called for short, targeted 'coach the coach' programmes.

"Three-year courses are impractical because rapid advances – especially in sports technology – make the training obsolete by the time participants finish," Aughey, whose research collaborators include FIFA, said.

Olympian Hakimuddin Habibulla, who swam for India at the 2000 Sydney Games, highlighted a major gap in coaching fundamentals.

"Coaches assume players already know the basics, and high stakes leave little room to teach foundational re-learning –breaking the transition from grass-roots to elite levels," he added.

Enriching experience: The participants and panellists at the symposium held at IIT Madras.

Aadhithya Chakravarthy, Head of Performance at FC Madras, shed light on decision errors in a data-driven world.

"Academies often evaluate players based on current ability rather than long-term potential, frequently discarding late bloomers for early maturers. Long-term patience is crucial," he explained.

"High-performance systems don't humanise athletes, making community sport its necessary counterpart. Consequently, our focus is making sports permissionless," Nandan Kamath, managing trustee of GoSports Foundation, advocated.

Rekha Dey, Partner at Tanjun Associate LLP, called for greater livelihood options to make sports viable to pursue at a community level, something Arun Vasu, president of the Indian and Asian Surfing Federation, corroborated.

Prof. Mahesh V Panchagnula, founder and head of the IIT Madras Center of Excellence on Sports Science and Analytics, placed the onus on schools to make sports a graded subject to help foster a more holistic culture that could turn profitable.

Meanwhile, Vik Singh, Trade and Investment Commissioner for Austrade in South Asia, said exchange relationships between the two countries need to move on from being one-sided.

With India hosting the 2030 Commonwealth Games and bidding for the 2036 Summer Games, major event capability and innovation took centre stage.

Dr. Sheila Nguyen, former Head of Sustainability for the 2023 FIFA Women's World Cup, cautioned against drawing on community resources without a plan to leave a legacy.

"We are distracted by ticket sales, broadcast numbers, and money spent. We need to broaden our perspective on hosting big events.

"They are more than nation-building exercises; they are also community-building exercises.

"If infrastructure improves, it can improve all the services around that facility and force people to upgrade, but it needs to be done with intention," she said.

TAMIL NADU ROUND-UP

TN takes a handy first-innings lead

NATHAM: Tamil Nadu added 49 runs to its overnight score of 291 for seven before being bowled out for 340 and secure a 139-run first-innings lead against Saurashtra on the third day of their U-23 Col. C.K. Nayudu Trophy Elite Group-A first-round match at the NPR College Ground on Wednesday.

Saurashtra's Maurya Ghoghari returned figures of eight for 123.

In the second essay, Harvansh Singh (95 batting) and Raxit Mehta (49 batting) shared an unbroken 135-run partnership for the third wicket to help Saurashtra erase the deficit and take a slender 26-run lead at stumps.

The scores: Saurashtra 201 in 85.3 overs & 165/2 in 43 overs (Harvansh Singh 95 batting, Raxit Mehta 49 batting) vs. Tamil Nadu 340 in 105.3 overs (Sunny Sandhu 70, Om Nitin Karthikeyan 33, Maurya Ghoghari 8/123).

Tamil Nadu gets the better of Goa

Tamil Nadu registered a four-wicket win over Goa in an u-19 Vinoo Mankad Trophy Elite Group-C match in Chandigarh on Wednesday.

The scores: Goa 184/6 in 50 overs (Aradhya Goyal 36, Afrid 43, Atharw Kumar Gupta 33) lost to Tamil Nadu 186/6 in 32.5 overs (M.G. Nithilan 32, V. Shavin 51). **Points:** *TN 4(14); Goa 0.*

Baroda women beat Tamil Nadu

Baroda defeated Tamil Nadu by 35 runs in a BCCI women's under-19 T20 Trophy Elite Group-D match at the Alur Cricket Stadium-II in Bengaluru on Wednesday.

The scores: Baroda 120 in 20 overs (Alankrita Parmar 42) bt Tamil Nadu 85 in 19.3 overs (Vidhi Parmar 4/11). **Points:** *TN 0(8); Baroda 4.*

Selection trials for TNCA academy

The Tamil Nadu Cricket Association (TNCA) will conduct selection trials for the TNCA Academy Emerging Talent Development Programme for Chennai city boys in the u-12 category at the MAC-B nets from October 27 to 30.

Those born between September 1, 2014, and September 30, 2016, are eligible and can register on the TNCA website (*www.tnca.in*).

Registration opens at 10 a.m. on October 15 and closes at 6 p.m. on October 21.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA U-14 round-robin tournament, Tamil Nadu-I vs Tamil Nadu-III (Wahe Guru-A); Tamil Nadu-II vs Tamil Nadu-IV (Tagore), 9.30 a.m.

Champion: M.O.P. Vaishnav defeated JBAS 35-16, 35-32 in the final of the University of Madras A-zone ball badminton tournament at Loyola College on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Arsenal, Barcelona cruise; Atletico stumps United

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

Atletico Madrid beat Manchester United 2-0 in the UEFA Champions League on Tuesday, while Bayern Munich was held 3-3 in Norway by underdogs Viking Stavanger. Arsenal eased to victory over Lille while Barcelona came from behind to beat Galatasaray but Inter Milan lost a seven-goal thriller to Club Brugge.

Atletico took the lead inside the opening minute through Pablo Barrios. Ademola Lookman got Atletico's second in the 79th minute, just after United's Leny Yoro was sent off.

The results: Lens 0 lost to Sporting 2 (Suarez 22, Doumbia 74); Sabah 2 (Parris 49, Mickels 88) bt Slavia Prague 0.

Arsenal 3 (Timber 64, Eze 67, Saka 71) bt Lille 0; Atletico Madrid 2 (Barrios 1, Lookman 79) bt Manchester United 0; Galatasaray 1 (Batrakov 28) lost to Barcelona 4 (Cancelo 43, Lopez 50, Gordon 53, Adeyemi 65); Inter Milan 3 (Martínez 44, 81, Bonny 90+3) lost to Club Brugge 4 (Tresoldi 30-pen, 63, 74, Vermant 87); RB Leipzig 1 (Gruda 75) bt PSV Eindhoven 0; Viking 3 (Stensness 2, Christiansen 38, Haugen 90) drew with Bayern Munich 3 (Kane 54-pen, 60, Díaz 71); Villarreal 3 (Mikautadze 23, Mourino 26, Oluwaseyi 86) bt Napoli 1 (Rrahmani 8).

Hat-trick hero: Tresoldi scores from the spot for Brugge's first against Inter. AFP

*Applicable T&C available at your nearest dealership. Ex-showroom price ₹13 99 900 for Grand Vitara Aspirion Edition, exclusively available in the Zeta (O) and Alpha (O) variants. Creative visualisation. Images used are for illustration purposes only. Features and accessories shown may not be part of the standard fitment. Black glass shade on the vehicle is due to lighting effect. Offers may vary and are subject to availability of stock. Maruti Suzuki India Limited reserves the right to discontinue an offer without further notice. Finance options available at the sole discretion of financier.

Kusal Mendis finds form, helps Lanka avoid a whitewash

Associated Press
RAWALPINDI

Kusal Mendis bounced back from two sub-par performances to hit an unbeaten half-century and Sri Lanka denied Pakistan a clean sweep in their T20 series with an eight-wicket win in Rawalpindi on Tuesday. The captain, who made one and nine in the previous two defeats, scored 87 not out off 48 balls and carried Sri Lanka to 172 for two in 17.1 overs as the visitors showed improvement in all the three facets of the game.

Pakistan skipper Sahibzada Farhan had earlier scored 76 off 47 balls to take the home team to 168 for eight after Kusal won his third straight toss.

Pakistan won the first game by four wickets and then inflicted a crushing 82-run defeat in the second game by scoring its second highest T20 score of 215.

The scores: Pakistan 168/8 in 20 overs (Farhan 78, Nuwan Tushara 2/38, Dasun Shanaka 3/21) lost to Sri Lanka 172/2 in 17.1 overs (Sineth Jayawardene 38, Kusal Mendis 87 n.o., Kamindu Mendis 40 n.o.).

Toss: Sri Lanka.

PoM: Kusal Mendis.

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
MARINE DEPARTMENT
No.MD/ACCTS/WK/R-12/2026/1217, Date : 25/09/2026

Name of the Work: Hiring of 3rd Battery Operated Electric Tug of 60T Bollard Pull (Green Tug Transition Programme) including Manning, Operation, and Maintenance for a Period of 15 years at Paradip Port Authority & Extendable by 02 more years. **(This 3rd tug under GTTP is in addition to the 1st GTTP tug & the 2nd GTTP tug. The 1st GTTP tug vide e-RFP No. MD/ACCTS/WK/R-20/2025/506, dt.15/04/2025 as amended vide e-RFP No. MD/ACCTS/WK/R-20/2025/828, dt.26/06/2025 is subject to the outcome of WP(C).33656/2025 & WP(C).33659/2025 and same is not being proceeded with in view of interim orders passed by Hon'ble High Court of Orissa).**

Estimated cost put to tender for hire charges of one year only: **Rs.20,02,02,500/- excluding GST.** Last date & time of submission of tender through on-line bidding is **17:00 Hours on dt.10/11/2026.** Date & time for opening of Technical Bid is **10:30 hours on dt.11/11/2026.** For further details, please log on to the Website: **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app.**

Deputy Conservator, PPA
PPA/PR/32/2026-2027, dt.13/10/2026

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
Office of the Chief Engineer — **T ENDER NOTICE**

ADV No.40/D3/CE/TTD/2026-27, NIT No.99 to 100 /SE-I/TTD/ 2026 -27 dt: 13- 10-2026
NAME OF WORK:(1) Facility Management Services for housekeeping, sanitation and maintenance of Sripatham Block at Tirupati for the years 2026-29 (3 years), **Open Tender Type, Time for completion 36 months (2)** Facility Management Services for housekeeping, sanitation and maintenance of Achyutham Block at Tirupati for the years 2026-29 (3 years), **Open Tender Type, Time for completion 36 months.**
NOTE: For full details, log on to the Website https://www.tirumala.org.

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.220) Date:14-10-2026 — **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
Office of the Chief Engineer — **TENDER NOTICE**

ADV No.39/D3/CE/TTD/2026-27, NIT No.101 /SE-I& NIT No.82/SE-III/TTD/ 2026-27 dt:13-10-2026
Name of work:(1) Construction of additional floor to the existing building (i.e. 3rd floor) North and East side wing at SV High School, TTD, Tirupati, Amount Rs.547.60 Lakhs, Time for completion 18 months **(2)** Operation and maintenance of Dairy/ Ghee plant at S.V. Gosamrakshana, Shala, T.T.D., Tirupati to process raw milk in to various milk products for 5 years. (6th call). Open Tender Type, Time for completion 60 months.
Note: For full details, log on to the Website https://www.tirumala.org.

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.218) Date:14-10-2026 — **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

bida — **भिवाड़ी इंटिग्रेटेड विकास प्राधिकरण**
एच-5, गजसिंह कॉलोनी, भिवाड़ी, अलवर, दूरभाष :- 01493-230819
ई-मेल :- bida.bhiwadi@rajasthan.gov.in

क्रमांक :- बीड़ा/अभि./3225/26 — दिनांक :- 09/10/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

Bid for "Integrated development of 45mtr wide master plan road with service road, green belt, footpath, drain and parking near saidpur bhiwadi.", is invited from interested Bidders up to 02.00 PM date 30.10.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** & **http://sppp.raj.nic.in** of the state; and **https://bida.rajasthan.gov.in** departmental website. **UBN : BDA2627WLOB00066**

राज.संवाद/सी/26/11879 — **अधिशाषी अभियन्ता, बीडा, भिवाडी**

कार्यालय नगर परिषद, फलोदी जिला–फलौदी (राज0)

क्रमांक / न0प0फ0 / 2026–27 / 6032 — दिनांक :–10.10.2026

–: ई–निविदा सूचना :–

नगर परिषद फलोदी द्वारा परिषद क्षेत्र में 1 कार्य हेतु सक्षम एवं राजकीय विभागों में नियमानुसार उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में दिनांक 02.11.2026 को 12:00 PM बजे तक ई–प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया से वेबसाईट **https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है, निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी व वेब साईट **https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in,** व **https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखी व डाउनलोड की जा सकती है ।
Tender ID :- 2026_DLB_603754_1
UBN No. :-DLB2627SLOB21873

राज.संवाद / सी / 26 / 11819 — आयुक्त, नगर परिषद,फलोदी

CPCL
Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise & a group Company of IndianOil)
[CIN – L40101TN1965GOI005389]
Regd. Office: No.536, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai – 600 018

NOTICE

Shri Karthikeyan.N, PR No.803407 SEA-VIII-P&U II&III, CPCL who has remained unauthorisedly absent from duty since 24.05.2026 is hereby informed that disciplinary proceedings are pending against him. He is directed to **report for duty and appear before the Inquiring Authority on 22.10.2026 at 09.00 hrs. at CPCL Refinery, Manali,** in connection with the disciplinary inquiry. If he fails to report for duty, submit a written defence, or appear before the Inquiring Authority on the said date, the disciplinary inquiry will be conducted and concluded ex-parte in accordance with the applicable rules. This is the final opportunity to participate in the proceedings.

A.S. Rajkumar
Chief General Manager (Technical)
Disciplinary Authority

Date: 15.10.2026
Place: Chennai

TAMIL NADU CO-OPERATIVE SUGAR FEDERATION LTD.,
'AAVIN' ILLAM, 1st FLOOR, 3-A, PASUMPON MUTHURAMALINGANAR SALAI,
NANDANAM, CHENNAI - 600 035. Phone: 044-24330083, 24344177
E-mail: tamilnaducoopsugarfederation@gmail.com
G.S.T.No.33AABAT0660R1Z8

E-Procurement Tender Notice

The following materials are required for fixing Rate Contract basis for 2026-27 season to all Cooperative and Public Sector Sugar Mills in Tamil Nadu.
Online bids are invited for
(1) **50 Kg Brown colour Polypropylene(PP) bags with inner liner**
(2) **50 Kg 'A' Type Sugar Gunny bags with inner liner**
(3) **Burnt Lime Powder**
(4) **Heavy Chemicals**
(5) **Co-gen Plant Chemicals**

For all other details including detailed NIT (Notice Inviting Tender) visit the E-tender portal website **https://tntenders.gov.in.**
The opening of the Part-I will be held on **29.10.2026 at 11.30 AM** onwards.

Place : Chennai 600 035
Date : 14 .10.2026 — DIPR/3141/TENDER/2026 — **Administrator**

सेन्ट्रल माईन प्लानिंग एण्ड डिजाईन इन्स्टीच्यूट लिमिटेड
CENTRAL MINE PLANNING & DESIGN INSTITUTE LIMITED
(A Subsidiary of Coal India Ltd.)
Gondwana Place, Kanke Road, Ranchi-834008, Jharkhand, India

NOTICE

"All the tenders issued by CIL and its Subsidiaries for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on websites of Coal India Ltd. **www.coalindia.in/** respective Subsidiary Company (CMPDI, **www.cmpdi.co.in)**, CIL e-procurement portal **https://coalindiatenders.nic.in** and Central Public Procurement Portal **https://eprocure.gov.in.** In addition, procurement is also done through GeM portal **https://gem.gov.in."**

VISAKHAPATNAM PORT AUTHORITY
VISAKHAPATNAM

E-Tender Call Notice: 2026_VPT_291637_1, Dt. 22.09.2026.

On behalf of the Members of Board of VPA, E-Tender is invited in Single Stage two steps system from the experienced bidders meeting the pre-qualifying criteria for the work mentioned below through online bidding on the Website http://www.etenders.gov.in

SUB: UP GRADATION OF THE EXISTING 80 BEDDED GOLDEN JUBILEE HOSPITAL TO A 300 BEDDED MULTI-DISCIPLINARY SUPER SPECIALITY HOSPITAL AT VISAKHAPATNAM PORT ON DESIGN, BUILT, FINANCE, OPERATE AND TRANSFER (DBFOT) BASIS" – **Last Date for bid submission: 05.11.2026.**

SECRETARY

MALKAJGIRI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PROJECTS, MMC, HYDERABAD.
Tender Notice No.12/SE (Projects)/MMC/2026-27 (Re-Call), **Dt:14.10.2026.**

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING

Item No.	Name of Work
1.	"Project management Consultancy Services for Proof checking, construction supervision, Quality Assurance, Quality Control & Quality Audit for the work of "Construction of RK Puram ROB Deposit work" under Engineering Procurement Construction(EPC)/Turnkey Basis"

Events	Date & Timings
Start Date	15.10.2026 03.00 PM
Pre-Bid Meeting	23.10.2026 at 03.00 PM Location: O/o Chief Engineer (Projects), MMC 1st Floor, Head Office, Tarnaka, Hyderabad.
Last Date & Time for receipt of Bids	26.10.2026 @ 03.00 PM
Technical Bid Opening	26.10.2026 After 03.30 PM
Price Bid Opening	27.10.2026 @ 04.00 PM

Address of the officer concerned **Smt. K.Rohini, SE (Projects), 9959442013.** Superintending Engineer (Projects), Malkajgiri Municipal Corporation, 1st Floor, HMDA Complex, Tarnaka, Hyderabad. Further details can be seen at 'e' Procurement **https://tender.telangana.gov.in.**

Sd/- Superintending Engineer(I/C) (Projects), MMC.

DIPR R.O.No.11945-PP/GL/ADVT/2026-27 Dt. 14.10.2026

READ
SPORTSTAR
EVERY FORTNIGHT.
TO SUBSCRIBE,
VISIT
www.thehindugroup.in
/subscribe

MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER CPD/58
Corrigendum-I -2026-27

Tenders are invited through e-Tendering in SRM Two Bid system from the registered vendors for Supply of following:

Tender No. & Description of Material	Estimated Amount (in Rs. Lakhs) / Tender Fee (in Rs.) Excluding GST	Due Date & Time (Hrs.) for Submission & Opening of Tender
SP/T-0512/1026 RFx 5000001610 (1st Call) for Procurement of 220kV (14 No.), 132kV (10 No.) and 100kV (02) Voltage Class Power Transformers/ICT (Total 26 No.) along with New Uninhibited High Grade Mineral Insulating Oil for Enhancement of Transformation Capacity under Amravati; Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar; Karad; Nashik, Pune & Vashi Zones of MSETCL.	23277.59 25,000.00	02.11.2026 Upto 17.00 Hrs 02.11.2026 17.15 Hrs
CORRIGENDUM NO.1 Dt.12.10.2026	Corrigendum due to change in Quantity in the Tender published on SRM Portal viz. **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/** and MSETCL website viz. **www.mahatransco.in.**	

Contact Person: Office of the Executive Engineer (Gr-V), CPA, C.O. MSETCL, 1st Floor, Prakashgad Building, Bandra (E), Mumbai. **Tel. No.:** 022-69852717/2740 **Email id:** cecpa@mahatransco.in, secpa@mahatransco.in, eegrp5@mahatransco.in, eepc@mahatransco.in. For further details visit our website **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/.** Any further amendments/clarifications will be published on the MSETCL website **www.mahatransco.in** & **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/**. Bidders are therefore requested to check these websites for further updates.

Sd/- Executive Engineer (P&C)

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଶକ୍ତି ସଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ ଲିଃ
(ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)
ODISHA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)
Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Janpath, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

E-Tender No.	Tender Description:	Estimated Cost
CPC-66/2026-27	Engineering, Supply, Installation and Testing & Commissioning works for Construction of 220kV DC Transmission line from Existing 220/132/33kV GSS, Balasore to Proposed 400/220kV GSS at Baisinga (220kV UG cable protion only) on Turnkey Contract Basis in e-tendering mode only. **Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 16.11.2026 upto 12:00 PM.**	**Rs. 90,00,43,027/-**
CPC-73/2026-27	Engineering, Supply, Installation and Testing & Commissioning works for Construction of 220kV DC Line through UG cable from 400/220/132/33kV GSS Mendhasal to 220/33kV GSS Infocity-II with two number of 220kV GIS Bay extension at each end i.e. at Mendhasal GSS and Infocity-II GSS on Turnkey Contract Basis in e-tendering mode only. **Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 16.11.2026 upto 12:00 PM.**	**Rs. 1,68,91,09,023/-**
CPC-75/2026-27	Procurement of Structure Materials & HDG Nut & bolts for (1) Balance materials for RTSS Dhutra & RTSS Garposh works and (2) Conversion of the above lines from 2 Phase to 3 Phase under deposit work of M/s SE Railway and (3) NH Diversion in RTSS Dhutra transmission coridorr under deposit work of NH Diversion, Jharsuguda.	**Rs. 6,37,04,296/-**

Complete set of bidding documents are available at **www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL** and **www.optcl.co.in.**

/optcl.odisha /optcl_odisha **HIPR-66/2026-27**

A click for posterity: Pranavi, who idolises McIlroy, lived her dream at the Delhi Golf Club on Wednesday. INSTAGRAM@PRANAVI_URS

Pranavi gets to meet 'ultimate hero' McIlroy

GOLF

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

For Asian Games gold medallist Pranavi Urs, meeting her idol Rory McIlroy was a dream come true.

The 23-year-old got to spend time with the six-time Major champion at the Delhi Golf Club here on Wednesday, exchanging notes on the highs and lows of competing at the highest level.

Grew up watching him

"Rory has been my idol for as long as I can remember. I grew up watching him more than I watched Tiger (Woods). I like Tiger as well, but Rory is my ultimate hero," Pranavi told *The Hindu*.

The two spent time together on the putting green before walking a couple of holes. "I told him about what I felt when I made the triple bogey in the final round, and he told me about what happened to him at one of the Tour Championships. We spoke about how he felt playing his first Masters. It was quite motivating," Pranavi said.

McIlroy, meanwhile, was impressed by the Indian's resilience in winning gold at Japan.

Amazing achievement

"It is an amazing achievement to win the Asian Games. The resilience and character she showed to go and win after having that early triple bogey... it was a delight to meet her.

"She is a wonderful young woman. She said she was nervous, but it didn't seem like she was. It was great to spend some time with her," McIlroy said.

McIlroy, Fleetwood and Rai headline star-studded field

Fox, Rose, Reed and Willett among the other leading contenders for the top prize; Saptak, Khalin, Veer and Shubhankar spearhead the home challenge in the blue riband event of Indian golf

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

A galaxy of golf's biggest names will descend on the picturesque Delhi Golf Club for the second edition of the DP World India Championship, which tees off here on Thursday.

With a prize purse of $4 million, the tournament has attracted three reigning Major champions, alongside several other big names. The 2026 Masters champion Rory McIlroy is undoubtedly the biggest draw, with PGA Championship winner Aaron Rai and Ryan Fox, who won The Open Championship, among the other leading contenders.

Justin Rose (2013 U.S. Open), Danny Willett (2016 Masters), Patrick Reed (2018 Masters) and Shane Lowry (2019 Open Championship) further bolster the star-studded field.

Plenty at stake

With the season nearing its conclusion, there is plenty at stake beyond the tournament title. This week's performance could prove decisive in the Race to Dubai, where Reed, Eugenio Chacarra and McIlroy are locked in a three-way battle. The storied DGC presents a distinctive challenge. At a time when courses are increasingly designed to accommodate long-hitters, the DGC demands a different approach. Its relatively short layout, narrow fairways, dense tree cover and thick rough place a premium on accuracy and course management.

Tee-off time: Defending champion Fleetwood will face a stern test from McIlroy. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

> It's a Ryder Cup year next year. I want to make that team. I want to contribute. I want to earn more points for Europe. I still want to do well there
> **RORY MCILROY**

> Last year, if you missed the fairways, you could hit it towards the green and then figure it out. This year, if you hit it in the rough, you're just hacking it out
> **FLEETWOOD**

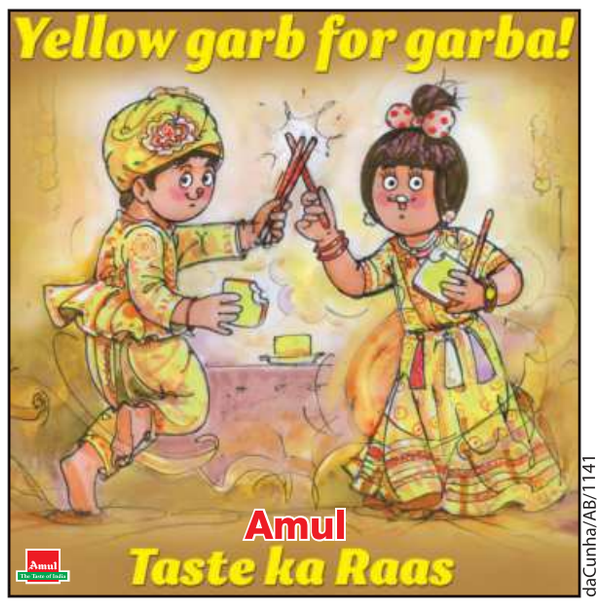
Big-hitting offers little advantage here, so much so that several players are expected to leave their drivers in the hotel.

Defending champion Tommy Fleetwood noted that the rough has grown thicker this year, adding another layer of difficulty.

"Last year, if you missed the fairways, you could hit it towards the green and then figure it out. But this year, if you hit it in the rough, you're just hacking it out," Fleetwood said.

The home challenge will be spearheaded by DP World PGTI Order of Merit leaders Saptak Talwar, Khalin Joshi and Veer Ahlawat. Shubhankar Sharma, meanwhile, arrives on the back of a victory at the Kapil Dev Invitational Tour Championship a few days ago.

The blue riband event of Indian golf promises a compelling blend of world-class talent and serious test of skill.



McIlroy speaks of desire to win Race to Dubai

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

Six-time Major champion Rory McIlroy has backed the DP World Tour's decision to bar players who sign up for LIV Golf from competing in its events from next year.

"The DP World Tour (known earlier as European Tour) are well within their rights to change the rules and regulations. This is the way to protect their business and to make the tour as strong as possible," McIlroy said here on the eve of the DP World India Championship.

In a statement to the BBC, DP World Tour chief executive Guy Kinnings said, "Players need to make a choice" – an ultimatum to those contemplating their future in the rival league, which is now facing financial turmoil.

A vocal critic of LIV Golf, McIlroy added, "The DP World Tour have made a good decision. The golf landscape has now got to the point where guys are going to have to make a decision on what is important to them and what they really want to do."

One of the modern greats of the game, the Northern Irishman may have achieved almost everything there is to achieve on the golf course, but his hunger for success remains undiminished.

McIlroy spoke of his desire to win the Race to Dubai - the season-long competition to crown the European Tour's leading player - for a record eighth time. He is currently third in the standings, with only a handful of tournaments remaining.

"At this stage of my career, it's always nice to get to this part of the season and have a chance to win the Race to Dubai. Eugenio (Chacarra) jumped me last week in Spain. Patrick (Reed) isn't playing so well, so this is a good opportunity to cut into that lead this week to try and win my eighth Race to Dubai".

I would love to push myself to try and win another Major

The 13-time PGA Tour winner feels that it is an important time for the sport globally and India is key to its development, is willing to constantly tweak his game in order to stay relevant with the modern times

INTERVIEW

Justin Rose

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

This is Justin Rose's second visit to India. The first was a good 22 years ago, when the English golfer played a skins game at DLF Golf and Country Club in Gurgaon. "That was back in the day before DLF became the DLF of now," Rose said.

Rose's own journey over the last decades has seen tremendous highs. A 13-time winner on the PGA Tour, Rose hit the peak in 2013 when he won the U.S. Open, his first and only Major title. In September 2018, Rose rose to the World No. 1 spot, becoming only the fourth English golfer to reach those great heights after Nick Faldo, Lee Westwood, and Luke Donald.

At 46, Rose has lost none of his competitive spirit. Now ranked 18th on the Official World Golf Ranking list, Rose has had a good year, winning the Farmers Insurance Open in February with a tournament-record score of 23-under par.

In April, Rose led the Masters by two shots in the final round, but back-to-back bogeys saw him finish tied for third. Now in New Delhi to compete in the DP World India Championship, Rose is keen to add to his trophy cabinet. A self-confessed fan of Indian food, Rose plans to enjoy a tasty Tandoori meal along the way.

The South Africa-born Englishman spoke on a range of topics at a press conference in Delhi Golf Club. Excerpts:

How important is it for an event like this to come to India, where there is so much interest in golf?

It is fantastic to be playing golf in this region. It's a country that is exploding in many, many ways, and I think that there is a commitment to golf here, with great sponsors and backers. This is an important time for golf to grow all around the world. What a field they have assembled here. Hopefully, that creates the interest that will help golf grow in this area.

You wanted to spend your 40th birthday in India, but it did not work out because of the COVID-19 restrictions. Tell us about your connection with India.

I have accumulated some Indian friends through the years. From what I've noticed, Indians are very proud of their country. Anybody who has any sort of influence here in India really wants to share it and show you the magic of India. I live in England, so of course I love Indian food. I'm not sure how authentic we make it in the U.K., but the national dish is chicken tikka masala. It is the most ordered dish in England. I am a big fan of Indian food.

What are your views on the course?

I can't tell you too much because I haven't been on the golf course yet. But I've spoken to my friend, Tommy Fleetwood, and guys who were here last year. It's a very unique golf course – very traditional and very old-school. There is no real need for distance off the tee. The driver stays in the bag. The DGC is a 250-yard, good second-shot type of golf course. Long and mid irons will be the most important part this week. Getting on the fairways and greens will be a huge premium.

What keeps the fire burning after so many years of competing at this top level?

That's a great question. Yes, I have been able to build a nice resume, but I've only achieved those high levels once. I would love to push myself to try and win another Major championship. But it's more than that. I want to play golf now for the memories. In order to build the memory bank, you have to keep putting yourself in the biggest situations in golf, whether that be down the stretch in Majors or on the first tee of Ryder Cups... I'm playing for those big moments.

The kids on the tour these days are so good. The strength and depth is so strong that I feel it's taking more discipline for me to stay relevant and continue to push myself to be a better player.

That is really the goal. Can I be better next year? I'm 47 next year. That shouldn't be possible, but I think it is possible. It is a personal battle, I suppose.

You came so close to winning the Masters this year but finished third. How do you recover and get back on the horse again?

This year, I turned up at Augusta with a sense that people were rooting for me because I have come so close to winning in the past. You can sense the sort of frustration of the crowd that you haven't been able to win, but you can't let that become part of your own story. I can only control my own performance and how I break down the golf course.

I've been incredibly close. I've had three runner-up finishes at the Masters. This year felt like a second-place finish, although it was a third. I feel like I played well enough to win the tournament, so my mindset would be to do nothing different.

The modern game has become increasingly driven by power and athleticism. How do you evolve as a player without losing the qualities that made you successful?

That's a really great question. I guess that's my job, especially this off-season. I have to try and figure out if there are some gains to be had, if I can push myself physically, and if there are some power and distance gains to be made. I also have to be realistic that pushing too hard at my age in certain areas comes with risks.

What has made me a great player through the years is being able to work my way around tough golf courses, plan my strategy, and, obviously, handle the mental side.

These are the things that I need to continue to do to stay strong. I am capable of driving the ball well enough to be incredibly competitive. My short game needs a little bit of work, but I know I have it in me. My putting has shown an uptrend in the last five or six years. If I can just piece it all together, I don't need to do much differently.

But yes, the game has shifted, no doubt. You see many college players coming out on tour now with 180-mile-an-hour ball speed. When I first arrived on tour, John Daly was the only one with 180-mile-an-hour ball speed. He was the outlier. Now it's the average. I fit somewhere below that average, but not by much. I need to compete by being consistent in everything.

You went on a Ryder Cup scouting trip. Talk to us about the process.

It was the first opportunity for (Team Europe captain) Luke Donald to get the group together. It was an important trip for players who haven't played the Ryder Cup before. It was good for rookies to be around the team and feel the energy of a Ryder Cup.

Luke talked a little bit about how he envisions the strategy and the plan for the next year or so. It was more of a boys' trip – casual golf, a nice dinner, and a little bit of discussion. It wasn't very intense.

You are a cricket fan. You played many pro-ams with Brian Lara. Will you use this week to play some cricket and meet a few cricketers?

I hope the energy of cricket comes through here in India. I know (former England cricketer) Kevin Pietersen quite well. We live in the same area back in England. I know he's also a big name and brand over here. I think he'll be around the golf tournament this week. If we can have some fun along the way, that will be great.

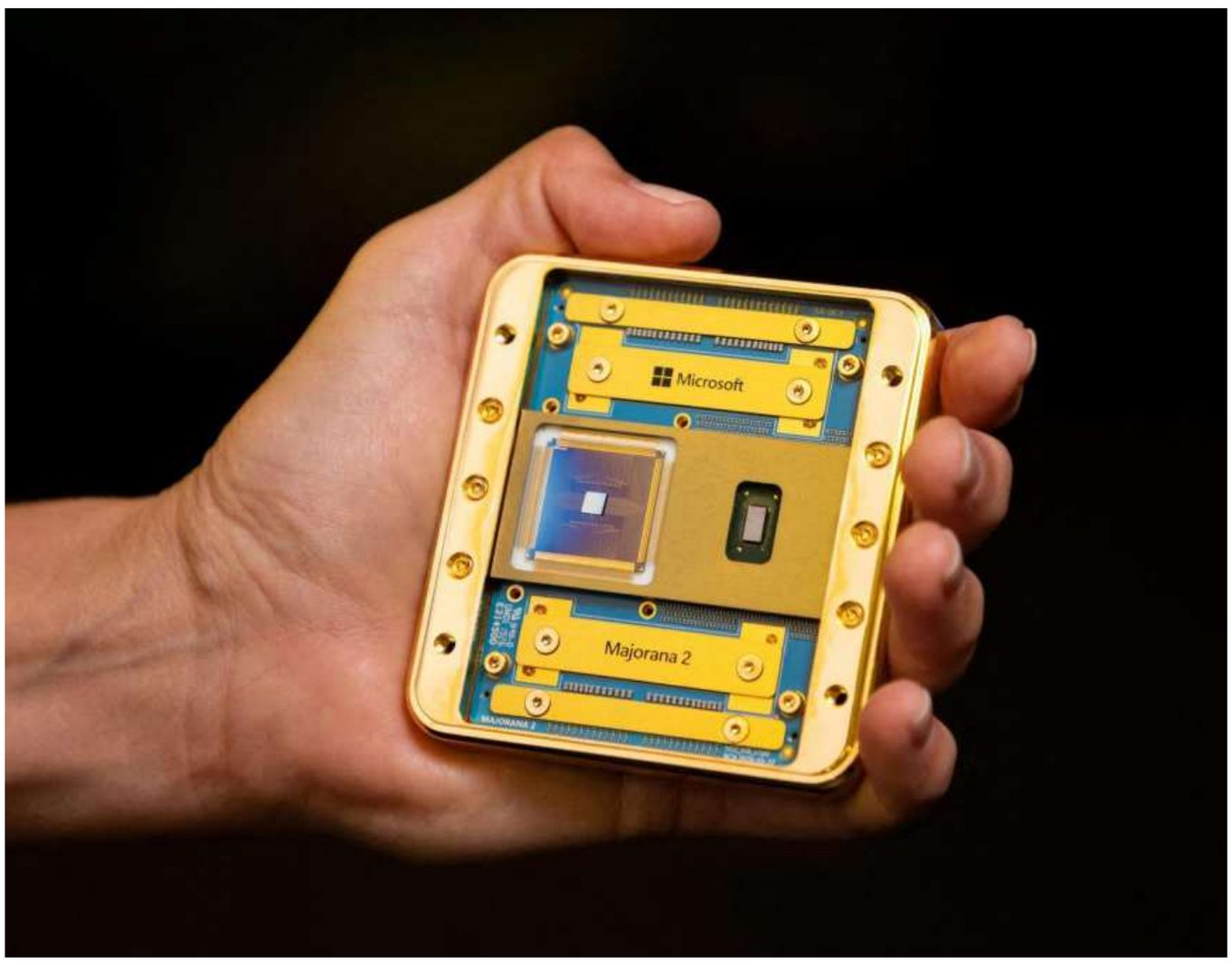
Perhaps you can get some batting practice...

Yes, sure, I can do some batting and maybe bowl my famous googly too (laughs).

Old doubts linger, yet new Microsoft quantum chip raises the stakes

Not everyone is convinced Microsoft learnt the bigger lesson from its experience with announcing the Majorana 1 chip; University of Pittsburgh professor Sergey Frolov has said Microsoft's previous record has left him unwilling to treat the new work as resting on a well-understood foundation

Vasudevan Mukunth



Microsoft's Majorana 2 quantum computing chip is seen in this undated handout photo. MICROSOFT/REUTERS

In February, the Microsoft Quantum research group announced a new kind of computer processor called Majorana 1. According to the tech giant, the processor contained the world's first topological qubits, built with a new material it called a 'topoconductor'. Majorana 1 contained eight qubits, with Microsoft Quantum saying it would in future hold a million.

The group published its paper in *Nature* the same day, and that stoked the early concerns about what Microsoft Quantum had actually demonstrated.

Foremost, the paper was considerably more circumspect than Microsoft's press release. The researchers had built devices made of indium-arsenide-aluminium and discussed a way to measure, in a 'single shot', the parity of an electronic state, i.e. whether the number of electrons was odd or even in the state, in the wire.

The team called this measurement a "necessary ingredient" for a highly sought after form of quantum computing.

However, there was a significant gap between the scopes of the paper and of the press release, prompting concerns in the scientific community that Microsoft was trying to lay claim to a commercially lucrative technology without first proving that it actually worked.

Zero modes

Quantum computing is a new, more powerful form of computing that scientists believe can solve some problems much better than conventional devices can. However, the quantum bits, or qubits, these machines are based on are notoriously fragile.

A qubit stores information in a quantum state, which can be disturbed by even the slightest interactions with stray heat or stray magnetic fields. Another technology called quantum error correction can compensate but not without imposing additional technological hurdles. Many leading quantum computers encode qubits in superconducting circuits, while others use atoms, ions or light. At least on paper, topological quantum computing shows another way.

In this domain, Microsoft Quantum has been trying to build a quantum computer with qubits based on particles called Majorana zero modes (MZMs). Technically, MZMs are 'emergent quasiparticles'. The physicists Sankar Das Sarma, Roman Lutchyn, and Jay Sau had predicted in 2010 that they would occur at the ends of specially engineered superconducting wires.

Two MZMs separated by some space constitute a particular quantum state, and whether that state is occupied or not can encode information, like 0 and 1. This way, each MZM pair stores information in both particles together.

This is less like one half being stored in each particle and more like both particles storing the information together: many small disturbances affecting only one end cannot destroy the information, yet both ends are required to access it. The space between the two MZMs of a pair is crucial to achieve this.

MZMs also follow some strange rules. For example, carrying out one exchange of MZMs and then another can create a different quantum state than performing the same exchange in the reverse order.

Airtight inference

But a big problem today is to ascertain if a device with the necessary superconducting wires and other parts also has MZMs. This is because there are many impostor states that are easier to create but which lack the MZMs' unusual properties. There is no way to directly spot an MZM with some kind of microscope and claim success. Instead, scientists and engineers have to measure the device's properties in different ways, and from that infer the presence of MZMs.

This inference has to be airtight, and the dispute in the Microsoft case is that its inference is not.

The matter is still on, in fact: on June 2 this year, Microsoft Quantum announced a new processor called Majorana 2 and uploaded a new preprint paper. Here, the team replaced aluminium with lead, whose superconducting state is harder to disrupt, to make the desired state more robust. It also switched to a gallium-antimonide substrate and redesigned the semiconductor stack to reduce disorder.

The upgrade was apparently dramatic: in Microsoft's telling, the topological gap – the energy needed to excite the system out of its protected state – had increased from around 30 microelectron-volts to 70 microelectron-volts. The parity switching time had also increased from a few milliseconds to around 20 seconds.

The group presented this as proof of topological quantum computing's promise because the new numbers were indicative of the encoded information being more robustly protected from disturbances. On the back of these reported advances, the company said it would build a scalable quantum computer by 2029 – a significantly shortened deadline considering how complex the technology still is.

Rebuttal and response

However, not everyone is convinced that Microsoft learnt the bigger lesson from last time. As University of Pittsburgh professor Sergey Frolov has said, Microsoft's previous record has left him unwilling to treat the new work as resting on a well-understood foundation.

MZMs are very difficult to create and detect. For example, researchers from TU-Delft in the Netherlands published a paper in *Nature* in 2018 claiming they had spotted MZMs. But it had to be retracted three years later after independent scientists found problems in the data analysis. In its 2025 paper, the Microsoft Quantum team used the topological gap protocol it had presented in a 2023 paper: a way to use electrical conductance data to identify combinations of magnetic field and gate voltage that are consistent with gapped MZMs. The team then used a technique called radio-frequency interferometry to check one region of the device, and where the team said the data had evidence of parity switching.

But at an American Physical Society meeting a month later, scientists remained sceptical. The Microsoft team had demonstrated one measurement on one wire in the paper and itself presented additional measurements of a different kind, but many physicists still had doubts.

Cornell University professor Eun-Ah Kim said the data was quite weak while Argonne National Laboratory physicist Kartiek Agarwal called the paper's claims premature, even if not deserving to be dismissed. Henry Legg, a lecturer at the University of St. Andrews in Scotland, in particular said the headline data came from a small number of measurements on one device. Then, on June 24 this year, *Nature* published a rebuttal by Dr. Legg alongside a response from Microsoft Quantum (physicist Chetan Nayak was the corresponding author). In his rebuttal, based on his own work over the last year, Dr. Legg contended that Microsoft's device itself may not have been qualified to host MZMs, that the underlying data of how electric currents move in the device appeared consistent with a gapless and highly disordered system, and that the topological gap protocol was sensitive, rather than agnostic, to how a researcher chose to analyse the system.

In response, Nayak et al. disputed Dr. Legg's logic and said its claims were based on the radio-frequency measurements, not the protocol.

Many physicists believe Microsoft's attempts are promising and commend its transparency with data. But many physicists also remain unconvinced that the qubits in Majorana 1 and Majorana 2 are working topological qubits.

mukunth.v@thehindu.co.in

A Thai villager paddles a foam float past a flooded home in Ayutthaya on October 6. AFP

Thailand floods villages to save capital, economic hubs

Agence France-Presse

Stilt houses in villages north of Bangkok are no longer high enough to stay dry as authorities in Thailand deliberately flood riverside communities to spare the capital.

Inside the home of Kamonchanok Sathaphonamonwut, raised more than three metres above the ground in Ayutthaya province, her family of three sleeps on makeshift platforms and cannot use the waterlogged toilet.

Her village has been flooded six years in a row, pushing some to move away, while others have raised their houses higher. "Our area simply cannot cope with this much water anymore," the 34-year-old said, wading through her soaked home. But while authorities prioritise protecting Bangkok and other business hubs from floods, "when it comes to our residential communities, they neglect us", she said.

Thailand experiences flooding every year during the monsoon season, and scientists say human-made climate change has made heavy rain and floods more frequent and severe. After devastating floods in 2011, the government expanded embankments, water gates, and other infrastructure to direct water away from Bangkok, the historic city of Ayutthaya, and industrial zones along the Chao Phraya River, which flows through the capital. The defences have largely kept commercial centres safe, but residents of other areas have been left to fend for themselves. Around 20 km from Ayutthaya's centuries-old temple ruins, a UNESCO heritage site, residents say floods that once reached their knees now rise above their heads in some areas and can take several months to recede.

Office worker Kamonchanok has been forced to commute by boat, and hoist her household appliances and other belongings above the waterline. "All we can do is deal with the consequences," she said.

Thai irrigation department spokesperson Thanet Somboon said climate change, low-lying geography, and recently built embankments that altered the natural flow of the Chao Phraya have contributed to more severe flooding of downstream communities. "Even when water is released from the Chao Phraya Dam at the same rate as before, the impact is greater than it used to be," Mr. Thanet said. And after irrigation channels were completely full of diverted water, he said, authorities had "no choice but to discharge the remaining water downstream". But Mr. Thanet acknowledged that officials may need to review infrastructure to "ensure floodwater can be kept within the intended limits".

As flooding in hard-hit districts has become more severe, many who remain have paid to lift their stilt houses higher and keep their living space dry. Ms. Kamonchanok's family raised their home twice in the 1990s, the second time by 1.5 metres.

The government's flagship fix is a $780-million flood diversion canal, designed to carry 1,200 cubic metres of water – around half the volume of an Olympic-size swimming pool – per second around the bottleneck where the Chao Phraya narrows through Ayutthaya. It is expected to be completed by 2030.

Until then, Ms. Kamonchanok said her community was not even demanding an end to intentional flooding, but rather a cap on water levels and financial support for those whose homes sit below the flood line. "All we're asking for is to be able to live comfortably in our own homes," she said ."Why can't they give us that?"

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Movie names that are also scientific concepts

Please send in your answers to science@thehindu.co.in

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

In astrophysics, the _____ _____ is the boundary around a black hole beyond which not even light can escape to a distant observer. The film, released in 1997, stars Laurence Fishburne and investigates a spaceship that has mysteriously reappeared near Neptune. Fill in the blanks.

QUESTION 2

Name the effect that describes how extremely small differences in the initial conditions of a system — like water vapour levels, temperature, winds, etc. — can produce drastically different outcomes over time, like a cyclone taking shape or not. In the 2004 film of the same name, a young man is able to travel back in time in a strange way.

QUESTION 3

What is the form of energy transferred between two systems because of a temperature difference called? This transfer happens spontaneously and the form can exist only in transit. The 1995 film with this name is considered to be one of the best crime films of all time.

QUESTION 4

A _____ is an arrangement of numbers or other mathematical objects that allows mathematicians to understand systems of equations. They are central to quantum mechanics, computer graphics, and machine learning — just as the turn-of-the-century film of this name is considered a cornerstone of sci-fi filmmaking. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION #5

The 1958 Alfred Hitchcock classic X is centered on some characters' extreme fear of heights, accompanied by the titular condition. In reality, the condition makes a person feel like they are moving when they are not. Name X.

Visual: Name the film in which this nail-biting scene appears. Its director Alfonso Cuarón said he named the film for a physical entity that played a major role in its plot. WARNER BROS./YOUTUBE

Answers to October 13 questions:

1. American physicist who won the physics Nobel Prize twice – **Ans: John Bardeen**
2. Laureate who won the physics Nobel for inventing optical tweezers – **Ans: Arthur Ashkin**
3. Physicist born Maria Skłodowska who named an element after her homeland – **Ans: Marie Curie**
4. Concept for which Hinton and Hopfield won the 2024 Nobel – **Ans: Machine learning**
5. Superconducting device that shows macroscopic quantum tunnelling – **Ans: Josephson junction**

Visual: **IceCube Neutrino Observatory**

First contact

Sheney Muraly | Tamal Biswas | Sadhan Panda | Anmol Agrawal | Krishna Jain

For feedback and suggestions
for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of households in Rajasthan awaiting tap connections

44 in lakh. Former Rajasthan CM Ashok Gehlot accused the BJP government of failing to implement Jal Jeevan Mission effectively, claiming that 44 lakh households were still awaiting tap water connections. He said work on 90% of drinking water projects had come to a standstill. PTI

India's trade deficit with China from January to Sept.

105.93 in $ billion. India's trade deficit with China crossed $100 billion in the first nine months of this year, even as Indian exports grew by 40%, sustaining their upward momentum amid a continued surge in Chinese exports. PTI

Railway employees for whom bonuses were approved by Cabinet

11 in lakh. Payment of productivity-linked bonus (PLB) to eligible railway employees is made each year before the Durga Puja/Dusshera holidays. "This year also, PLB amount equivalent to 78 days' wages is being paid to about 11.40 lakh non-gazetted Railway employees," the government said. PTI

Amount mobilised by the World Bank for job creation in India

36 in $ billion. The World Bank Group said it has helped mobilise $36 billion over the last four years for development across sectors and to support efforts to boost investment and create jobs. Of this, $9.6 billion was channelled towards micro, small and medium enterprises. PTI

Share of people who lived with mental health struggles

53 in per cent. More than 50% of people waited over a year to seek professional mental health care, while 56.2% reported thoughts of self-harm before accessing care, according to mental healthcare provider Amaya's 'Mental Health Report 2026'. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us facebook.com/thehindu X.com/the_hindu instagram.com/the_hindu

Why is Spain facing a housing crisis?

How are tourism and investment funds worsening the crisis? Why is Spain struggling to provide affordable housing? How has the housing crisis affected Sánchez's government? What measures has the government proposed to tackle the crisis? What is at stake in Spain's snap election?

EXPLAINER

Sonikka Loganathan

The story so far:

Last month, 87-year-old María del Carmen Abascal was evicted from her home of over seven decades. Her father first rented Abascal's apartment in Madrid's upscale Retiro neighbourhood in 1956. She stayed there under rent control after her parents died. The building changed ownership in 2018, and Abascal was offered the option to buy the unit. Since she couldn't afford it, investment fund Urbagestión bought the unit and raised the rent from 500 euros to 2,650 euros. The fund then lowered the rent to 1,650 euros, but Abascal, who was living on pension funds, still could not afford it.

Voicing concerns: People take part in a protest demanding action to alleviate Spain's housing crisis in Barcelona on October 9. REUTERS

How severe is Spain's housing crisis?

Her eviction sparked tens of thousands of people to protest nationwide over a housing crisis that is crippling the European nation. Hundreds of people set up tents in Madrid's Puerta del Sol plaza, with some camping out there for over a week. They are demanding stronger protections for tenants, lower rents and a ban on investment funds buying property. Protesters say the problem is one of supply and demand – there simply are not enough affordable homes. Rental costs have risen by an average of 84% over the last 10 years, according to property outlet Idealista. The southern city of Malaga has seen an increase of 113%, while Marbella's increase was just under 150%. Average incomes in recent years have failed to keep up with rising costs. According to the National Statistics Institute, the average gross monthly salary in Spain is around 2,460 euros. According to Idealista, in September, a 50-square-metre apartment in Madrid cost about 1,170 euros a month – about half the average income.

The Bank of Spain's latest reports also estimate that the country has a housing shortfall of about 750,000 homes. The bank's deputy governor, Soledad Núñez, said the housing deficit could increase by another 300,000 homes between 2026 and 2028, crossing the one-million mark.

Why is this happening?

Three key issues are worsening the crisis. First, household construction has not been able to keep up with Spain's demographic boom. About 1.2 million new households came about between 2021 and 2025, driven by an increase in migration. But that same period saw fewer than half a million new homes being constructed. The 2009 Eurozone crisis, which followed the 2008 Global Financial Crisis, caused Spain's construction industry to shrink. The COVID-19 pandemic pushed up material costs, and political differences continued to restrict construction initiatives.

Tourism is worsening the problem, as more houses are being used as short-term rentals. Madrid's tenants' union, Sindicato de Inquilinas de Madrid, estimates that over 4 million homes and 400,000 vacation rentals are currently empty.

Spain's Ministry for Consumer Rights ordered the short-term rental platform Airbnb to remove about 66,000 unlicensed listings, but locals say it isn't enough. Limited public housing is also worsening the situation, forcing many young adults to leave their parents' homes only after turning 30 – far older than in other European countries. Spain ranks towards the bottom among countries in the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development in terms of government-owned rental properties, which account for less than 2% of the total housing stock. Madrid has only around 10,000 public housing units for its 3.5 million residents.

Investment funds are further exploiting the problem by buying whatever homes and units are available and hiking rents dramatically. Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez's government calls them "vulture funds".

How has the crisis shaken Sánchez's government?

As protests continue to swell, Sánchez presented two emergency measures to tackle the housing crisis, largely aimed at providing tenants with more protections. On October 1, Spain's Congress rejected both proposed decrees, prompting further protests. The defeat showed that Sánchez's socialist government does not have congressional backing. Following the blow, Sánchez called for a snap general election on November 29. The next general election was meant to be held before the end of next summer. Sánchez is hoping to capitalise on public anger over the housing crisis to win votes and maintain his position. His Spanish Socialist Workers' Party is up against the far-right Vox party, the conservative People's Party and the pro-independence Catalan party Junts. If Vox wins, it would be the first time a far-right party has governed Spain since the death of dictator Francisco Franco in 1975.

THE GIST

- Rents in Spain have risen by an average of 84% over the past decade, while the country faces a housing shortfall of about 7,50,000 homes
- A shortage of new homes, the growth of short-term tourist rentals, limited public housing and investment funds driving up rents have worsened the crisis
- After Congress rejected his proposed housing measures, Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez called a snap general election for November 29, hoping to capitalise on public anger over housing

How has the SC strengthened arrest safeguards?

What makes written grounds of arrest mandatory, and what happens if they are not provided?

R.K.Vij

The story so far:

The Supreme Court recently, in *Jaskaran Jeet Singh Deol v. State of Punjab* (September 2026), held that the investigating agency would require permission of the magistrate to re-arrest the accused after his previous arrest was held illegal for the non-supply of the grounds of arrest in writing. It also recommended departmental action for the negligent investigating officer (IO) and change of the IO in the case.

What governs the communication of grounds of arrest?

The genesis of informing the grounds of arrest to a person flows from the Constitutional safeguard provided in Article 21 that no person shall be deprived of his life and personal liberty except according to procedure established by law. Article 22(2) says that every person who is arrested and detained in custody shall be produced before the nearest magistrate within a period of 24 hours of such arrest, excluding the time necessary for the journey from the place of arrest to the court of the magistrate, and no such person shall be detained in custody beyond the said period without the authority of a magistrate.

The Constitutional safeguard is incorporated in Section 50 of the CrPC (now Section 47 of BNSS). Section 47 of BNSS casts a duty on the police officer to communicate the grounds of arrest to an accused person arrested without a warrant. However, neither Article 22(2) of the Constitution nor Section 47 of BNSS specifies the mode of communicating the grounds of arrest to an accused person.

How has the law evolved?

In *Pankaj Bansal v. Union of India & Ors.* (2023), the Supreme Court while dealing with a case of Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 (PMLA) held that there was no valid reason as to why a written copy of the grounds of arrest could not be provided to the arrestee as a standard procedure without any exception. The court cited two reasons for it. First, in case the grounds of arrest are orally read out to an accused person, those orally stated facts could be disputed in a given case. Second, the accused person may seek legal counsel to avail bail. The court therefore held that furnishing a copy of written grounds of arrest to an accused was mandatory without exception.

This principle was reiterated by the court in *Prabir Purkayastha v. State (NCT of Delhi)* (May 2024) while dealing with a case under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967. It held that communicating the grounds of arrest was not merely a procedural formality but a vital safeguard with the ultimate objective of enabling the arrested person to effectively consult legal aid and be prepared to raise objections in the remand hearing and apply for his/her bail. Also, any breach of Article 22(2) would vitiate the lawfulness of arrest and subsequent remand, and entitle the person to be set at liberty.

However, in *Vihaan Kumar v. State of Haryana and Another* (2025), the court observed that although the ideal mode of communication of grounds of arrest is to provide such grounds in writing, there is no such statutory requirement to do so.

What did the court rule in the Rajesh Mihir Shah case?

The Supreme Court in *Rajesh Mihir Shah v. State of Maharashtra and Another* (2025) held that the constitutional mandate of informing the arrestee of the grounds of arrest is mandatory in all offences under all statutes, including offences under the IPC (now BNS). Second, the grounds of arrest must be communicated in writing to the arrestee in the language he/she understands. Third, in cases where the arresting officer is unable to communicate the grounds of arrest in writing on or soon after arrest, it needs to be done orally. The said grounds of arrest are to be communicated in writing within a reasonable time and in any case at least two hours prior to production of the arrestee for remand proceedings before the magistrate. Fourth, in case of non-compliance, the arrest and subsequent remand would be rendered illegal.

What are the consequences?

The court in the *Jaskaran Jeet Singh Deol* (supra) case said that if the IO still needs to re-arrest an accused for custodial interrogation during investigation, the IO has to file an application before the concerned magistrate for custody, stating the reasons.

The IO would also need to explain the reasons for non-supply of the grounds of arrest to the accused. However, the application could be filed only after furnishing the grounds of arrest to the accused. Also, the application must have the endorsement of the immediate superior authority. It is only after the receipt of such application that the magistrate shall decide the same expeditiously.

Second, the investigation of the case shall be handed over to another officer by the superior authority, and he shall also direct departmental enquiry for the serious lapse of not providing the grounds of arrest in writing to the accused.

Additionally, the High Court may direct payment of compensation as part of the public law remedy for the violation of Article 22(2) of the Constitution, with liberty to the accused to avail his remedy under the private civil law.

(R.K. Vij is a former IPS officer)

THE GIST

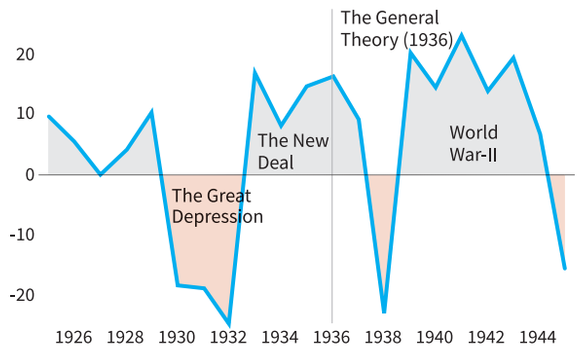
- The Supreme Court ruled that grounds of arrest must be communicated in writing, in a language the accused understands, at least two hours before remand proceedings
- If this safeguard is violated, re-arrest requires the magistrate's permission. The court also called for a change of investigating officer and a departmental inquiry into the lapse

KEYWORD

Economics of growth

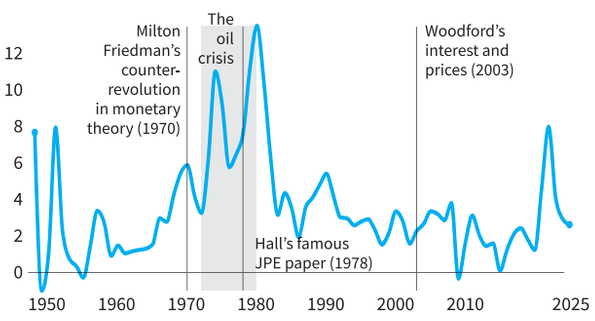
From business cycles to long-run growth, Keynes-Kalecki and orthodox economists differ on the role of demand

Chart 1 (a): The Great Depression and the rise of Keynes-Kalecki
(CAGR of U.S. industrial production, 1925–1945)



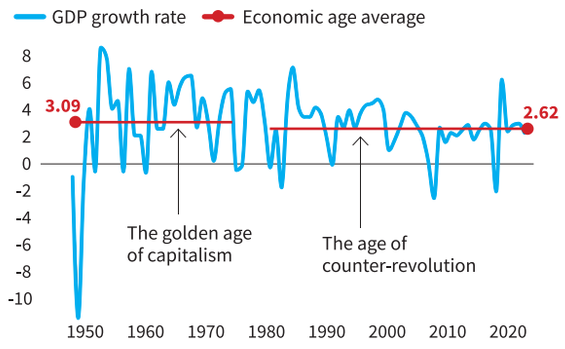
Source: Industrial Production – Total Index (IPB50001SQ), Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System (U.S.) via FRED

Chart 1 (b): Inflation and a monetarist counter-revolution in the U.S.
(1948-2025, CPI annual per cent change from year ago)



Source: Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: all items in the U.S. city average, index 1982-1984=100, seasonally adjusted

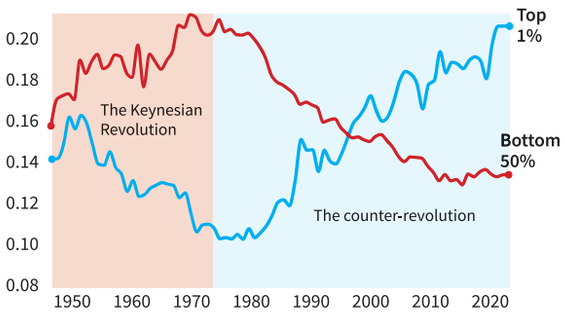
Chart 2: Long-run trend and business cycles in the U.S.
(Annual growth rates of real GDP, 1945-2025, in %)



The red lines: CAGR = geometric average, i.e., the constant annual rate that compounds to the same cumulative real GDP change over the phase: 1945-1973 (3.09%) and 1980-2025 (2.62%).

Source: Authors' calculations. Federal Reserve Economic Data, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis

Chart 3: Economic ideas are not class agnostic
(Ratio of class-wise pre-tax income to total income)

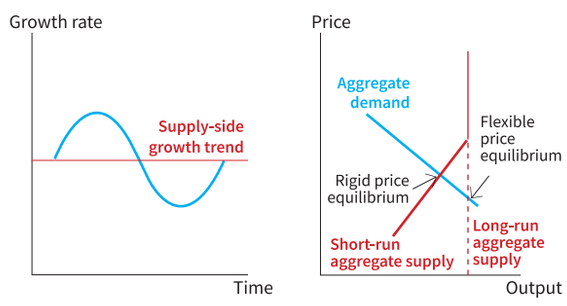


Source: World Inequality Database

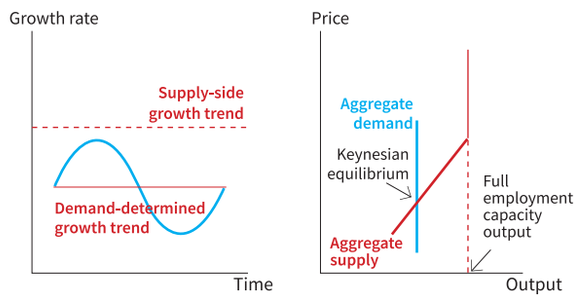
Robert E. Hall

Michael Woodford

Graph 1: Schematic representation of the orthodox framework



Graph 2: Schematic representation of the Keynes-Kalecki framework



Why the debate between Keynesian and orthodox economics matters

Keynes-Kalecki framework holds that demand, particularly private investment, shapes short-term fluctuations and long-term growth, unlike orthodox supply-led approaches; the shift towards inflation targeting coincided with falling wage shares and a greater burden on workers

Rohit Azad
Indranil Chowdhury

GETTY IMAGES

Economists are products of their times. While KK wrote against the backdrop of the Great Depression, the deepest economic crisis faced by capitalism, this year's Nobel laureates wrote in the aftermath of unprecedented inflation of the 1970s

Professors Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford have been awarded the Nobel Prize in Economics this year "for microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation". In this piece, we take a longue durée view of macroeconomics to situate their work within the context of political economy. In many ways, the field has come full circle from the days of John Maynard Keynes and Michal Kalecki (henceforth KK)

Economists are products of their times. While KK wrote against the backdrop of the Great Depression, the deepest and longest economic crisis faced by capitalism (Chart 1a), this year's Nobel laureates wrote in the aftermath of the unprecedented inflation of the 1970s (see Chart 1b).

These are two watershed moments in both the history of capitalism and the field of macroeconomics. The former brought the Keynesian revolution (though a misnomer, as Kalecki had an equal part in it), while the latter are part of a counterrevolution to reestablish pre-Keynesian orthodoxy in many ways.

Ideas matter a great deal. The arguments and policy flowing out of the KK framework led to what is considered the golden age of capitalism (1945-1973), a period that recorded the highest sustained growth rates (compare the average growth rates across time in chart 2).

What creates a business cycle?

What is a business cycle? Like a ship navigating the ocean, a capitalist economy moves through ebbs and flows in economic activity. Just as a ship cruises smoothly when the waters are calm, an economy has an underlying long-term trend rate of growth. Both the cycle and the underlying trend rate of growth have been the subject of intense debates in economics. There are two broad poles in this debate – with some variations within each: heterodox and orthodox approaches.

Heterodox approaches hold that demand influences both the cycle and the trend, while orthodox approaches believe demand plays a role in the cycle but not the trend, albeit for different reasons. The Nobel laureates work within the latter tradition, while KK did within the former. Why should the readers bother about these esoteric questions? Because our livelihoods, jobs, cost of living, and much else depend on which side is steering the ship.

Consider the orthodox approach. Before KK, it was believed that in the long run, economies move along full-employment paths with cycles arising from external shocks, which did not require policy interventions from the State. These arguments, however, were built on ad hoc assumptions. In the 1980s, a newer version of this orthodox approach sought to build the framework from the bottom up, moving from micro-foundations to a macroeconomic model. This led to the development of real business cycle (RBC) theory, associated with economists Finn Kydland and Edward Prescott, who won the 2004 Nobel Prize in Economics. The economy functions along the full-employment path, with the trend determined by the growth of the labour force and its productivity (Graph 1(a)). For them, output and labour markets clear in the short run, so even the cyclical movements were caused by the supply side, thereby precluding the possibility of any State intervention.

Economists such as Hall and Woodford, while keeping the RBC framework intact, argued that economies can fall off the full-employment path if prices do not adjust fast enough to clear the markets. The argument they made was that not all firms change their prices at the same time; some do so in one period, while others in another. As a result, prices do not fully adjust between these periods. If household demand for goods is less than what firms collectively wish to supply (Graph 1(b)), prices may not fall enough to restore equilibrium. The economy then operates at lower levels of demand (recession). The opposite happens if demand is greater than supply (boom with signs of overheating).

If you consider a time period long enough (over a business cycle), on average, the prices would have adjusted fully, in which case demand also adjusts fully to what the firms would like to supply. Demand creates supply in the short run while supply determines the demand in the long run. It is obvious, therefore, that policy is required only for the short run and not the long run.

Demand and long-term growth

The KK tradition is markedly different from this. They argued that demand matters not just in determining the cyclical component of growth but also the underlying trend. Kalecki had famously said, "the long-run trend is but a slowly changing component of a chain of short-period situations; it has no independent entity". If the economy is underemployed through the short run, it remains so in the long run as well (see graph 2 (a)). And if policy changes the short-run equilibrium, it affects the trend rate of growth too.

But even more importantly, their analysis of the short term differs as well. Economies are stuck at below-capacity output or with unemployed workers not because prices and wages are rigid but because capital investment by the capitalists is not enough to employ all those who seek employment. Rigidity of investment, not prices, causes unemployment. In Keynes, prices are not even rigid, let alone being the cause of the business cycle. In Kalecki, they are, but that is not the cause of the shortage of demand. Unless the fall in prices could affect investment, it would have no impact on demand. Demand is vertical in prices (Graph 2(b)).

A fall in prices may in fact have a negative impact on investment through debt defaults, etc. All of this had a profound impact on both understanding the workings of a capitalist economy as well as policy prescriptions.

Non-neutrality of money

Having looked at their understanding of how capitalism functions, consider their take on policy, particularly monetary policy.

Before Keynes, it was believed that money could not affect the 'real' economy, i.e., it was neutral in its impact on output. It was believed that a larger pool of money would chase the same amount of goods, which simply leads to a rise in their prices. The role of monetary policy, therefore, was to stabilise prices. The New Keynesian Model (NKM) agrees that this is indeed the case in the long run; however, in the short run, since prices are sticky, a rise in the money supply increases real balances in the hands of households, who increase their consumption, thereby making money non-neutral. But this holds only in the short run. While money is non-neutral in the short run, the primary role of monetary policy nevertheless is to stabilise inflation. No wonder that this policy approach is called inflation targeting. The KK framework, on the other hand, did not believe that money leads to inflation. Given that the ebbs in activity were caused by a lack of adequate private investment, their policy recommendations foregrounded policies which increased the level of activity directly, i.e., through fiscal intervention by the State. If private investment is not coming through, public investment fills the gap.

As for monetary policy, it mostly played a second fiddle to fiscal policy in their framework. Monetary policy on its own may not work because it is an indirect route of increasing private investment by decreasing the cost of loans. KK believed that low investment is because the demand for the products the factories produce is low, so a mere fall in the cost of loans will not reverse the 'animal spirits' of the capitalists.

Class politics of inflation

All of this is not just a theoretical debate. While the Keynesian revolution improved the lot of the workers on the whole, the monetarist counter-revolution has made them the scapegoats in this fight against inflation, which we have written about in these columns earlier. It is not surprising that the wage shares were rising during the KK years and a reversal has taken place since the RBC counterrevolution took hold over the discipline (Chart 3). Economic frameworks and policy prescriptions, therefore, are not, and can never be, class agnostic.

(The authors are a part of the DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics)

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning and origin of the idiom "to live the life of Riley"? (K. R. Manohara, Chitragupta)

When you say that somebody is "living" or "leading the life of Riley", what you are implying is that he/she is leading a very comfortable life. He/she is leading the kind of life that all of us wish we had – a life where one doesn't have to work hard or spend sleepless nights worrying about making ends meet. When you lead the life of Riley, you lead a very "cushy" life.

While Prabha worked all day, Sunil stayed home living the life of Riley.

What is the origin of this expression? Well, no one is really sure as to who this Riley was. Some scholars argue that this Riley (originally spelt "Reilly") referred to the character that appeared in a song written by Pat Rooney in 1890. In the song, Riley says if he ever became the President of the US then "New York" would "swim in wine when the White House and Capitol are mine." It tells you something about the kind of President he would have made, doesn't it? Some others argue that it was an American poet by the name of James Whitcomb Riley who gave rise to this idiom. Apparently, Riley (1849-1916) wrote sentimental poems about young boys, which were very popular during his time. The poems told the stories of young boys lazing around during the summer without a care in the world – wandering about barefoot, swimming in the river, and fishing.

What is the meaning of "sixth sense"? (T. Srinivas, Siddipet)

Sometimes when you get up in the morning you have a feeling that you are going to have a really bad day. There may not be any logical explanation why you feel this way. You just have this strange feeling and, funnily enough, you end up having a perfectly lousy day. This intuitive feeling that you sometimes have that tells you that something good or bad is going to happen is your "sixth sense". We all have five senses – taste, hearing, sight, smell, and touch. This sixth sense cannot be explained by the other five senses; it is something that cannot be explained by logic. Here are a few examples.

Atul's sixth sense warned him not to trust his new lawyer.

Prem's sixth sense told him that something bad was going to happen.

The expression means the same thing as "gut reaction" or "gut feeling". Your gut feeling about something is your personal or intuitive feeling about something. For example,

Satish had a gut feeling that he was going to get some bad news.

What should a sign say? "No admission" or "No admittance"? (G.K.S. Kandasubramanian, Sivaganga)

Both are correct. When you find these signs on a door, what they imply is that you do not have the right to enter. Of the two, "admittance" is the more formal. It stresses on the physical act of entering the premises. "Admission", on the other hand, is far less formal and has several different meanings. For example, we talk about "admission to a club or university". Here the focus is not on the physical act of entering the university or the club, but in the general sense of participating with others. Admission gives you the right to join others and participate in an event/programme.

Published in The Hindu on April 9, 2002

Word of the day

Mendacity:
the tendency to be untruthful

Synonyms: lie, falsehood, fabrication

Usage: *The politician was known for his mendacity.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/mendacity

International Phonetic Alphabet: /mɛndæsəti/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'